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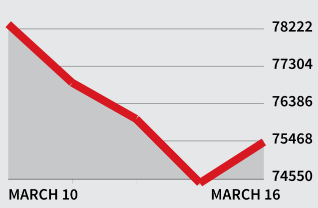

IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23408.80	+257.70
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.73	+0.26
US Dollar (in ₹)	92.42	-0.03
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	155090.00	-2675
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	248711.00	-11777

YIELD BOOST. Horticulture output is pegged marginally higher at 370.85 mt in 2025-26, aided by better yields despite a slight dip in area **p8**

URBAN JOBS RISING. Jobless rate edged down to 4.9% in Feb from 5% in Jan, per the National Statistics Office **p9**

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QUICKLY.

NON-VEG FOOD ITEMS UP

Wholesale inflation jumps to 2.13% in February

New Delhi: With a rise in non-vegetable food prices, inflation based on the Wholesale Price Index (WPI) rose to 2.13 per cent in February, the Commerce Ministry reported on Monday. This is the fourth successive month of rise. Wholesale inflation was 1.81 per cent in January. **p3**

$3-BILLION DEAL

Reliance to supply green ammonia to Samsung C&T

Mumbai: Reliance Industries said it has signed a binding 15-year agreement worth over $3 billion with Samsung C&T Corporation to supply green ammonia, marking one of the world's largest offtake deals for the clean fuel and underscoring India's ambitions as a green energy exporter. Under the agreement, Reliance will begin supplying green ammonia to Samsung C&T from the second half of FY29. **p2**

Bajaj Auto mulls EV expansion out of Maharashtra on sops row

UNPLUGGING? Company riled by State's autorickshaw permit curb; TN, Karnataka woo automaker

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

POLICY SNAG

- Bajaj Auto's plan to shift base comes amid a dispute with Maharashtra over ₹75 crore in unpaid subsidies and curbs on new auto permits
- Permit curbs could hit the company as the State accounts for 15-17% of its ICE three-wheeler volumes
- Bajaj has invested about ₹750 crore in the EV ecosystem in Pune; vendors added ₹250 crore more

Bajaj Auto is contemplating moving a part of its electric vehicle (EV) manufacturing out of Maharashtra and allocating future EV investments to other States following a disagreement with the State government over nearly ₹75 crore in unpaid subsidies and restrictions on new autorickshaw permits, according to sources familiar with the matter.

Industry sources said the company is exploring the possibility of shifting future EV manufacturing expansion to its Pantnagar facility in Rudrapur, Uttarakhand, while also considering directing new investments to States offering clearer policy support and incentives. The development has prompted rival States to reach out to the Bajaj Auto management to compete for the company's upcoming EV investments. Karnataka and Tamil Nadu have already initiated discussions with the automaker, industry sources said.

The dispute stems from tensions between Bajaj Auto and the Maharashtra Transport Department over delays in subsidy payments and a recent decision to restrict the issue of new autorickshaw permits in the State, citing market saturation.

Subsidy dues to Bajaj Auto are estimated around ₹75 crore, though the company has reportedly received partial payments.

MINOR ISSUE: GOVT

The Maharashtra government sought to downplay the issue as it continues to engage with the company. Maharashtra Industries Secretary P Anbalagan described the subsidy issue as a relatively minor one from a budget perspective while emphasising that the State remains committed to working with industry.

"That is a small component problem from a budget perspective. The government is there to engage with industry, and we are working closely on the issues," Anbalagan told *businessline* at the Confederation of Indian Industry Maharashtra Annual Meeting, where he outlined the State's $1 trillion manufacturing ambitions.

PERMIT CURBS

The situation drew wider attention after Bajaj Auto MD Rajiv Bajaj publicly criticised the State's EV policy, calling it a "massive failure" and saying that in his 36-year career, he had never seen such a major policy breakdown.

Analysts said that the permit restrictions could significantly affect Bajaj Auto, given its strong presence in the three-wheeler market. The State accounts for 15-17 per cent of the company's domestic ICE three-wheeler volumes and about 15 per cent of its overall three-wheeler sales, according to analyst estimates.

Bajaj Auto is estimated to hold around 87 per cent market share in Maharashtra's three-wheeler segment, making it particularly sensitive to regulatory changes.

Through its subsidiary Chetak Technology Ltd, the company has invested about ₹750 crore in its EV ecosystem at its Akurdi facility in Pune.

Vendors have invested another ₹250 crore in the local component ecosystem, while Bajaj has earmarked ₹420 crore for EV-related capex, suggesting that any expansion outside the State could affect the wider supplier network.

businessline did not receive a response from Bajaj Auto till press time.

Comfortable on crude, gas, petrol, diesel; still tight on LPG: Govt

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

LPG carrier *Shivalik* arriving at Mundra Port on Monday ANI

The government on Monday said the country's crude oil, petrol and diesel stocks remain "comfortable", with uninterrupted natural gas supply even as the LPG situation remains "tight".

Sujata Sharma, Joint Secretary, Petroleum Ministry, said crude oil supplies remain "adequate" and refineries are operating at high capacity, with petrol pumps functioning normally and no dry-outs reported.

Natural gas supply is also uninterrupted, with 100 per cent availability of compressed natural gas (CNG) and piped natural gas (PNG). Commercial LPG users are being encouraged to shift to PNG where available, with city gas distribution (CGD) companies offering incentives and fast-tracking new connections, she said.

LPG SUPPLY TIGHT

"While the LPG situation remains tight, consumers continue to receive supplies with no distributor-level dry-outs reported. About 90 per cent of LPG bookings are now made online, and delivery authentication code usage has risen to 72 per cent," Sharma said. The States have intensified action against hoarding and black marketing. Consumers with both PNG and LPG connections have been advised to surrender LPG connections and avoid panic booking.

India's average daily LPG production since March 5 has increased by 36 per cent. From about 37,355 tonnes per day in January 2026, the output has risen to around 50,803 tonnes.

SHIPS IN TRANSIT

Rakesh Kumar Sinha, Special Secretary, Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, said 22 Indian-flagged vessels with 611 seafarers remain west of the Strait of Hormuz in the Persian Gulf region.

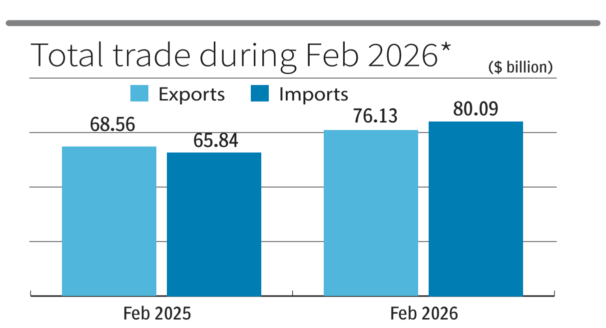
These include six VLGCs, one LNG carrier, four very large crude carriers, one chemicals and products vessel, three container ships, two bulk carriers and one dredger. One vessel is in ballast (without cargo), while three are in dry dock for maintenance.

Indian-flag vessel *Jag Laadki*, carrying about 80,800 tonnes of Murban crude oil, sailed from the United Arab Emirates on March 14 and is safely en route to Mundra Port.

Of the two Indian-flag LPG carriers that crossed the Strait of Hormuz on March 14 carrying about 92,712 tonnes of LPG, *Shivalik* has reached Mundra Port and completed documentation for priority discharge, while *Nanda Devi* is expected to arrive early on Tuesday.

Feb goods exports dip a tad to $36.61 b, but trade deficit doubles to $27 b on import surge

Amiti Sen
New Delhi



India's total exports during April-February 2025-26 are estimated at $ 790.86 billion registering a positive growth of 5.79 per cent. Total imports 2025-26* are estimated at $ 900.51 billion registering a growth of 7.37 per cent

Goods exports declined a marginal 0.81 per cent year-on-year in February to $36.61 billion amid global uncertainties, but March is set to be even more challenging due to the West Asia crisis and logistical bottlenecks, according to the Commerce Department.

Imports increased 24.11 per cent to $63.71 billion in February, which widened the trade deficit to $27.1 billion, almost double of $14 billion in February 2025.

But the trade deficit was lower than $34.68 billion in January, according to the Commerce Department data.

Despite the increased geopolitical turmoil following the US-Israel attack on Iran in February-end, the government is hopeful that the country's exports of goods will remain in the positive territory in FY26 with efforts on to help exporters deal with the West Asia crisis and also increase shipments to other parts of the world, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal said.

GREATER CHALLENGE

"On the trade front, we are facing one challenge after another... March will pose a greater challenge (due to the West Asia problems)... Whatever exports we lose from that part of the world, we will try and make up with more exports to other markets. We would like to be in positive territory versus last year on merchandise exports by the end of this fiscal," Agrawal said.

The government will unveil a support package within a week to assist exporters struggling with the West Asia trade disruptions, the Secretary said.

India's goods exports stood at $402.93 billion in April-February 2025-26, which is about 1.84 per cent higher than $395.66 billion in the same period last fiscal year.

A drop in performance in March due to the Iran war could upset the math but the government is working against that.

In April-February 2025-26, imports also increased 8.53 per cent to $713.53 billion.

The Commerce Secretary explained that the decline in exports in February was largely due to a fall in petroleum shipments, which slumped 40 per cent to $3.42 billion, while the higher trade deficit was due to an increase in imports of gold and silver.

Apart from petroleum, export of readymade garments, leather and leather products, iron ore and plastic also declined.

Exports to the US, India's largest market, declined 12.88 per cent to $6.88 billion in February as a fallout of the 50 per cent reciprocal and penal tariffs, which were subsequently removed and replaced with a 10 per cent short-term global tariff.

Insurance premium hikes not related to medical inflation; no IRDAI study done: Minister tells LS

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Double-digit medical inflation has long been cited by insurance companies as the primary justification for hiking premiums.

However, the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) has maintained that there is insufficient evidence to establish a direct correlation between the two.

"IRDAI has informed that no specific study has been conducted by it on the rate of medical inflation and its correlation with health insurance premium," Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary said in a written reply.

This admission weakens the narrative of insurers, which have frequently cited double-digit healthcare inflation to explain the surging premiums — in some cases by over 100 per cent within just 3-4 years after the Covid-19 pandemic.

MANY FACTORS AT PLAY

Chaudhary noted that several factors beyond medical inflation, including the rising average age of policyholders, higher sum insured and modified policy features, drive annual premium hikes.

"Since multiple reasons contribute to the increase in individual premiums, the increase attributable to only medical inflation cannot be identified," the Minister said.

ACTUARIAL OVERSIGHT

He also highlighted the IRDAI's push for greater transparency through mandatory actuarial oversight.

"The Appointed Actuary of insurer is made responsible for periodical review of the products. He/she shall ensure that any revision either of the premium rates or the corresponding benefits or both with respect to the existing products shall be based on credible underlying experience of relevant risk parameters. The revision shall also consider the analysis of policyholders' grievances and market feedback, if any," he said.

The IRDAI has capped premium hikes for senior citizens at 10 per cent by all general and health insurers.

If the proposed increase exceeds 10 per cent annually or if an individual health insurance product offered to senior citizens is withdrawn, the insurers must consult the regulator beforehand, Chaudhary said.

INDUSTRY STANCE

Insurance companies define medical inflation as the rise in expenses related to healthcare services, including medicines, diagnostic tests, doctor fees and hospitalisation charges.

The type of treatment and the procedures needed may also be factored into the calculation.

Insurers say medical inflation is in the range of 12–14 per cent, significantly higher than general inflation.

Last month, Anand Roy, MD and CEO of Star Health and Allied Insurance Company, said around 65 per cent of the company's products saw price hikes last year due to healthcare inflation.

A CH-CHE

QUICKLY.

Arun Mammen re-elected Chairman of ATMA

Kochi: Arun Mammen, Vice-Chairman & Managing Director of MRF Ltd, has been re-elected as the Chairman of the Automotive Tyre Manufacturers' Association (ATMA), the national industry body for the automotive tyre sector in India. Rajarshi Moitra, MD, Bridgestone India Private Ltd, is the new Vice-Chairman of ATMA. Sanjay Chatterjee, Assistant Director General of ATMA, has been elevated as Director General in place of Rajiv Budhraja, who retires on March 31. Set up in 1975, ATMA is among the most active national industry bodies in the country, representing the over ₹1,00,000 crore automotive tyre industry. Large tyre companies comprising a mix of Indian and international tyre majors, representing over 80 per cent of the production of tyres in India, are members of the association. OUR BUREAU

CUMI starts thin wheel production at Hosur unit

Chennai: Carborundum Universal Ltd (CUMI) has announced the commencement of commercial production of its cutting and grinding wheels (thin wheel) at its Hosur facility. With the commissioning of this production facility, CUMI India's total annual cutting and grinding wheel manufacturing capacity will increase from 45 million wheels to over 90 million. The plant has been established on an investment of ₹83 crore and, at peak capacity utilisation, is expected to generate a turnover of ₹160 crore. The products manufactured at the facility will cater to a wide range of industrial applications. In 2023, the CUMI Group acquired the manufacturing lines, technology and brand of DRONCO GmbH. OUR BUREAU

RIL signs $3 b deal to supply green ammonia to Samsung

MAJOR WIN. It is among the largest long-term green ammonia offtake contracts globally

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Reliance Industries said it has signed a binding 15-year agreement, valued at over $3 billion, with Samsung C&T Corporation to supply green ammonia. This marks one of the largest global offtake deals for the clean fuel, signalling India's growing ambitions as an exporter of green energy.

Under the agreement, Reliance will supply green ammonia to Samsung C&T from the second half of FY29. The SPA is among the largest binding long-term green ammonia offtake contracts globally, it said.

The agreement with Samsung C&T is expected to be the first in a series of long-term offtake partnerships supporting the expansion of Reliance's new energy business.

GOVT MISSION

The deal is expected to support the development of India's green hydrogen ecosystem and aligns with the government's National Green Hydrogen Mission, which aims to position the country as a major global producer and exporter of green fuels.

GOING PLACES. Reliance will supply green ammonia to Samsung C&T from the second half of FY29

Reliance is currently developing a large clean energy ecosystem centred around the Dhirubhai Ambani Green Energy Giga Complex in Jamnagar, Gujarat.

The manufacturing hub will house gigafactories for solar modules, batteries, electrolysers, fuel cells and power electronics, supporting integrated green hydrogen and ammonia production.

Reliance said the agreement with Samsung reflects its strategy of building a fully integrated new energy platform spanning renewable power, energy storage, green hydrogen and downstream green fuels and chemicals.

The company is also developing domestic manufacturing capabilities for key clean energy technologies, such as solar modules, battery energy storage systems and electrolysers, as part of its broader push towards self reliance in the energy transition.

According to the company, integrating these technologies within a single ecosystem will allow it to produce green energy solutions that are scalable and globally competitive while strengthening India's manufacturing base.

Anant Ambani, Executive Director at Reliance Industries, said the partnership marks an important milestone in the company's clean energy strategy. The collaboration will help scale the company's green hydrogen ecosystem and manufacturing facilities while contributing to India's ambition of becoming a global hub for green hydrogen and its derivatives, he said.

Through these investments, the company aims to build a globally competitive clean energy platform while advancing its goal of achieving net-zero carbon emissions by 2035.

W. Asia crisis boosts EV enquiries in India, but analysts see only gradual adoption

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

The West Asia crisis, which hit gas supplies and created anxiety among owners of petrol/CNG/LPG vehicles, may have helped increase footfalls in electric vehicle showrooms over the past few days, but analysts do not see this bringing about a sea change in EV adoption.

Auto industry sources added that the footfalls had not yet translated into increased bookings, but they were seeing broader customer interest. According to Poonam Upadhyay, Director at Crisil Ratings, the auto sector is unlikely to see a sharp shift in fuel mix, and any change will likely remain gradual.

"EV share in two-wheeler registrations has edged up to 6.6 per cent year-to-date from about 5.5 per cent in FY25, indicating steady but measured adoption. The passenger vehicle (PV) segment shows a similar trend, with EV share rising from 2.9 per cent in FY25 to around 3.5 per cent year-to-date, reflecting modest gains from a small base as buyers weigh running costs against higher upfront prices and charging constraints," she told *businessline*.

CNG remains a strong choice in the PV segment and is already the second-largest fuel type, with year-to-date penetration at 18 per cent, up from 16.5 per cent in FY25, supported by lower operating costs.

"With gas availability facing some pressure in the current environment and possible changes in price dynamics, incremental demand could moderate. Overall, with the broader focus on sustainable mobility, the sector is expected to continue transitioning towards cleaner fuels, albeit at a measured pace," Upadhyay added.

ENERGY SECURITY

According to Gaurav Vangaal, Associate Director for LVP Forecasting at S&P Global Mobility, India remains highly dependent on global stability to secure its energy needs, and a prolonged conflict could reshape consumption trends.

Nevertheless, EV adoption is expected to continue its upward trajectory, he added.

A spokesperson for Tata Motors, a leader in the passenger vehicle segment, said the company is seeing a broader increase in consumer interest in EVs nationwide. The rise is driven by factors such as total cost of ownership, ease of home charging and growing awareness of energy security and sustainability.

"Several of our dealer partners have also anecdotally reported higher enquiry volumes for EVs over the past week or so. EV adoption in India has been on a steady upward trajectory, and our focus remains on supporting customers through a compelling product portfolio and a continuously strengthening charging ecosystem," the spokesperson said.

IndiGo takes the lead in pilot count, SpiceJet tops pilot-to-aircraft ratio

Yashaswani Chauhan
New Delhi

DATA FOCUS.

As airlines seek temporary relief from flight duty time limitation (FDTL) norms amid longer international flight durations, data on pilot strength, pilot-to-aircraft ratio and passenger service indicators point to widening operational pressures across the aviation sector.

According to a response to an unstarred question in the Lok Sabha, among Indian carriers, IndiGo has the largest pilot base at 5,200, with a pilot-to-aircraft ratio of 7.6. Air India follows with 3,123 pilots and a ratio of 9.1.

Air India Express employs 1,820 (ratio 8.8), while Akasa Air has 761 pilots with a ratio of 9.33. SpiceJet operates with 375 pilots, but has the highest pilot-to-aircraft ratio at 9.4. Alliance Air, with 115 pilots, has the lowest ratio at 6.

KEY INDICATOR

The pilot-to-aircraft ratio is a key indicator of scheduling flexibility. Higher ratios typically provide airlines greater buffer to manage disruptions, crew rest requirements and roster adjustments. Carriers operating with lower ratios may face tighter operational margins during unforeseen events such as diversions or airspace closures.

To supplement domestic capacity, some airlines have hired foreign pilots. Air India Express leads with 48 foreign pilots, followed by IndiGo with 29 and Alliance Air with 15.

Cancellation data show diverging trends across carriers. IndiGo improved its cancellation rate from 0.78 per cent in 2024 to 0.48 per cent in 2025.

Akasa Air also saw improvement, with cancellations declining from 0.31 per cent to 0.19 per cent.

In contrast, the Air India group's cancellation rate rose from 0.62 per cent in 2024 to 0.71 per cent in 2025. SpiceJet recorded the highest cancellation rates among major carriers, increasing from 1.91 per cent to 1.97 per cent.

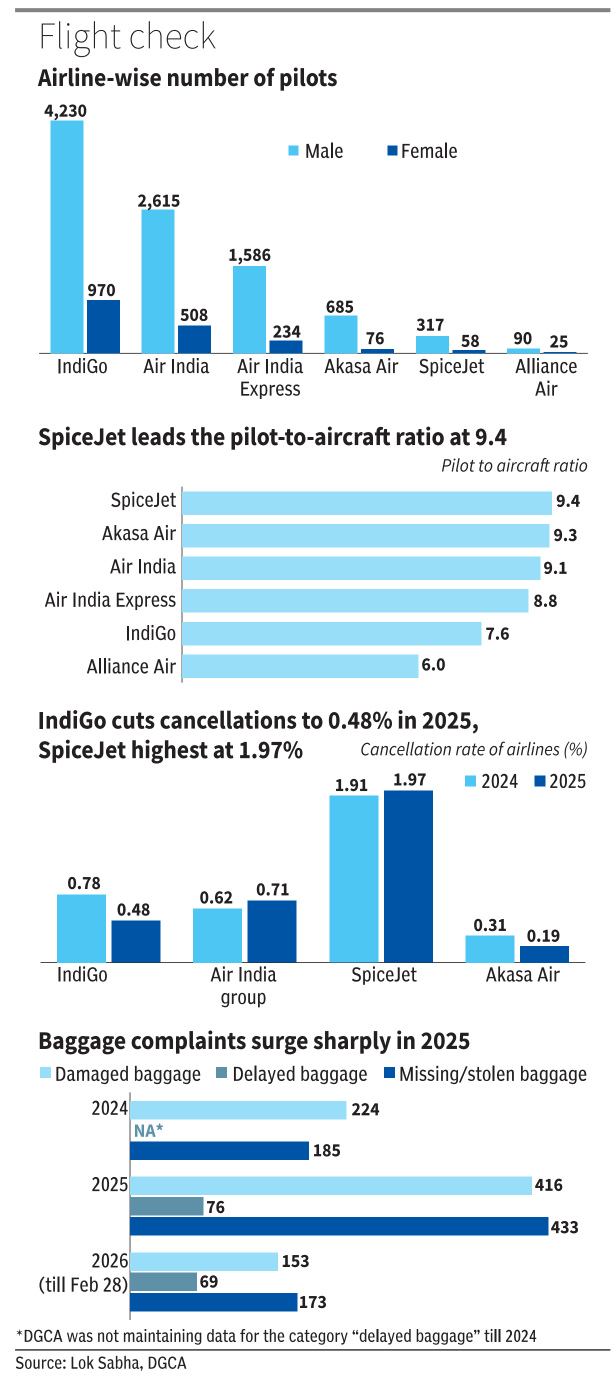
BAGGAGE COMPLAINTS

Passenger service indicators show a sharp increase in baggage-related complaints in 2025. Damaged baggage cases rose from 224 in 2024 to 416 in 2025. Missing or stolen baggage incidents more than doubled from 185 to 433 during the same period. Data for delayed baggage were not maintained separately until 2025, when 76 cases were recorded. In 2026 (till February 28), 153 damaged baggage cases, 69 delayed baggage complaints and 173 missing or stolen baggage cases have already been reported.

The rise in baggage complaints, along with mixed trends in flight cancellations, highlights the growing operational strain on airlines as they expand and navigate external disruptions.

As carriers add aircraft and seek temporary regulatory flexibility, ensuring adequate crew strength and consistent service standards will be critical to maintaining passenger trust.

Air India group's cancellation rate rose from 0.62% in 2024 to 0.71% in 2025. SpiceJet recorded the highest cancellation rates, increasing from 1.91% to 1.97%



Tata Motors, Ashok Leyland to gain from move to extend localisation deadline for EV motors

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

The Centre has pushed the localisation deadline for key electric bus and truck components to September 1 under the PM E-Drive scheme, a move that's expected to provide relief to manufacturers such as Tata Motors, Ashok Leyland, Eicher Motors and EKA Mobility. These players are ramping up electric bus and commercial vehicle deployments across the country.

TRACTION MOTORS

The amendment gives vehicle makers additional time to domestically manufacture traction motors used in electric buses and N2-category electric trucks, with officials acknowledging that the revised timeline factors in supply chain disruptions flagged by OEMs, particularly shortages of rare-earth magnets used in high-efficiency electric powertrains.

The Ministry of Heavy Industries notified the change through a Gazette notification dated March 13, amending the phased manufacturing programme (PMP) roadmap for electric trucks in the N2 and N3 commercial vehicle categories under the PM E-Drive scheme.

REVISED NORMS

Under the revised norms, traction motors used in these vehicles must be manufactured domestically from September 1, with key processes carried out within India. According to the notification, domestic manufacturing must include processes such as magnet fitment, rotor and stator assembly, shaft fitment, bearing integration, enclosure fitment and connector, and cable installation.

The rules also mandate deeper localisation of integrated systems, including motor-transmission assemblies and traction motor controllers with inverters. For integrated traction motors used with transmissions, domestic assembly of motor-transmission systems, transmission controllers and software flashing must be undertaken locally from September. Similarly, traction motor controllers with inverters must undergo domestic manufacturing that includes PCB assembly with electronic components and semiconductors, high-voltage connector integration, heatsink fitment and firmware flashing.

Industry executives said the revised timeline reflects persistent global supply-chain constraints, particularly the limited availability of rare-earth permanent magnets, which are essential for high-efficiency traction motors used in electric buses and heavy commercial vehicles.

Finolex eyes ₹1,000 cr revenue from TN in FY27

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Finolex Cables is targeting ₹1,000 crore in revenue from Tamil Nadu in the coming fiscal year, driven by the State's expanding industrial ecosystem and growing data centre and other infrastructure investments.

With around ₹750 crore turnover from the State, Tamil Nadu is the power and cables company's biggest market in the South, and the growth here is in "higher double-digits", Amit Mathur, President, Sales & Marketing, Finolex Cables, told *businessline*.

The overall growth in industrialisation and infrastructure development has driven the growth of power cables for Finolex. "We can see the CAGR is more than 30-40 per cent in the flexi cables product," he said.

Similarly, there is a good uptake in communication and optical fibre cables with a surge in business from data centres.

VOLUMES HIT

Despite the strong growth levers, the ongoing war in West Asia has created a cloud of uncertainty over volume growth, the executive said, noting a price increase across key materials that go into their business.

"We have seen that PVC prices have gone up by 21 per cent in last 7-8 days only. Aluminium prices have gone up by almost 5-7 per cent. Copper is stable, but we have seen a lot of volatility in the last 7-8 months. And look at the dollar," he said, hinting at a price rise for final consumers. "We are extending financing to our channel partners to ensure the volumes are not hit," he added. Finolex started with wires and cables, but has emerged as a complete electrical solutions provider with products that include switches, lighting, fans, water heaters, switchgears and new entrant solar cables.

Amit Mathur, President, Sales & Marketing, Finolex Cables

The company makes solar cables using controlled electron e-beam technology and has seen a sharp rise in this business, including orders from solar power giants, such as Tata and Adani, said Mathur. Around 40 per cent of Finolex's revenue comes from the southern region, and 40 per cent out of that comes from Tamil Nadu itself. "Our market share across our products in Tamil Nadu is between 25 and 30 per cent. We have more than 425 channel partners in this State. We have more than 20,000 retail partners associated with us in Tamil Nadu."

"We have seen a good growth in data centers from Tamil Nadu. There is also a lot of infrastructure development happening in this region. We are also supplying to most of the top residential and commercial developers," said Mathur.

With Tamil Nadu a key auto manufacturing hub, Finolex's auto cables are a big seller here, and its 3 Core Flat Cables or submersible pump cables are also popular in the agricultural regions.

Honda tests 0 Alpha in India as ₹1,200 cr EV push gathers pace

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Honda Cars India has begun public road testing of its 0 Alpha electric SUV, a key step in validating the Japanese automaker's ₹1,200 crore investment to manufacture its first locally built electric vehicle at the Tapukara plant in Rajasthan, ahead of the planned launch in 2027.

TOUGH COMPETITION

The model is expected to compete with Maruti Suzuki's e-Vitara, Hyundai Creta EV, Tata Curvv EV and Mahindra's BE-series SUVs, placing Honda in the rapidly expanding mid-size electric SUV segment, where domestic and global manufacturers have already established an early presence.

"The start of pan-India public road verification testing is a key milestone in our electrification journey. India has unique driving and climate conditions, and it is important for us to test our electric vehicle thoroughly in real-world environments," said Takashi Nakajima, President and CEO, Honda Cars India. The prototype, based on Honda's 0 Series born-electric platform, unveiled at the Japan Mobility Show 2025, has entered a pan-India verification programme, which will evaluate the vehicle across highways, city roads and challenging terrains, including extreme summer temperatures and monsoon conditions. The electric SUV will be manufactured at the Tapukara facility, which the company plans to position as a production base for both domestic sales and exports. Industry analysts say the 0 Alpha project represents Honda's first serious push into India's mid-size electric SUV segment, signalling a shift from its earlier hybrid-focused approach to a broader electrification strategy.

BIG PLANS. The electric SUV will be manufactured at Honda's Tapukara facility in Rajasthan

The vehicle is likely to be positioned alongside or above the Honda Elevate in the company's portfolio, with an expected price range of ₹17 lakh to ₹30 lakh (ex-showroom).

Ola Electric seeks ₹2,000 crore via stake sale in battery unit OCT

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Ola Electric has kicked off a plan to raise up to ₹2,000 crore by selling stake in its battery arm, Ola Cell Technologies (OCT), according to sources. OCT owns the Tamil Nadu-based lithium-ion cell manufacturing plant with 1.5 GWh of operational capacity, and plans to scale to 6 GWh by the end of this financial year.

Investment bank Avendus and Motilal Oswal are mandated to run the fund-raising process, sources said.

The development comes amid Ola Electric's efforts to restructure operations and shore up its balance sheet as it works towards its business turnaround.

UNIQUE NATURE

The stake dilution plans will also determine the market valuation of a crucial battery infrastructure asset that has not yet been ascertained, sources said, adding that the asset's unique nature had attracted inbound interest from financial investors, including some leading sovereign wealth funds.

QUICKLY.

'IEA members may release more oil stocks if needed'

Paris: Member countries of the International Energy Agency could release more emergency oil stocks later "as and if needed" as there will still be over 1.4 billion barrels remaining in their emergency oil stocks despite the largest release of reserves in history already agreed, Executive Director Fatih Birol said on Monday. "Despite this huge release, we still have a lot of stocks left," Birol said in a video statement. REUTERS

Changes in FDI norms for border countries notified

New Delhi: The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade on Monday notified changes in the FDI policy to permit overseas companies with Chinese shareholding of up to 10 per cent to invest in India under the automatic route. These investments will be subject to sectoral FDI limits and conditions. However, the relaxed FDI norms will not apply to entities registered in China/Hong Kong or other countries sharing land borders with India. PTI

US allies rebuff Trump's plea for support in Strait of Hormuz

EXERCISING RESTRAINT. Germany, EU, UK cautious; China calls for de-escalation

Reuters
Berlin/Brussels/London

US allies said they had no immediate plans to send ships to unblock the Strait of Hormuz, rebuffing a request by President Donald Trump for military support to keep the vital waterway open.

Trump called on nations to help police the strait after Iran responded to US-Israeli attacks by using drones, missiles and mines to effectively close the strategic channel off its shores for tankers transporting a fifth of global oil supply.

Most NATO countries, several of whom have been at the sharp end of criticism from Trump in recent months, are usually wary of angering the White House but are now signalling reluctance to become embroiled in the conflict with Tehran.

"What does (...) Donald Trump expect a handful or two handfuls of European frigates to do in the Strait of Hormuz that the powerful US navy cannot do?" German Defence Minister Boris Pistorius said in Berlin on Monday, as he downplayed threats by Trump that failing to come to Washington's aid could have consequences for the NATO alliance. "This is not our war, we have not started it," he added.

> This is not our war, we have not started it
>
> **BORIS PISTORIUS,**
> German Defence Minister

The conflict has nothing to do with NATO and Germany has no plans to be drawn into it, government spokesperson Stefan Kornelius said.

"Neither the US nor Israel consulted us before the war, and ... Washington explicitly stated at the outset of the war that European assistance was neither necessary nor desired," the spokesperson said. Still, some allies signalled a cautious willingness to help. EU foreign policy chief Kaja Kallas said the bloc is in talks with the United Nations about replicating a deal that allows for grain to be exported out of Ukraine during its war with Russia.

CHINA IN TALKS

The EU is also discussing whether it could change the mandate of its Middle East naval mission Aspides, which currently protects ships in the Red Sea from attacks by Yemen's Houthi rebel group, to include the Strait of Hormuz, Kallas said.

But Greece, which leads the Aspides mission, will limit its participation in the Middle East to the Red Sea, said government spokesman Pavlos Marinakis.

China is talking with all sides about the strait as it seeks to de-escalate the conflict, its Foreign Ministry said on Monday.

Britain will work with allies on a collective plan to secure freedom of navigation through the strait, Prime Minister Keir Starmer said, while acknowledging that it wouldn't be easy and reiterating the UK would not be drawn into a wider war.

> Britain will work with allies on a collective plan to secure freedom of navigation through the strait
>
> **KEIR STARMER,**
> UK Prime Minister

Denmark said the EU should work to re-open the strait even if it didn't agree with the war.

But other European nations appeared to rule that out. Spain said it would not do anything that could escalate the conflict, while Italian Deputy Prime Minister Matteo Salvini said sending military ships to a war zone would be interpreted as participation in the conflict.

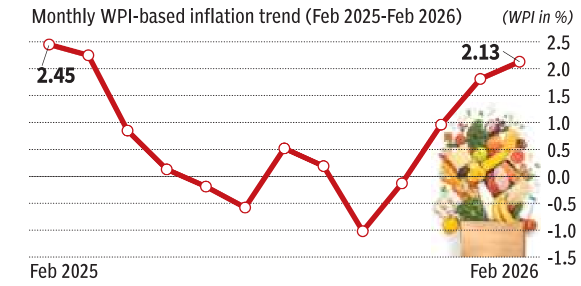
"Italy is not at war with anyone and sending military ships in a war zone would mean entering the war," Salvini told reporters in Milan.

Wholesale inflation jumps to 2.13% in Feb, driven by costlier non-food items

Our Bureau
New Delhi

On the rise

Monthly WPI-based inflation trend (Feb 2025-Feb 2026) *(WPI in %)*



Source: Ministry of Commerce and Industry *Provisional

With a rise in non-vegetable food prices, wholesale inflation based on the Wholesale Price Index (WPI) rose to 2.13 per cent in February, the Industry ministry reported on Monday. This is the fourth successive month of rise.

Wholesale inflation was 1.81 per cent in January.

"Positive rate of inflation in February is primarily due to an increase in prices of other manufacturing, manufacture of basic metals, non-food articles, food articles and textiles, etc.," the Ministry said in a statement.

According to WPI data, inflation in food articles was 2.19 per cent in February, as against 1.55 per cent in the previous month.

VEGETABLES EASE

In vegetables, inflation eased to 4.73 per cent in February against 6.78 per cent in January.

However, pulses, potato and egg, meat and fish saw an uptick in inflation in February over the previous month.

In the case of manufactured products, WPI inflation inched up to 2.92 per cent in February, from 2.86 per cent in the preceding month.

Non-food articles category inflation spiked to 8.8 per cent in February, from 7.58 per cent in January.

Negative inflation, or deflation, continued in the fuel and power basket, at 3.78 per cent in February, *vis-a-vis* 4.01 per cent in January.

It may be noted that the RBI mainly tracks retail inflation for deciding on benchmark interest rates.

HIGHER ENERGY PRICES

According to Rajani Sinha, Chief Economist, CareEdge, it is important to note that the February inflation data do not yet reflect the potential impact of the ongoing conflict in West Asia, which resulted in higher energy prices.

Looking ahead, elevated energy prices are likely to exert upward pressure on WPI inflation as input costs rise.

The impact of elevated energy prices is expected to be more pronounced on WPI compared with CPI, given the higher weight of petroleum, natural gas and mineral oil in the WPI basket (10.4 per cent) relative to the CPI basket (4.8 per cent).

EL NINO RISK

In addition to energy price risks, the increased probability of an El Nino weather event in FY27 could adversely affect food inflation.

Considering these risks, "it will be important to closely monitor geopolitical developments in West Asia and weather-related developments. For FY26, WPI inflation is expected to average 0.6 per cent. Under the baseline scenario, assuming Brent crude prices average between $60-70/bbl, WPI inflation is projected to average around 3.5 per cent in FY27," Sinha said.

Trade talks pause as India waits for new US tariff framework, says official

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

India will wait for the US to create a new global tariff architecture following the US Supreme Court verdict invalidating reciprocal tariffs before signing a trade deal with the country as any pact has to be necessarily based on the comparative tariff structure, a senior official has said.

A deal with the US will also take care of the Section 301 investigations that Washington is carrying out against India, the official added.

COURT RULING

According to the official, the agreement with the US was earlier expected to be signed in March, but the court's decision striking down tariffs imposed under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act (IEEPA) changed the situation. "When the deal was being prepared, the Supreme Court judgment

India wants the trade deal with the US to also take care of the Section 301 investigations

had not come. Now with the judgment, those tariffs *per se* will not exist," the official said.

At present, the US has tariffs of around 10 per cent in place under provisions related to balance-of-payments emergencies (under Section 122), which are applicable for about five months on all countries.

"Any deal that we finalise and sign has to be against the tariff structure or comparative advantage," the official explained. In August 2025, the US imposed a total of 50 per cent additional tariffs on most Indian exports, which have been replaced with the 10 per cent global tariff.

Washington is now working to recreate a global tariff architecture, and India believes it would be more appropriate to sign the agreement once that framework is clearer, the official pointed out. "The deal has already been broadly finalised and decided. The teams will start negotiating to iron out the final details. But the actual signing might be done when the new architecture of tariffs globally is in place," the official said.

SECTION 301

On the US move to initiate fresh trade investigations against several economies, including India, under Section 301, the official said New Delhi had only recently received the notices and was examining them. "These investigations take time. My view is whenever a deal is finalised and signed, this will take care of these Section 301 issues also," the official said. The timing is important because trade agreements are negotiated as part of a broader competitive landscape, the official noted.

Countries assess their tariff advantages and disadvantages not only relative to the partner country but also *vis-à-vis* other competing exporters. "There is no standoff," the official said, adding that India remains ready to proceed whenever the US side is prepared.

The official also referred to developments involving other countries that have stepped back from trade arrangements with Washington after the court ruling.

According to the official, there are two categories of countries in this situation. One group announced framework deals and signed legal agreements. Those countries may now need to recalibrate their arrangements because the agreements were based on the earlier tariff structure, which has since been invalidated.

As India pushes for Hormuz safe transit, Tehran seeks return of seized tankers

Reuters
New Delhi

Iran has asked India to release three tankers seized in February as part of talks seeking the safe passage of Indian-flagged or India-bound vessels out of the Gulf via the Strait of Hormuz, three sources with knowledge of the matter told Reuters.

Indian authorities seized the three Iran-linked tankers near Indian waters, alleging that they had concealed or altered their identities and were involved in illegal ship-to-ship transfers at sea.

Tehran also sought supplies of certain medicines and medical equipment, according to one of the sources, an Iranian official.

Iran's ambassador to New Delhi met Indian Foreign Ministry officials on Monday to discuss the issue, the source said.

The sources declined to be named due to the sensitivity of the matter.

India's Foreign Ministry, the Iranian embassy in New Delhi and Iran's Foreign Ministry did not immediately respond to *Reuters'* requests for comment.

Asked about negotiations to ensure passage for Indian vessels, Foreign Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said on Monday that recent movements reflected a "history of engagement, of dealing with each other".

India said on Monday that at least 22 Indian-flagged vessels and 611 Indian seafarers remained in the Gulf.

An Indian source said six of the vessels were loaded with LPG, and the country was keen for their passage first to ease a shortage of the cooking fuel.

Indian authorities seized the tankers *Asphalt Star*, *Al Jafzia* and *Stellar Ruby*, alleging they had concealed or altered their identity and movements.

Reliance, Grasim, Nirma among firms cleared to pipe treated effluents into sea off Gujarat coast

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

Major industrial units, including Reliance Industries, Grasim Industries, Nirma Ltd, Gujarat Fluorochemicals and GHCL, have received environmental clearances to discharge treated industrial effluents into the Arabian Sea through marine outfall pipelines along the Gujarat coast, with the approved projects permitting over 460 million litres per day (MLD) via pipelines spanning more than 110 km.

The largest among the approvals is the one for Reliance Industries' petrochemical complex at Dahej, which has been permitted to discharge about 63 MLD of treated effluent through an offshore pipeline. Grasim Industries' Indian Rayon unit in Veraval has been cleared to release 27 MLD, while Nirma Ltd's soda ash plant in Bhavnagar has been permitted to discharge 12 MLD.

SIMILAR APPROVALS

Other industrial units granted similar approvals include Gujarat Fluorochemicals Ltd at Dahej, cleared to discharge 3.2 MLD, and GHCL's facilities in Kutch and Gir Somnath, which have been permitted smaller volumes of treated effluent. The details of environmental clearances received during the last five years were shared by Minister of State for Environment, Forest and Climate Change Kirti Vardhan Singh in a written reply in the Rajya Sabha recently.

Apart from individual industrial units, several projects that have received similar clearances relate to common effluent treatment plants (CETPs) serving large industrial clusters. These include Vapi Green Environment Ltd facility, which can discharge 70 MLD through a 29.68-km marine pipeline, and the Sarigam CETP expansion in Valsad district, which allows 25 MLD.

Similarly, in the Petroleum, Chemicals and Petrochemicals Investment Region (PCPIR) at Dahej, a project in the SEZ-II area has been permitted to discharge 80 MLD. Further, a deep-sea disposal pipeline near Porbandar has been cleared to release 80 MLD collected from CETPs located at Jetpur, Bhatgam and Manpur–Derdi, through a pipeline extending about 5.6 km, according to the government's reply.

AP CLEARANCES

A smaller number of projects have also been cleared along the Andhra Pradesh coast, largely linked to pharmaceutical manufacturing units.

> **KEY MANDATE**
>
> According to the Environment Ministry, projects involving marine discharge must undertake marine environmental impact assessments, including biodiversity monitoring and baseline ecological studies

According to the Ministry's reply, five pharma projects in Srikakulam, Visakhapatnam and Kakinada districts have been allowed to discharge treated effluents into the sea. Together, these projects are permitted to release about 13.5 MLD.

According to the Environment Ministry, projects involving marine discharge must undertake marine environmental impact assessments, including biodiversity monitoring and baseline ecological studies, while compliance with Coastal Regulation Zone norms is overseen by the State Coastal Zone Management Authorities.

thehindubusinessline.
TUESDAY - MARCH 17, 2026

Electric kitchens

Centre should drive a shift from LPG to e-stoves

The cooking gas shortage in India caused by the war in Iran has exposed a serious policy lapse. That is, the extreme dependence on imported liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) to fire domestic and industrial kitchens. The country produces just 40 per cent of the cooking gas that it consumes with the rest almost fully coming from the Gulf region.

For a country that has been conscious of its excessive dependence on imported fossil fuels and has taken active policy measures to reduce consumption of petrol and diesel, it is strange that cooking gas went under the radar. A major reason is, of course, the messed up subsidy regime which has made it unattractive for refineries to produce more of the fuel. But there may be an opportunity in the crisis now. Even as the Centre grapples with the shortage now, trying short-term fixes such as asking refineries to divert their propane and butane output to produce cooking gas, the long-term strategy should be to structurally alter the demand dynamics. And that will be to find alternative fuels to fire our kitchens. Electricity is the best alternative. Indian consumers are not new to electric cooking, be it with microwaves or induction stoves. In fact, induction stoves have been flying off the shelves in the last two weeks as consumers seek a safe haven from the cooking gas uncertainty.

The big picture is that electric cooking is better than LPG. An October 2025 study by the Institute for Energy Economics and Financial Analysis points out that even at a unit rate of ₹8, induction cooking is 37 per cent cheaper. This is essentially because it is more efficient; 85 per cent of the energy is directly transferred to the vessel, whereas in the case of LPG 60 per cent escapes into the air. A wholesale shift can be managed, as most households, pan-India, have an electricity connection. To drive the shift, the Centre could consider a limited-period subsidy on quality electric stoves, akin to the one in place for EVs. A policy thrust that involves premier institutions would be well worth the effort — because what is required here is a safe and energy efficient design of e-stoves at affordable prices. Meanwhile, the current rush to pick up such stoves fearing LPG shortage, could spur the supply of sub-standard, unsafe stoves. The Centre should be watchful and manage this transition.

There is, of course, the question of the impact of this shift on power demand. Thermal power capacity utilisation, at 68 per cent, presents enough headroom for increased output. The renewables transition has arrived at a new inflexion point with a drop in battery prices as well as increased storage capacity. Using time-of-use tariffs and linking up the e-stove plan to the solar rooftop scheme will add impetus. In fact, a plan to shift to e-cooking is already in place. The 'National Efficient Cooking Programme', launched in late 2023, has presumably distributed 20 lakh induction stoves. It needs to scale up, with a plan. Finally, every crisis presents an opportunity to be efficient — and the LPG one is no exception.

OTHER VOICES.

GULF NEWS

Defending truth in times of crisis

Modern conflicts are no longer fought only with missiles, drones and military formations. Increasingly, they are waged through narratives, images and digital content designed to shape perceptions and influence public opinion. Recent developments in the region have once again demonstrated this reality. As the UAE faced blatant Iranian aggression targeting its skies, the country's Armed Forces responded with remarkable precision and professionalism, intercepting hostile missiles and unmanned aerial vehicles with exceptional efficiency. Yet alongside the military response, another front was equally important: the information front. The battlefield has expanded into the realm of information, and in that arena, credible media has become one of the most important lines of defence. (DUBAI, MARCH 16)

CHINA DAILY

Tomahawk rips off Tokyo's 'pacifist' mask

Japanese Defence Minister Shinjiro Koizumi announced on Friday the official delivery — for the first time in history — of US Tomahawk cruise missiles and Norwegian-made Joint Strike Missiles to the Self-Defence Forces. This move represents a bold step toward the country's remilitarisation and a challenge to the stability of East Asia and beyond. Japan claims to be pursuing "counterstrike capabilities", a euphemism for the ability to launch pre-emptive attacks on targets in its neighbourhood. This is not defence; it is offence. The Tomahawk missiles, with a range of up to 1,600 kilometres, can reach deep into the territories of Japan's neighbours, and their deployment will likely trigger an arms race. (TOKYO, MARCH 15)

SN ANANTHASUBRAMANIAN
MS SAHOO

Anchoring corporate governance responsibility

BREAK THE SILOS. It is time to harmonise governance roles across laws and regulations to avoid diffusion of accountability

GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Governance systems function best when responsibility converges at a clear centre. Without such clarity, accountability risks dissolving into institutional ambiguity. Yet modern corporate governance frameworks disperse responsibility across boards, committees, executives, and compliance officers. The result is a proliferation of expressions describing those responsible for governance, without clearly identifying where responsibility ultimately rests.

India's corporate governance framework increasingly confronts this challenge. The expression "those charged with governance" (TCWG) illustrates this tension. A relatively recent entrant into the governance lexicon, the phrase carries an appealing air of inclusiveness. It suggests that someone must surely be responsible for oversight while appearing to democratise governance: almost anyone may potentially be charged with governance.

Auditing standards define TCWG as persons responsible for overseeing the strategic direction of the company and its accountability obligations. By this definition, the Board, the Audit Committee, and independent directors may all qualify as TCWG. At the same time, these standards task auditors to identify, at the start of the audit, who precisely constitutes TCWG within a company.

In practice, this task often resembles detective work, requiring auditors to reconstruct lines of authority and oversight from the institutional complexity of modern corporations. Importantly, a framework that seeks to make governance everyone's concern risks producing the opposite effect: when responsibility appears widely dispersed, it may feel like nobody's responsibility.

Part of the difficulty arises from India's layered regulatory landscape. Corporate governance as a discipline emerged within the company-securities law framework, where company law structures internal governance to align the interests of stakeholders, and securities regulation strengthens that structure for listed companies in the interest of investors and market integrity. Together, they constitute the core architecture of corporate governance. Within this architecture, the board represents the apex of governance responsibility.

The Companies Act, 2013 establishes the foundational governance structure for companies. At its apex stands the Board of Directors, entrusted with fiduciary duties and overall stewardship of the company. Beneath the board, the Act identifies Key Managerial Personnel, including the managing director or chief executive officer, the chief financial officer, and the company secretary, who exercise executive authority and carry operational and compliance responsibilities. Board committees, particularly the Audit Committee and the Nomination and Remuneration Committee, support specialised oversight functions. The Act also introduces an "officer who is in default", who bears statutory liability for compliance failures. Together, these provisions create a clear hierarchy of governance responsibility and individual accountability.

ADDITIONAL GOVERNANCE LAYER

For listed companies, securities regulation adds an additional governance layer above company law. These regulations expand the governance framework to include promoters and promoter groups, senior management, and specialised board committees. Significantly, securities regulation has elevated the position of the compliance officer, requiring that the role be placed not more than one level below the board.

The prominence of the compliance officer reflects an important evolution in the understanding of governance. In modern corporate systems, effective governance requires both oversight and operational enforcement. The compliance officer increasingly functions as the custodian of governance discipline within the organisation, ensuring regulatory

Different regulators will inevitably tailor governance structures to their specific objectives. What is needed, however, is conceptual alignment around a clear centre of responsibility

compliance, validating disclosures, and serving as the interface between the company and regulators. In effect, the board provides strategic supervision, and the compliance officer operationalises the discipline of governance.

Over time, other governance frameworks, whether in financial reporting oversight or sector-specific regulation, have begun constructing parallel vocabularies of responsibility rather than building upon this foundation. Each framework identifies its own set of functionaries and institutions responsible for governance. The terminology differs, the scope varies, and the attribution of liability may shift depending on the governing framework. The result is a fragmented language of governance in which responsibility appears dispersed across regulatory silos.

This company-securities law architecture provides a coherent hierarchy of responsibility. The board exercises strategic oversight; executive management runs the enterprise; specialised officers ensure compliance and governance discipline. The difficulty arises when other regulatory frameworks develop their own governance terminology without clearly anchoring it in this architecture. Auditing standards speak of TCWG. Sectoral regulators prescribe roles such as chief compliance officers, principal officers, or appointed actuaries. These roles serve legitimate regulatory purposes, but their relationship to the underlying governance structure is not always clearly articulated.

The consequence is a proliferation of expressions — board, management, senior management, key managerial personnel, compliance officer, officer in default, and TCWG — that often refer to overlapping responsibilities but carry different legal implications.

Companies must navigate this patchwork when mapping accountability across regulatory regimes, while regulators must determine liability based on framework-specific definitions.

The solution does not lie in imposing identical terminology across all regulatory regimes. Different regulators will inevitably tailor governance structures to their specific objectives. What is needed, however, is conceptual alignment around a clear centre of responsibility. That centre already exists in the company-securities law framework. Other regulatory frameworks should build upon this structure. Where governance roles already exist within this framework, regulators should recognise and adopt them rather than create parallel designations.

Anchoring governance responsibility in this architecture would yield several benefits. It would significantly reduce interpretational ambiguity, simplify compliance mapping across regulatory frameworks, and strengthen the attribution of accountability. More importantly, it would restore clarity to corporate governance by ensuring that responsibility ultimately converges where the law intends it to reside.

India's corporate governance ecosystem has evolved significantly through reforms in company law, securities regulation, and financial reporting oversight. Yet the language used to describe governance responsibility has become increasingly fragmented. Harmonising this language by building upon the foundations of the company-securities law framework would not merely simplify regulatory design. It would strengthen the architecture of accountability itself.

Corporate governance must ultimately answer a simple question: who is responsible? A coherent regulatory framework must ensure that the answer is not scattered across statutes and regulators but anchored clearly within the governance structure of the company.

Ananthasubramanian is former President, and Sahoo is former Secretary, ICSI

Why a transition to natural farming is a necessity

We cannot easily control conflicts, wars or energy markets. But we can definitely redesign how we grow food

PVS Suryakumar

Human civilisation rests on a simple foundation: the ability to grow healthy and nutritious food reliably. That foundation is now under growing strain.

A disruption in energy or fertilizer markets can ripple through food systems faster than policy can respond. Modern agriculture is tightly linked to fossil fuels, global supply chains and ecological services — and when these links weaken, livelihoods and health suffer first.

The Fuel to Fork analysis by IPES-Food [2024/25] estimates that food systems consume nearly 40 per cent of petrochemicals and about 15 per cent of fossil fuels globally, tying every plate to volatile energy markets. The world is beginning to acknowledge this reality and must now find a way forward.

The system's industrial dependence compounds the risk. Analyses by Vaclav Smil and FAO suggest that about 40 per cent of global dietary protein intake depends on synthetic nitrogen fertilizer made via the energy intensive Haber-Bosch process. When energy tightens, fertilizer costs rise — and food prices follow. Current urea prices are already elevated (around $585/tonne), with analysts warning of $650-700/tonne under extended stress. Trade concentration amplifies this. According to Kpler's trade data (2024), over two-thirds of India's ammonia and sulphur imports originate in the Gulf region. So regional shocks quickly tighten global availability.

The scientific picture is also plain. The IPCC warns that, intensifying heat and shifting rainfall are already shortening growing windows. In India this is tangible: recent temperature spikes have lowered wheat yields in affected districts, and higher night-time temperatures reduce rice grain filling — material threats where wheat and rice anchor food security.

Given these multiple uncertainties, India's cropping patterns will need gradual diversification. Pulses, oilseeds and millets offer nutritional and ecological advantages, though consumer acceptance, processing ecosystems and agronomic adaptation will determine how far and how fast such shifts occur.

Ecological and health signals deepen the alarm. Global assessments (IPCC-AR6, IPBES, FAO) show biodiversity loss, pollinator declines and soil degradation are eroding ecological services destabilising yields. Public-health reviews (WHO) are increasingly concerned about chemical

HEALTHY FOOD. Reducing chemical use in agriculture is key

exposures and rising non-communicable diseases. These are not separate problems: degraded soils and chemical-laden foods undermine both production and public health.

A sensible policy is neither one of panic, nor prohibition. A disciplined and financed transition — phased across crops, regions and over time — can reduce dependency while protecting farmers' welfare.

FOR A CREDIBLE TRANSITION

This has to be practical and subtle. First, improve nutrient-use efficiency and replace part of the input mix with biological alternatives where they are ready to deploy.

Second, fund public agricultural research on soil health, microbial partnerships and cropping systems that integrate trees, livestock and legumes and back it with extension. Third, redesign subsidies and procurement to reward soil health, improved soil carbon, biodiversity, and ecosystem services.

Finally, build markets and supply chains that pay for the public goods produced by ecological agriculture, so farmers who make the transition are not left isolated and unpaid for their stewardship.

India's embrace of natural farming can anchor this agenda and can be strategically phased temporally and spatially. Natural farming — with R&D, extension, assured markets and transition finance — can organically scale without forcing risky, abrupt change on farmers.

Gradually reducing chemical dependence in agriculture will make our food systems more resilient and healthier for both people and nature.

We cannot easily control conflicts, wars or energy markets. But we can definitely redesign how we grow food. If institutional incentives, research and markets align behind resilient, ecological farming, we will reduce fragility where it matters most — at the soil and at the plate.

The writer is former Deputy Managing Director, NABARD. Views are personal

LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Americans must wake up

This refers to 'Tariff war 2.0' (March 16). Fighting a losing battle can affect the thought process of even a seasoned soldier. Trump is not one. And, he is alone in the crowd. That makes him desperate and he starts opening more war fronts, like filing suits and disturbing peace in other geographies by casual handling of obsolete punitive provisions of tariffs, etc. When things backfire, this President has nowhere to get sane advice as he has already created more enemies around him than he can handle. In their own interest, Americans should wake up and restore sanity in governance.

MG Warrier
Mumbai

Prudent trade strategy

Frequent tariff probes and shifting rules weaken confidence in trade agreements. Countries may hesitate to commit when terms change suddenly. This uncertainty may also affect long-term supply chains and investment decisions. India's cautious approach in negotiations therefore appears sensible. Protecting interests in agriculture, data security, and intellectual property remains important. At the same time, steady engagement with partners should continue. Stable and predictable trade rules are essential for healthy global commerce.

S Balasubramaniyan
Villupuram, TN

Reckless foreign policy

The 'The US' global misadventures' (March 16) rightly exposes how power, profit and public apathy fuel reckless US foreign policy. For India, the lesson is urgent: stop romanticising dependency. A stronger dollar inflates our oil and gold bills, hurting ordinary citizens. India must respond with energy self-reliance, deeper strategic reserves, wider rupee trade, and policies that curb excessive gold dependence. Sovereignty is not a slogan; it is economic preparedness. Washington will protect itself. India must protect India.

Arul Mozhi Varman
Sivakasi, TN

Fiscal health of States

The recent Fiscal Health Index released by NITI Aayog highlights a deepening divergence in the financial resilience of States. To restore fiscal health, States must enhance their own tax-capacity by broadening the GST base, and rationalise non-merit subsidies to reduce the revenue deficit. Most importantly, governments must adopt multi-year frameworks to stabilise debt rather than rely on annual ad-hoc populist measures. Strengthening fiscal governance at the State level is a prerequisite for sustainable and inclusive growth.

Madhvi Sharma
Chandigarh

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Nervous Republicans

The Middle East war is causing anxiety within GoP

Sridhar Krishnaswami

War by any other name is still war.

And no amount of spin from either US President Donald Trump or any of his top advisors seems to be working. Republican members of Congress in both the House of Representatives and Senate are getting jittery as to how the war in the Middle East, that started on February 28 with Israel and the US dropping missiles and bombs on Iran, is going to end.

So far there have been little indication, from the administration apart from a raft of rants of how things are going to get worse for Tehran. And Iran has met all this with indignation and defiance.

According to a Quinnipac University national poll taken a week after the start of operations, a majority of voters are opposed to the strikes with higher numbers against induction of ground troops into Iran and a significant 75 per cent believing that the American military action against Tehran will lead to a terrorist attack on the US. If 53 per cent of those polled oppose the military action, only 40 per cent support it; and this is along partisan lines with Republican support at 85 per cent and Democratic opposition close to 90 per cent.

But the significant message to the Grand Old Party is that 60 per cent of Independents are opposed to Washington's military attack. As the polling analyst for the University, Tim Malloy, put it, "Voters are unenthusiastic about the air attack on Iran and there is overwhelming opposition to putting American troops on Iranian soil to fight a ground war".

Iran has faced the brunt of the damage including casualties including the outrageous hit on a girls school resulting in the death of an estimated 100, now being fobbed off on "old" intelligence. But Republican law makers are nervously watching how the administration responds to hunting down some 400-odd kg of Uranium stockpile said to be inside Iran.

Apart from clamour for getting Congressional approval to put boots on the ground, law makers still have memories of Iraq and the hunt for Saddam Hussein's weapons of mass destruction with inspectors coming back empty handed.

In the case of the so-called Iranian stockpile, few will be nursing the illusion that the operation will be a quick entry-exit scenario.

IRAN WAR. Causing disquiet VIA REUTERS

OIL WORRIES

At this time, Republican anxiety does not lie in the potential return of body bags. It is in the implication of an expanding conflict in the Middle East that has already started taking its toll on oil prices.

The restrictions imposed for the Strait of Hormuz aside, Iran is said to have mined the waters, while also resorting to occasional hits on tankers braving the hostile environment.

All this have led to a spurt in oil prices that is being reflected in the pumps in the US. Trump's decision to suspend sanctions against Russian oil and the International Energy Association's decision to release 400 million barrels as an emergency measure have hardly calmed markets where the price of crude still tops $100.

Even as it is, record numbers of Republicans are leaving the House of Representatives and not seeking re-election in November. And Republicans incumbents in the House and Senate are facing strong challenges at the primaries that are in full swing, putting pressure on funds that would normally be spent fighting Democrats at showdown time.

The party leadership is facing the music not only at the national level, but at the state level too. The pressure has intensified for the party, especially in the red-states where the GOP has taken hits recently, to maintain their super-majorities for legislations to pass in the face of a veto by the Governors.

The political problem is rather acute for the GOP leadership that does not seem to be satisfied with the numbers of missiles and bombs that Iran faces daily or in the number of sorties flown by jet fighters.

The writer is a senior journalist who has reported from Washington DC on North America and UN

Oil shock's impact on India's BoP

Oil shortages and price spike triggered by US-Israel war on Iran will hit India harder given its integration into global oil markets

MACROSCAN.

CP CHANDRASHEKHAR, JAYATI GHOSH

Uncertainty and shortages have roiled India's oil markets following the unwarranted bombings of Iranian civilian and military targets launched by the United States and Israel and Iran's predictable response to that unprovoked attack.

With India heavily reliant on oil imports and anywhere between 30 and 40 per cent of its crude imports and 80-90 per cent of its liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) imports sourced from and transiting through the Gulf region, the impact the war is having on the physical supply of oil and LPG and the prices of those supplies is a major shock to the economy.

Globally the war has shaken the world's oil markets for multiple reasons. First, the bombing of Iran threatens to shut down its oil production facilities for quite some time. Since Iran hosts a large oil reserve and was a major supplier to global markets till US sanctions were imposed on the country, that consequence does influence calculations of long-run supply and can therefore impact oil price trends.

Second, since Iran's response includes shutting off the Strait of Hormuz that is the easiest and most cost-effective route to service anywhere between a fifth and close to a third of the world's gas and oil demand, the impact on global supply is immediate. More so because the targets of Iran's retaliation include oil facilities in many oil- and gas-exporting Gulf states, which are seen as implicitly or explicitly facilitating US-Israeli aggression.

Third, large trading firms, like Vitol, Trafigura, Glencore and Gunvor, which are not necessarily large oil producers, dominate the global physical trade in oil, and are known to be secretive speculators for profit in commodity markets. This concentrated trade and speculation leads to an amplified impact of the war on oil prices, far beyond what is warranted by any supply shortfall. This speculative impact is highlighted by the huge volatility that oil prices have displayed around a rising trend.

Finally, this dominance of speculators means that any effort to redress demand-supply imbalances, as is sought to be done through the release from strategic reserves of 400 million barrels of oil by the members of the International Energy Agency, only sends out a signal that the crisis is serious and intensifies speculative activity. So long as uncertainty prevails, oil prices would soar to levels way beyond the so-called $100 psychological barrier.

IMPACT ON INDIA

The impacts from these consequences transmit to the Indian economy through multiple routes. Given India's import dependence for crude and gas, there is already talk of shortages that would affect, among others, households using LPG and oil-based means of transportation, truckers, and farmers using oil based fertilizers.

The rise in the price of a universal intermediate like oil would trigger "imported" inflation both because of the rise in the dollar price of oil and the depreciation of the rupee it precipitates. And the current account of India's balance of payments, crucial to sustaining the 'confidence' of foreign financial investors, which has been shored up by remittances and receipts from IT and IT-enabled services exports, will be hit by falling remittance inflows and a widening trade deficit.

Chart I illustrates the relationship between the price of India's oil import bill and the price of the Indian basket of crude (a weighted average of Oman, Dubai and Brent crude prices). The import bill has clearly been driven primarily by the average import price, with some signs of divergence. Since import data are yet to be released, the impact of the recent spike is yet to show itself, though a sharp rise is inevitable.

> **The rise in the price of a universal intermediate like oil would trigger "imported" inflation** both because of the rise in the dollar price of oil and the depreciation of the rupee it precipitates

That rise can be damaging because India's aggregate imports have risen at a much faster rate than its oil imports since the end of the Covid pandemic (Chart 2). Clearly non-oil imports, including imports of non-necessities such as gold, have been rising, not least because of continuous liberalisation in the import trade and the associated reductions in import tariffs. A sharp rise in the oil import bill will only add to the vulnerability resulting from that longer term tendency.

TRADE BALANCE IMPACT

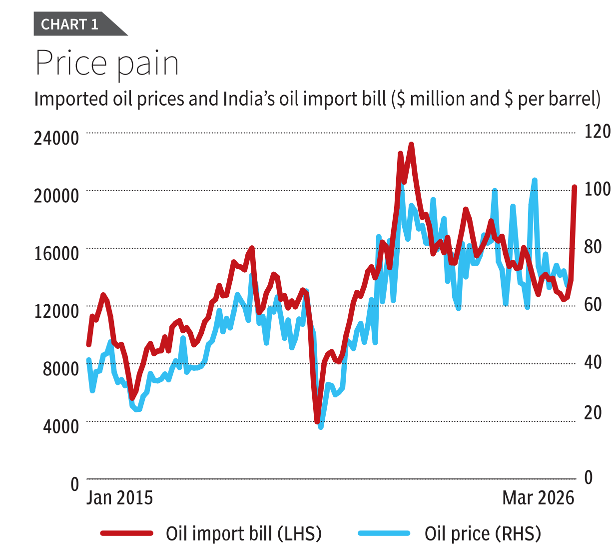
In the past there had been one factor mitigating the impact of oil import dependence on India's trade balance. With excess refinery capacity, India has been exporting refined products manufacture with imported crude, generating export revenues from its oil sector. In fact, as Chart 3 shows, the rise in imports of oil and products has been closely followed by export revenues in that category.

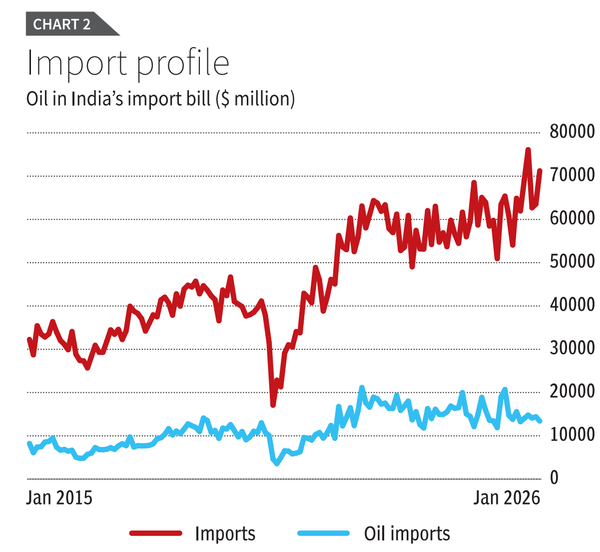
Given value addition through refining in India, the export revenues generated from these related oil imports would be large than the value of those imports. So, the deterioration in the oil trade balance following the pandemic would have been greater than reflected in Chart 3 if these exports had not occurred.

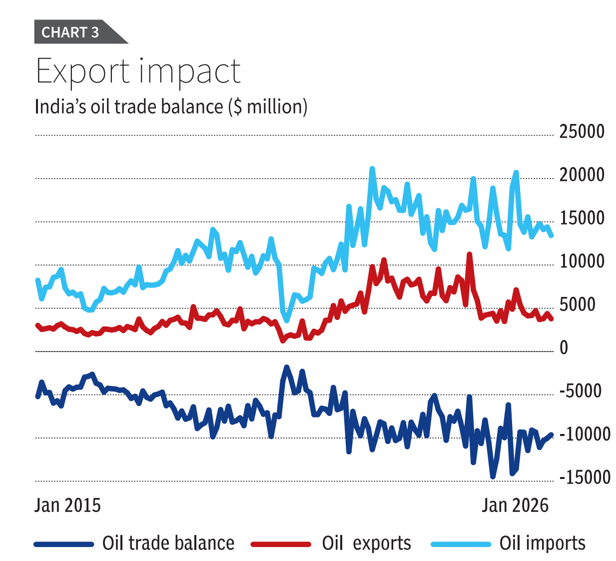
But, given the current loss of physical access to crude imports, the Indian government would possibly retain available imported supplies for domestic consumption, adversely affecting the export of refined products from private facilities. This would mean that the influence of the widening import bill on the oil trade balance would be significantly higher and the deterioration in the balance of payments larger.

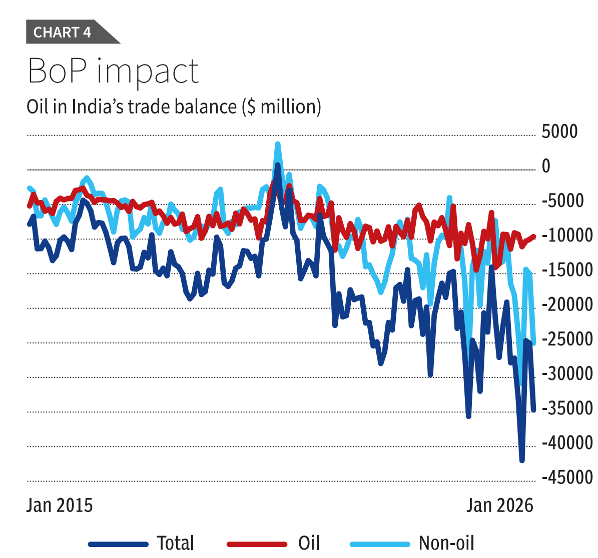
The significance of this for the balance of trade comes through from Chart 4 which presents the relative roles of the oil and non-oil trade balances in determining India's overall trade balance. Much of the post-pandemic deterioration in the trade balance was on account of the worsening of the non-oil trade balance, with oil contributing only marginally to that downturn. That would change now, with adverse consequences.

In sum, the fact that the oil crisis, precipitated by the unwarranted attack on Iran, is resulting in both a physical shortage of supply as well as a spike in prices, would amplify its adverse effects on India's balance of payments, given the nature of its integration into global oil markets.









thehindu**businessline.**

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

March 17, 2006

Goldman Sachs plans to invest $1 b in India

Goldman Sachs, the US based global investment bank, on Thursday announced that it would make investments of $1 billion (about Rs 4,500 crore) in private equity, real estate, private wealth management, and other businesses in India for its institutional clients in the next couple of years as part of its new strategy for the country.

Govt questions Cairn's reserve claims

The Directorate-General of Hydrocarbons (DGH) has questioned the UK-based Cairn Energy's claims on the estimated in-place reserves in the Rajas than block. The company, which has said that it may sell between 25 per cent and 80 per cent of its shares in its Indian business through an IPO, has estimated that in-place oil in its Rajasthan exploration block exceeds 3.5 billion barrels.

I-T staff walk out over large taxpayer units plan

Income-Tax Department employees today staged a walk out across the country against the Centre's move to set up large taxpayer units (LTPUs). A section of non-gazetted employees also threatened to go on an indefinite strike by the end of the monthover the issue.

Gulf oil behemoths deepen output cuts as Hormuz stays blocked

Salma El Wardany
Fiona MacDonald

The United Arab Emirates and Kuwait reduced oil output further as the effective closure of the Strait of Hormuz increases pressure on major producers with the Iran war stretching into its third week.

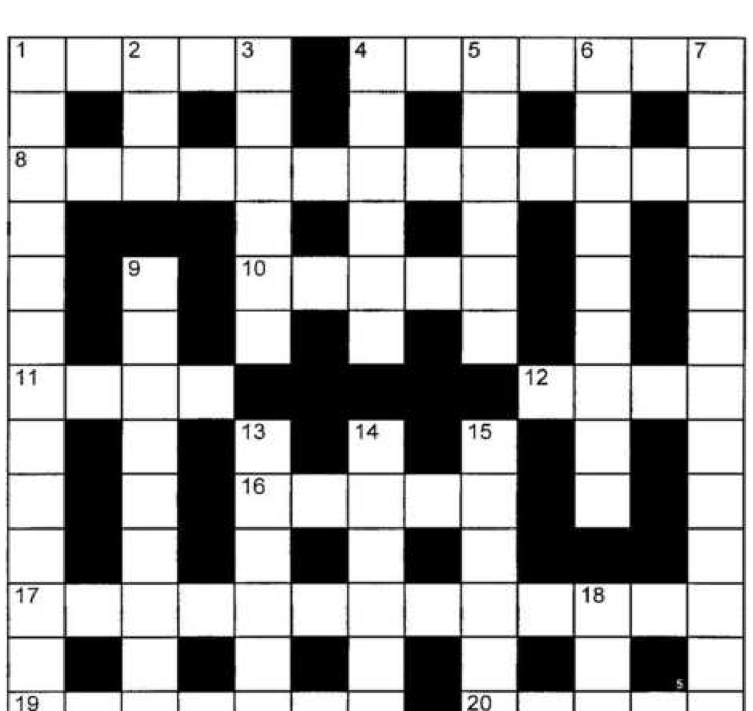
The UAE's production cut has deepened to about 1.5 million barrels a day, from 500,000 to 800,000 a day as of March 10, while Kuwait's has increased to near 1.3 million a day from half a million about a week ago, people familiar with the matter said, asking not to be identified because the data isn't public. Output cuts are rippling across the Gulf even as Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates race to boost exports through alternative routes to bypass Hormuz. While some producers are also preemptively curtailing supply to delay the point at which they'd be forced to stop completely, the longer the war goes on the more time it will take take to bring output back to normal levels.

Saudi Arabia's output was down by 2 million to 2.5 million barrels a day as of a week ago, while Iraq's was down by about 2.9 million a day as the Hormuz crunch fills up storage, according to people familiar with the matter. Riyadh has been diverting millions of barrels to its export terminals on the Red Sea coast, allowing it to avoid the Strait of Hormuz.

The UAE, which has a bypass pipeline of its own, is also switching barrels away from the waterway. Its key oil port of Fujairah in the Gulf of Oman has come under increased drone attacks, causing brief halts in loadings.

BLOOMBERG

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2638



EASY

ACROSS

01. Plain face, plinth at foot (5)
04. Be worthy of (7)
08. Very small, cannot be discerned (13)
10. African river (5)
11. Be ahead (4)
12. Pinion (4)
16. Component, part (5)
17. Quality of being incapable of error (13)
19. Tape-like trimming, binding (7)
20. One under age (5)

DOWN

01. Sparkling (13)
02. Policeman; capture (3)
03. Commission involving short journey (6)
04. Sift flour, sugar etc over (6)
05. Humorous criticism of folly etc (6)
06. Revolt (9)
07. Evensong (7,6)
09. Very lovely (9)
13. Greek sun-god (6)
14. Military force (6)
15. Irksomeness (6)
18. Hostelry (3)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

01. Plain plinth comes close to being destroyed (5)
04. To merit being half made to do time in the army (7)
08. Will not be noticed as receipt be : limp form, instead (13)
10. River one might ignore, nothing being missing (5)
11. Top singer in Heavy Metal lookalike (4)
12. Part of large house at the side of the stage (4)
16. Portion of crusty dish and cabbage first and last (5)
17. With which one won't be let down with ability to fill in so (13)
19. Binding material will go on when everything is inside it (7)
20. One in the norm is wrong to be of lesser import (5)

DOWN

01. Sparkling with icing : all tints can be provided (13)
02. Constable starts canvas over primer (3)
03. Make a mistake, also find what may be run (6)
04. Medical man is on the brink and will dig it up from bed (6)
05. It takes off as it re-assembles (6)
06. Revolt of the East, ill borne out (9)
07. Late service given near pyre built for it (7,6)
09. Very lovely it may be, but a fuel one might use in pieces (9)
13. Sun-god got it all wrong : work came to nothing (6)
14. A lot of Roman soldiers, their name being beyond numbering (6)
15. Monotony could make it die in one's belly (6)
18. Where one may be entertained at home with television finally (3)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2637

ACROSS 1. Chair 4. Special 8. Monograph 9. Lot 10. Entered 12. Once 14. Curtain 17. AWOL 18. Regalia 20. Ill 21. Challenge 23. Endless 24. Resit

DOWN 1. Commemorative 2. Agnate 3. Rigorous 4. Spa 5. Echo 6. Island 7. Letters-patent 11. Deter 13. Singular 15. Boiled 16. Flanks 19. Acre 22. Ass

For BSE/NSE live quotes, scan the QR code or click the link https://bit.ly/2FpossK

QUICKLY.

SEBI eases SGF norms for commodity exchanges

Mumbai: SEBI has eased settlement guarantee fund (SGF) norms for commodity exchanges. It has introduced a new provision which states that SEBI, after due deliberation, may grant exemptions or relaxations from the strict enforcement of the provisions in the commodity derivatives segment, on a case-to-case basis. Based on representations from stakeholders, recommendations of the Risk Management Review Committee and public comments received, SEBI has also modified the provisions contained in respect to Coverage of SGF and Standardised Stress Testing for Commodity Derivatives. Clearing Corporations will calculate the credit exposure due to simultaneous default of at least three (two earlier) clearing members causing highest credit exposure, it said. OUR BUREAU

Sagar Cements to sell 7.24% in Andhra Cements

Hyderabad: Sagar Cements will sell up to about 66.76 lakh equity shares of face value of ₹10 each, equivalent to 7.24 per cent of the total issued equity share capital of Andhra Cements through offer for sale (OFS). The proposed shares of Andhra Cements, a subsidiary of the Hyderabad-based company, are for achieving minimum public shareholding, Sagar Cements informed the BSE on Monday. Sagar Cement's share lost 2.05 per cent on the BSE to end at ₹171.60. OUR BUREAU

Sensex, Nifty rebound, but war premium keeps markets on edge

NOT ALL HUNKY DORY. Advance-decline ratio remains bearish; 907 stocks hit new 52-week lows

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

The benchmark indices staged a sharp recovery on Monday, erasing early losses to close firmly in the green, even as the spectre of an escalating US-Iran conflict continued to hover over global markets. The Sensex surged 939 points to close at 75,502.85, while the Nifty 50 gained 258 points to settle at 23,408.80 after briefly touching a session low of 22,955.

The recovery was anything but smooth. Both indices spent much of the morning in negative territory before a sharp buying surge after 2 pm turned the tide. "Bulls finally cheered with relief rally on Monday... Sharp buying that emerged after 2 pm led to a sharp bounce back in Nifty to close near the highs," said Nagaraj Shetti, Senior Technical Research Analyst, HDFC Securities. He, however, cautioned that the underlying broader trend of Nifty remains weak and "the market is still not out of woods," with a crucial overhead resistance at 23,500-23,600.

MAJOR WINNERS. Among Nifty gainers, UltraTech Cement led the pack, surging 4.46 per cent, followed by Grasim Industries, Mahindra & Mahindra, Eternal and Trent REUTERS

CAUTIOUS TIMES

Market breadth on the BSE told a more cautious story — of 4,537 stocks traded, only 1,509 advanced while 2,860 declined, and 907 stocks hit fresh 52-week lows against just 81 at 52-week highs.

Among Nifty gainers, UltraTech Cement led the pack, surging 4.46 per cent, followed by Grasim Industries (3.44 per cent), Mahindra & Mahindra (3.34 per cent), Eternal (3.16 per cent) and Trent (2.68 per cent). On the losing side, Bharat Electronics fell 2.48 per cent, Max Healthcare (-2.32 per cent), Wipro (-1.79 per cent), Coal India (-1.71 per cent) and ONGC (-1.51 per cent). Auto and financial stocks carried the recovery, while oil & gas and realty remained under pressure.

India VIX cooled 4.47 per cent to settle at 21.63, offering some relief, though it remains elevated above 20.

The session was shaped significantly by the ongoing US-Iran conflict now entering its third week.

NEXT TRIGGERS

"Supply chain disruptions stemming from the Iran conflict are increasingly viewed as re-inflationary, prompting markets to scale back expectations of policy easing," noted Kaynat Chainwala, AVP Commodity Research, Kotak Securities. Precious metals may remain soft in the near term, with the upcoming FOMC meeting and US PPI data the next key triggers to watch.

The broader picture, however, offers some perspective for long-term investors. "Periods of uncertainty often create opportunities for those who remain invested and take a long-term view," Narender Singh, Founder of Growth Investing and smallcase Manager, said.

SEBI to harmonise roles of MF distributors, investment advisers

Our Bureau
Mumbai

SEBI will review the regulatory framework governing mutual fund distributors (MFDs) and address overlaps with investment advisers (IAs), and is also preparing a common advertisement code and a digital compliance platform for advisers.

Speaking at ARIA Aspire 2026, SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said the regulator has set up a working group to examine the current framework and harmonise any overlap between the two intermediary segments. "A working group has been set up to review the extant regulatory framework of MF distributors and harmonise overlap, if any, between MFDs and IAs," he said.

The move comes as the regulator looks to strengthen the investment advisory ecosystem and ensure clearer regulatory boundaries between advisory and distribution models.

Pandey said SEBI is also preparing a common advertisement code for all intermediaries to improve consistency in communication with investors. "A common advertisement code for all intermediaries is being prepared. This should reduce operational challenges and

SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey

improve consistency," he said.

"A digital platform — SEBI SETU — is being developed to provide simple and end-to-end regulatory guidance from registration to ongoing compliance for IAs," Pandey said.

LIGHT-TOUCH PENALTY

The regulator is also working on a simplified penalty framework for IAs to encourage compliance. "A standardised light-touch penalty structure for IAs is being worked out. This should promote compliance while ensuring transparency and fairness," he said.

India's investment advisory ecosystem is undergoing a transition, with a shift toward more institutional entities. "Today, there are around 1,000 registered IAs — 470 individuals and 530 non-individuals," he said, adding that the move toward non-individual entities indicates a more institutional ecosystem.

At the same time, the number of registered advisers has declined in recent years even as the investor base continues to expand. "That is a matter of concern that the number of registered IAs has declined since 2021. As India's investor base expands rapidly, our market needs more regulated advisers," Pandey said.

He said that the gap could be filled by unregulated voices on social media.

"This is undesirable. It distorts investor behavior, weakens discipline and erodes trust," Pandey said.

IT firms' m-cap slumps up to 42% amid AI fears

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

India's three largest IT services companies — Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), Infosys and Wipro — have seen their market capitalisation (m-cap) shrink sharply over the past five years, lagging the Nifty IT Index, as they grapple with softer deal making, rise of artificial intelligence (AI) and growth moderation.

Data from Tracxn shows the m-cap of large IT firms declined between 2021 and March 2026, with TCS' valuation falling the most in absolute terms. Its m-cap dropped 36 per cent to ₹9.08 lakh crore in March 2026 from ₹14.27 lakh crore in 2021.

Wipro recorded the steepest percentage decline among the big three, with its m-cap contracting 42 per cent amid muted financial performance and softer deal bookings in recent quarters. During the same period, the Nifty IT Index has appreciated 8.86 per cent. However, Tech Mahindra and HCL Technologies bucked the trend, with their m-cap increasing 14-18 per cent.

In recent times, TCS has undertaken investments towards AI transformation such as the ₹18,000-crore joint investment with TPG towards its data centre plans. However, most IT service provider stocks have been hit following the exaggerated response to Claude Cowork developments, Titus M, Practice Director, Everest Group, told *businessline*.

"While the impact is real, it will not replace providers like TCS; in fact, in the long run, it will increase the role of such providers," he said.

TCS' m-cap has fallen mainly because of de-rating, after trading at a premium during the post-Covid tech boom. As growth slowed and AI disruption fears increased,

IT cos market cap
(in ₹ lakh crore)

Company	2021	2025	2026 (Mar)
TCS	14.27	11.60	9.08
Infosys	7.43	6.22	5.25
Wipro	3.64	2.35	2.11
HCL Tech	3.12	4.00	3.67
Tech M	1.19	1.50	1.36

investors stopped paying that high multiple, Rajesh Palviya, SVP-Research, Axis Securities, said.

TECHM STRATEGY

Experts attributed Tech Mahindra's performance to its new leadership and focused AI transformation. In recent years, Tech Mahindra improved its performance through margin recovery and sharper execution, especially under its turnaround initiative, Project Fortius.

It has reduced costs, improved its employee pyramid, cut subcontractor dependence and become more disciplined in choosing deals. Besides, it has focused more on AI-led transformation, telecom modernisation, engineering services and cloud opportunities. "The change in direction and improvement in business quality have helped it gain attention to the company," he said.

HCL TECH SHOW

Meanwhile, HCL Tech is reaping the benefits of setting up a more diversified business mix compared to its peers with a strong exposure to Engineering and R&D services, software business.

It has also delivered relatively better growth, maintained healthy margins and shown clearer traction in AI-led opportunities. This enables investors to bet on long-term growth of the company, said Palviya.

Titus expects overall market to remain strained in the next six months until AI opportunities manifest into revenues for these companies.

PhonePe defers IPO plans due to geopolitical tensions

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

Walmart-backed digital payments firm PhonePe has deferred its plans to go public, citing heightened geopolitical tensions and volatility in global capital markets.

"We sincerely hope for a swift return to peace in all the affected regions. We remain committed to a public listing in India," said Sameer Nigam, CEO, PhonePe, adding that the company will resume the listing process once there is greater stability in global markets.

The Bengaluru-based fintech had received approval from SEBI earlier this year for its initial public offering.

discussions. The decision to pause the listing comes amid escalating geopolitical tensions, including the ongoing conflict involving Iran, Israel and the US, which has rattled global financial markets and reduced risk appetite among investors.

Backed by retail giant Walmart, PhonePe is among India's largest digital payments platforms.

The company commands around 45 per cent share of transactions on the Unified Payments Interface network, ahead of rival Google Pay, which holds roughly 35 per cent share.

WAR IMPACT

The offering was expected to raise around $1.3 billion through an offer-for-sale and value the company at roughly $10 billion, according to people aware of the

Coal India arm's IPO opens on Friday at ₹163-172

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Coal India's subsidiary Central Mine Planning & Design Institute (CMPDIL) has fixed a price band of ₹163-172 a share for its initial public offering that will open for subscription on March 20 and close on March 24. Investors can bid for a minimum of 80 shares.

The issue is entirely an offer for sale of up to 10.71 crore shares by Coal India. The shares will be listed on the BSE and the NSE.

Not more than 50 per cent of the net offer will be allocated to qualified institutional buyers, while non-institutional investors and retail investors will be allotted not less than 15 per cent and 35 per cent, respectively.

CMPDIL has also reserved up to 53.6 lakh shares for employees, who will receive a discount of ₹8 a share on the final price. Up to 1.071 crore shares have been reserved for eligible shareholders.

BROKER'S CALL.

ICICI Securities

KFIN TECHNOLOGIES (BUY)
Target: ₹1,050
CMP: ₹902.35

We have liked KFIN Technologies (KFIN) for its business growth potential based on its core Indian MF RTA operations, alongside likely traction in international business (buoyed by acquisitions/partnerships), alternatives, and corporate registry. New wins, organic and inorganic product suites across fund accounting, transfer agency and new segments such as wealth management have helped KFIN achieve continued client wins.

Earnings may moderate owing to: Periodic cuts in yields, mostly following notable growth in client AUMs as seen in FY25; and cost inflation, which is being managed through automation and efficiency. Diversification and continuous investment in technology remain two strategic pillars to optimise growth and profitability.

The investment thesis remains: Continued strong growth in Indian MF, also aided by steps like new asset class launch by SEBI; strong outlook in corporate issuer business; and high growth potential in existing international and AIF business. Partnership with Blackrock's Aladdin provider network and recent acquisition of Ascent are available growth levers.

We value KFIN basis a 35x multiple (earlier 38x) on FY28E EPS of 30 and arrive at TP of ₹1,050 (earlier ₹1,180). The lower multiple factors in full consolidation of Ascent's financials, even though it currently owns only 51 per cent and plans to own about 67 per cent by FY28E. Key risks include cut in MF yields with size.

Axis Securities

FEDERAL BANK (BUY)
Target: ₹290
CMP: ₹260.85

Federal Bank (FB) continues to prioritise NIM improvement, supported by growth in the chosen mid-yielding segments and realigning the liability mix with focus on CASA deposits, primarily CA deposits. Growth in the mid-yielding portfolio tends to result in slightly higher credit costs vs the lower-yielding segments, while adequately compensating with better yields. FB has guided for credit costs to be contained between 55 bps and 60 bps in FY26.

It continues to witness strong traction in the focus segments and will continue to drive growth momentum as it exits FY26. The bank has seen a growth pick-up in Q3 following a muted performance over H1, and the outlook around growth continues to remain encouraging.

We expect FB's RoA improvement to 1.3-1.4 per cent over FY27-28E, compared with a relatively subdued 1.1 per cent in FY26E, supported by healthy risk-adjusted credit growth, margin improvement levers playing out with portfolio mix shift towards better-yielding segments and lower CoF, strong deposit franchise with improving CASA mix, strengthened fee income profile, and stable asset-quality metrics keeping credit costs under control.

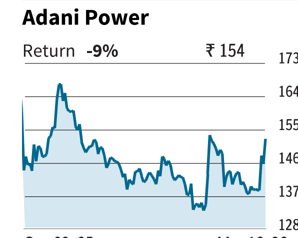
Valuation: Trading at 1.5x September 2027E BV. We recommend a Buy with a target price of ₹290/share.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

Adani Power (₹154.10): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau



The short-term outlook is bullish for Adani Power. The price action in the last few days indicates that the upmove in the stock is gaining momentum. The stock is holding well above ₹145, a key resistance which was broken last week.

The levels of ₹145 and ₹142 are good supports now. The stock can rise to ₹162 in the near term. A break above it can take Adani Power share price higher to ₹185 in the coming weeks.

Traders can buy Adani Power shares now at ₹154. Accumulate on dips at ₹146. Keep the stop-loss at ₹138 initially. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹158 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹161. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹163 and ₹172 when the price touches ₹168 and ₹177, respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹182.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

23390 » **Nifty 50 Futures**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
23350	23150	23550	23600	Go on a bounce from 23350. Stop-loss can be kept at 23320

₹839 » **HDFC Bank**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
835	827	845	856	Wait for dips. Go long at 836 with a stop-loss at 833

₹1245 » **Infosys**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1220	1200	1255	1275	Go long only above 1255. Keep the stop-loss at 1245

₹307 » **ITC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
306	304	310	312	Take fresh longs above 310 with a stop-loss at 309

₹260 » **ONGC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
258	254	262	264	Go short only below 258. Stop-loss can be kept at 259

₹1395 » **Reliance Ind.**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1390	1365	1400	1425	Take fresh longs above 1400. Keep the stop-loss at 1390

₹1063 » **SBI**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1055	1035	1075	1085	Wait for a rise. Go short at 1070 with a stop-loss at 1080

₹2401 » **TCS**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2365	2300	2430	2470	Go long only on a break above 2430 with a stop-loss at 2420

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Reliance working with six banks on Jio's IPO

Bloomberg

Reliance Industries (RIL) is working with half-a-dozen banks for the planned share-sale of its telecom unit, Jio Platforms, with more advisers likely to be added soon, according to people familiar with the matter.

The company is working with BofA Securities, Citigroup Inc, Goldman Sachs Group Inc, JM Financial, Kotak Mahindra Capital Co and Morgan Stanley on the offering, the people said.

Jio is moving ahead with what might be the first offering by a major unit of RIL in almost two decades.

Bankers had previously proposed valuing Jio Platforms at about $170 billion, in which case it could raise about $4.3 billion at the minimum requirement.

SEBI clears 3 IPOs that will mop up over ₹500 cr

Our Bureau
Mumbai

SEBI has cleared three initial public offerings (IPOs) of Travelstack Tech, Learnfluence Education and Tea Post to raise over ₹500 crore. Incidentally, Arjun Jewellers, Rays Power Infra and Madhur Iron & Steel India have withdrawn their application to go public.

The regulator has cleared the fresh fund-raise through primary market at a time when IPOs have almost dried up in the market. The war in West Asia has further added to the bearish sentiments forcing many companies to put-off their issues. Currently, SEBI is considering 46 IPO applications.

IPO STACK

Travelstack Tech's proposed IPO comprises a fresh issue worth ₹250 crore and an Offer For Sale (OFS) of 2.69 crore shares by promoters and other shareholders. Of the fresh issue proceeds, ₹135 crore will be used for working capital requirements, ₹45 crore for repayment of debt and the remaining for general corporate purposes.

Learnfluence Education plans to raise ₹246 crore through fresh issue and an OFS of up to 40 lakh equity shares. It plans to utilise the proceeds for setting up new physical campuses, sales and marketing initiatives, repayment of loans and lease payments for existing identified long-term campuses.

Tea Post's IPO comprises a fresh issue of up to 1.43 crore equity shares and an OFS of up to 1.43 crore equity shares. The company intends to use the proceeds primarily to set up and open new company-operated tea cafes.

Nifty 50 Movers

▲ 257.70 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
HDFC Bank	840.60	79.20	16.70	12.05
ICICI Bank	1272.90	28.36	16.08	8.52
Reliance Ind	1395.10	21.33	19.31	8.83
M&M	3036.10	20.56	22.34	2.54
State Bank	1066.70	17.93	11.38	4.15
ITC	308.25	14.38	18.65	2.78
Bajaj Finance	878.15	13.46	29.82	2.19
UltraTech Cement	11099.00	12.56	42.68	1.23
Axis Bank	1214.70	10.94	14.28	3.26
Eternal Ltd.	222.04	10.02	927.60	1.50
L&T	3469.40	7.83	25.15	3.82
Grasim Ind	2654.40	7.19	19.07	0.95
Tata Steel	186.94	6.22	25.58	1.45
JSW Steel	1145.60	5.42	36.07	1.01
Trent Ltd.	3596.10	5.27	78.92	0.75
Kotak Bank	369.85	4.84	19.57	2.55
Bajaj Auto	9073.00	4.82	28.52	0.94
Maruti Suzuki	12757.00	4.78	26.86	1.57
Bajaj Finserv	1773.90	4.50	14.76	0.95
Hindalco	921.15	3.52	12.87	1.25
IntGlobeAvi	4222.10	3.17	50.84	0.89
Hind Unilever	2175.70	3.06	50.84	1.81
Eicher Motors	6827.50	2.61	34.96	0.88
Asian Paints	2217.70	2.07	54.40	0.94
NestleIndia	1213.40	1.76	71.74	0.82
Adani Ports	1373.90	1.73	25.33	0.95
Titan	4090.80	1.59	76.20	1.58
TataConsumerProduct	1092.70	1.30	73.48	0.67
Infosys	1249.80	1.15	18.10	4.10
Adani Enter	1978.00	0.97	16.15	0.48
Tech Mahindra	1339.50	0.93	28.58	0.80
HCL Tech	1328.60	0.74	21.89	1.31
SBI Life	1909.20	0.47	77.23	0.80
Tata Motors PV	314.40	0.14	42.75	0.62
HDFC Life	626.00	0.06	71.46	0.63
TCS	2409.20	-0.29	18.17	2.31
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	234.35	-0.65	92.78	0.72
Apollo Hosp	7490.00	-1.35	57.72	0.72
Wipro	195.11	-1.55	15.35	0.52
Cipla	1300.00	-1.81	23.16	0.69
Dr Reddys Lab	1276.90	-2.06	19.30	0.73
NTPC	382.40	-2.13	14.93	1.70
ONGC	260.45	-3.11	7.29	0.95
Max Healthcare	970.60	-3.16	66.53	0.68
PowerGrid Corp	297.75	-3.18	17.84	1.26
Coal India	460.30	-3.34	9.53	0.98
Shriram Finance Ltd.	992.00	-3.56	20.40	1.30
Sun Pharma	1783.20	-4.27	39.06	1.77
Bharat Elec	429.50	-7.78	52.65	1.44
Bharti Airtel	1788.80	-8.92	27.53	4.67

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers

▼ 229.15 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
Adani Power .	154.06	88.65	26.29	2.83
Tvs Motor Cmp .	3374.80	35.43	52.51	3.69
Varun Beverages .	407.15	24.02	44.97	2.59
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1527.10	16.62	26.59	3.01
Bajaj Holdings	9631.00	16.24	11.96	1.94
Godrej Consumer	1041.10	15.94	58.48	1.95
Shree Cement	23315.00	14.04	46.84	1.45
Pidilitind	1353.60	12.67	59.53	1.96
Britannia Ind	5842.00	11.85	58.23	3.21
Icici Lombard Gic	1850.50	9.73	33.70	2.08
Indian Hotels Co. .	613.35	9.22	40.34	2.51
Ambuja Cements	429.00	6.68	21.55	1.22
Adanigreenenergy	866.95	5.15	76.94	1.24
Bosch	30355.00	4.42	32.48	1.23
Adani Energy Solutions .	996.50	4.37	50.22	1.61
Rural Elec	332.45	3.56	5.08	1.93
Lic	777.35	3.10	9.27	0.80
Power Finance	406.25	2.84	4.02	2.75
United Spirits .	1317.40	2.66	55.71	1.81
Mazagoan Dock	2331.80	0.87	39.08	0.82
Ltimindtree	4207.10	0.17	26.40	1.82
Divis Lab	6071.00	0.00	65.01	3.59
Hindustanaeronautics	3913.10	-0.74	29.42	3.46
Canara Bank	134.51	-1.72	6.63	2.11
Bajaj Housing Finance .	81.31	-2.36	27.34	0.35
Siemens Energy India .	2787.70	-2.44	84.04	1.15
Info Edge I	949.60	-3.26	36.54	1.72
Indian Railway Finance Corp	96.44	-4.07	17.99	0.80
Bank Of Baroda	279.95	-6.12	7.37	2.42
Samvardmothersoninternatl	113.32	-6.66	32.86	2.34
Avenuesuper	3817.90	-7.25	86.74	2.62
Punjab Natl Bank	110.97	-7.55	7.13	1.78
Havells	1297.30	-9.76	54.88	1.52
Jindal Steel	1133.00	-11.55	57.33	1.97
Solar Industries	14082.00	-12.35	83.47	1.60
Jsw Energy .	505.15	-12.56	33.91	1.26
Gail (India)	146.06	-13.92	11.16	1.83
Zyduslifesciences	886.90	-14.26	17.76	1.03
Macrotech Developers .	848.75	-14.85	25.34	1.11
Siemens	3149.60	-15.38	70.74	1.30
Vedanta	685.60	-20.10	16.18	5.41
Tata Power	390.55	-22.17	24.92	3.05
Hyundai Motor India .	1963.90	-23.14	27.56	1.30
Cg Power & Ind Sol	698.65	-23.18	99.17	2.23
Hindus Zinc	533.85	-23.54	19.11	1.08
Dlf	530.35	-23.87	29.65	1.58
Abb India	6218.00	-27.46	78.13	1.52
Torrent Pharma	4266.60	-38.72	63.56	2.08
Bpcl	304.95	-83.45	5.38	2.75
Indian Oilcorp	148.96	-84.97	5.71	2.59

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

Data Patterns bags ₹288 cr order from IMD

Chennai: Data Patterns said it has won an order worth ₹288 crore from the India Meteorological Department (IMD) for the supply of 32 units of doppler weather radars. The contract was negotiated with IMD earlier and it was received now, the company said in an exchange filing. "This is part of a negotiated contract announced after Q3 FY26," it added. OUR BUREAU

Intellect Design enters into JV for UK advisory firm

Chennai: The Board of Intellect Design Arena has approved a joint venture with Fintel PLC, a UK fintech and support services firm to incorporate a new financial advisory platform in the UK. Intellect said that the JV will develop and commercialise the AI-led platform tailored for the UK market. OUR BUREAU

Microfinance sector seeing structural transformation in ticket-size mix

HIGHER-VALUE LENDING. Share of loans below ₹50,000 has almost halved to 17 per cent in Oct-Dec 2025

Our Bureau
Mumbai

THE BIG PICTURE. The rise in average ticket sizes indicates that lenders are more comfortable with higher exposure to borrowers with a good track record

The microfinance sector is undergoing a structural transformation in ticket-size composition, pushing the industry's average ticket size to its highest recorded level, according to the Equifax-SIDBI Microfinance Pulse Report.

Loans above ₹75,000 now contribute 38 per cent of the total disbursement value, up from 25 per cent the previous year.

This comes amidst the microfinance industry's total portfolio outstanding declining 22 per cent year on year to stand at ₹2,69,897 crore, as of December-end 2025.

The share of loans below ₹50,000 has declined to 17 per cent (33 per cent).

The report noted that this migration toward higher ticket lending has pushed the industry's average ticket size to its highest recorded level, indicating rising credit confidence and lenders' preference for providing higher exposure to existing, proven customers.

The average ticket size in October-December 2025 has climbed to a historic high of ₹61,253 (₹52,748), up 16 per cent, reflecting a cumulative shift toward higher-value lending.

The contraction in the outstanding loan portfolio reflects tighter underwriting, moderated expansion strategies and the introduction of stricter guardrails to restrict the number of loans and leverage at a borrower level, the report said."While the overall outstanding portfolio has contracted, new lending activity has registered steady growth. Industry disbursements for the October-December 2025 quarter saw a 6 per cent year-on-year growth, reaching ₹63,348 crore, alongside a clear redistribution of market share," per the report.

HEALTHY CORRECTION

Aditya B Chatterjee, Managing Director, Equifax, said, "What we are witnessing is a necessary and healthy correction in the microfinance cycle. Periods of accelerated growth are often followed by consolidation, and this phase appears to be restoring balance in the system."

The report noted that the industry's 30+ days past due (DPD) delinquency has nearly halved, signalling a broad-based normalisation in borrower repayment behaviour.

Risk metrics have improved across earlier buckets. Early-stage stress indicators (1-29 DPD) and mid-stage delinquencies have steadily declined over the past four quarters. Borrower leverage also remains stable, with the share of single-lender borrowers rising to 73 per cent in December 2025, suggesting improved credit concentration discipline.

DIP IN DELINQUENCIES

Chatterjee said the meaningful decline in delinquencies (30-179 DPD) to 3.9 per cent reflects improved credit discipline, more calibrated underwriting and stronger risk monitoring across lenders.

However, stakeholders must remain cognizant that while fresh slippages are under better control, legacy stress is still working its way through ageing buckets.

Importantly, the rise in average ticket sizes indicates that lenders are more comfortable with higher exposure to existing borrowers with a good track record, rather than a sign of stress-led borrowing.

Chatterjee emphasised that a sector that grows with prudence, data-led decision making and responsible credit expansion will be far more resilient over the long term.

NBFC-MFIs now account for 44 per cent of new sourcing, strengthening their dominance in the segment. Conversely, private sector banks continued to curtail their exposure, registering a significant 26 per cent contraction in disbursals.

Equifax offers lenders' 2-year trend in customer score movement

K Ram Kumar
Mumbai

Movement of credit score over a two-year period can give lenders better insights into a prospective borrower's credit behaviour than a point-in-time score. Keeping this in view, credit information company (CIC) Equifax India has come up with a product that tells the lender how a prospective borrower's credit score has moved over the last eight quarters.

This product is aimed at helping lenders with better borrower selection as well as reducing the risk of delinquency.

Currently, when lenders pull a credit information report from a CIC, they get a three-digit customer credit score, which is a point-in-time representation of his/her creditworthiness.

Aditya B Chatterjee, Managing Director, Equifax India, observed that the handicap of a credit score is that it is a point-in-time representation of a customer's credit behaviour.

"Suppose a lender taps the bureau, pulls a prospective customer's credit score and the score comes to 800 out of 900. So, this is a wonderful score. But what it doesn't tell the lender is what has been the trend of the score — whether it has gone up from 750 to 800 or gone down from 850 to 800. If a customer's credit score is at 800, but it has come down from 850, the downward pattern indicates a risk. The standalone score never tells the lender that," Chatterjee said.

RICHER INFORMATION

The innovation that Equifax India has come up with is that instead of giving a point-in-time credit score, it now give trends in credit score movement. Chatterjee underscored that the trend in credit score movement gives more richer information, based on which the lenders can underwrite better.

Equifax India introduced the credit score trend offering for lenders a couple of months ago. It is now trying to make it more comprehensive by giving lenders insights into the proportion of secured and unsecured loans in a borrower's overall loan outstanding.

Can't confirm or deny that strategic sale is being scrapped, says IDBI Bank

Our Bureau
New Delhi

IDBI Bank said that it cannot confirm or deny reports about scrapping of its strategic stake-sale. Meanwhile, the Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM) kept mum on the status.

There have been reports that financial bids for strategic sale are below the reserve price, hence the government is likely to scrap the strategic sale. Post these reports, shares of IDBI Bank crashed on Monday and closed after a loss of around 16.5 per cent to ₹77 on the BSE. Repeated calls and messages to DIPAM to enquire about the truth of these reports remained unanswered till the time of going to press.

On Monday, responding to an enquiry from the BSE about reports on deals being scrapped, the bank said, "The proposed strategic disinvestment of IDBI Bank is a confidential process being undertaken by the Government of India (GOI) and, hence, IDBI Bank is not in a position to either confirm or deny the referenced news report." Under the strategic sale, the government will offload 30.48 per cent and LIC 30.24 per cent, leaving them with 15 per cent and 19 per cent stakes, respectively.

BIDS RECEIVED

On February 6, DIPAM Secretary Arunish Chawla said in a social media post that financial bids had been received for the strategic disinvestment of IDBI Bank. They would be evaluated as per the prescribed procedure. However, he did not disclose the names of the bidders.

Earlier, government officials repeatedly indicated that the divestment process would be completed in the fiscal year ending March 2026. The proceeds from the sale are critical amid apprehensions of a shortfall in overall tax collections.

The regulatory clearance has already been approved, which means prospective bidders received 'fit and proper' approval from the RBI.

Union Bank Committee okays ₹20,000 crore bond issuance

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Union Bank of India's Committee of Directors for fund raising (non-capital) on Monday approved issuance of long-term bonds of up to ₹20,000 crore in one or more tranches for financing infrastructure and affordable housing as per the Board approved plan.

The public sector bank, in a regulatory filing, said out of the aforementioned amount, it may explore opportunities to raise ₹7,500 crore (base issue: ₹3,000 crore + green shoe option: ₹4,500 crore) with tenor of 10 years before March-end 2026.

Union Bank also plans an issuance of Green Bonds/ Sustainable Bonds amounting up to ₹5,000 crore in one or more tranches.

Govt flags competition oversight due to concerns over duopolies in key sectors

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The government on Monday said competition authorities remain empowered to investigate anti-competitive practices and abuse of dominance in sectors such as aviation and digital markets, responding to concerns about the growing concentration of market power in industries where two major players dominate.

Replying to a question in Parliament by Congress MP Manish Tewari on duopolistic trends across sectors including aviation, digital payments, food delivery and e-commerce, Minister of State for Corporate Affairs Harsh Malhotra said the competition watchdog examines allegations of anti-competitive conduct whenever information or references are received.

CASE AGAINST INDIGO

The Minister said the Competition Commission of India (CCI), set up under the Competition Act, 2002, is mandated to prevent practices that adversely affect competition, promote fair markets and protect consumer interests.

On the aviation sector, Malhotra said the CCI had ordered an investigation into InterGlobe Aviation, which operates IndiGo, following allegations of abuse of dominant position.

In the case of Kartikeya Rawal vs InterGlobe Aviation (Case No. 44 of 2025), the CCI on February 4 directed its Director General to conduct a detailed investigation under Section 26(1) of the Act, the Minister said.

Minister of State for Corporate Affairs Harsh Malhotra

Addressing disruptions in the aviation sector in December 2025, the government said the Ministry of Civil Aviation intervened to safeguard passenger interests after largescale cancellations triggered a surge in fares on affected routes.

A four-member committee constituted by the Directorate General of Civil Aviation probed the disruptions. Subsequently, enforcement action was taken against IndiGo, including a penalty of ₹22.2 crore and a 10 per cent reduction in its approved flight network, with the freed-up capacity redistributed among other airlines.

On the broader issue of market concentration, the government said neither the Ministry of Corporate Affairs nor the CCI has conducted a specific assessment of the impact of duopolistic structures on competition, pricing, innovation or consumer choice. However, the regulator undertakes market studies periodically to better understand competitive dynamics across sectors. The government also pointed to legislative reforms aimed at strengthening competition enforcement in emerging digital markets.

FSSAI nod for 17 r-PET manufacturing units

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

The Association of PET Recyclers Bharat on Monday said 17 recycled PET manufacturing plants have bagged authorisation from the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI).

It stressed that FSSAI's move to grant final licences will help strengthen India's packaging supply chain at a time when virgin PET faces global pressures in the wake of Iran-Israel war, Association of PET Recyclers (APR) Bharat, said.

The companies that have received the FSSAI authorisation include Ganesha Eco Extrusions, Dodhia Industries, Ganesha Ecopet, JB Ecotex, Alpha Ecoplast, Ribotl Solutions, Dalmia Polypro Industries, Revalyu Recycling and Srichakra Polyplast.

MEET DEMAND

Overall, the country now has 3 lakh mt per annum of FSSAI authorised capacity to meet the demand for food-contact packaging from the beverage/bottling industry.

"The timing could not have been more appropriate when global markets for virgin PET and polymers are facing uncertainty amid geopolitical developments such as the ongoing Iran–Israel conflict. Capacities at these plants will help ensure adequate supply of r-PET in the market, enabling beverage manufacturers to meet the regulatory guideline mandating 40 per cent recycled food-grade plastic content in PET packaging bottles in 2026-27," said Goutham Jain, Director General, APR Bharat.

PLASTIC WASTE RULES

The Plastic waste Management Rules, 2016 (as amended from time to time) mandate the use of 30 per cent recycled content in rigid plastic packaging, effective 2025-26, with gradual increase of 10 per cent every year until 60 per cent in 2028-29 and onwards.

The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change in a draft notification issued on June 3, 2025, allowed brands and producers to carry forward shortfalls in meeting the 30 per cent r-PET target for food contact applications for 2025-26 over the next three years.

"The delay in issue of final notification has caused uncertainty and impacted the immediate demand significantly for r-PET by beverage and bottling industry," Jain said. "With these 17 recycled PET manufacturing plants receiving final authorisations, there will be surplus r-PET available in the market. This can help fill any gap in the supply of polymers due to the ongoing war and volatility in global markets," he added.

India inks ToR with Philippines, Maldives for trade talks

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

India has inked terms of reference with the Philippines and the Maldives to start negotiations for free trade agreements (FTAs), the Commerce Ministry said on Monday. The terms of reference (ToR) outline the scope and modalities of a proposed trade pact.

With the Philippines, negotiations will begin for a preferential trade agreement (PTA), while with the Maldives, it will be for an FTA, the Ministry said.

India's exports to the Philippines rose 3.11 per cent to $2.16 billion in 2024-25, while imports dipped 17.8 per cent to $1.17 billion.

AITIGA REVIEWS

The Ministry said that the AITIGA (Asean-India Trade in Goods Agreement) Joint Committee has met for review 11 times so far. The next meeting is scheduled for March 30-31, 2026. It also said that the India-Korea CEPA (Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement) is under review for upgradation of the pact. The review started in 2016, and so far, 11 rounds of negotiations have been held, with the last round held in Seoul in July 2024.

Recently, the country launched trade pact talks with the Gulf Cooperation Council and Canada. Similar negotiations are going on with Australia, Sri Lanka, Peru, Chile, EAEU and Israel.

PE/VC funds increasingly turn to domestic capital as global investors become selective

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

Private equity and venture capital funds investing in India are increasingly turning to domestic pools of capital, including family offices, high networth individuals and local institutions, as global investors become more selective in committing fresh money.

While India continues to attract strong investor interest, capital commitments are increasingly concentrated among a smaller group of established fund managers, experts said.

Between 2022 and 2024, the six largest private equity managers accounted for about 64 per cent of the $13.7 billion raised for India-focused funds, according to a survey of limited partners conducted by McKinsey & Company in partnership with Indian Venture and Alternate Capital Association. This shows a trend where limited partners prefer backing firms with proven track records of deploying capital and delivering exits.

Fundraising cycles have also lengthened, with investors globally placing greater emphasis on a manager's ability to generate liquidity and return capital, they said. At the same time, fund managers are widening their search for investors within India, tapping family offices, wealthy individuals and domestic institutions to diversify their investor base.

STAYED STRONG

Despite tighter fundraising conditions globally, dealmaking activity in India has remained resilient. Private equity and venture capital investments in the country reached $60.7 billion across 1,475 deals in 2025, an 8 per cent increase in value and a 9 per cent rise in deal volumes from the previous year, according to the latest EY-IVCA PE/VC Trendbook 2026. India-focused growth funds raised about $5.1 billion in 2025, a sharp increase from the previous year, while growth investments totalled $10.2 billion across 328 deals, said a report by Praxis Global Alliance.

"The year 2025 was a true testament to the resilience and maturity of the Indian PE/VC landscape," said Vivek Soni, Partner and National Leader–Private Equity Services at EY India.

Some industry participants estimate that only around 10 per cent of investible Indian companies have received private equity or venture capital funding so far, leaving substantial headroom for future investments.

CHENNAI
businessline.
TUESDAY - MARCH 17 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Palm oil hits one-year high on Dalian palmolein

Kuala Lumpur: Malaysian palm oil futures climbed for a fourth consecutive session on Monday as stronger Dalian palmolein and strength in crude oil prices supported the market. The benchmark palm oil contract for June delivery on the Bursa Malaysia Derivatives Exchange gained 82 ringgit to 4,654 ringgit a tonne at the close, its highest in over a year. REUTERS

Metals under pressure as oil surge fuels inflation

London: Industrial metal prices came under pressure on Monday as surging oil prices due to the conflict in West Asia fuelled fears about inflation and global growth prospects, traders said. Benchmark copper on the LME traded up 0.5 per cent to $12,840 a tonne in official rings due to a softer dollar. REUTERS

Crude oil prices mixed due to Gulf war

London: Crude oil prices were mixed on Monday with benchmark Brent crude slightly higher and US crude prices down amid attacks on Gulf oil production and US President Trump's call for global efforts to secure the Strait of Hormuz. Brent crude futures were up 16 cents to $103.30 a barrel by 1137 GMT while US West Texas Intermediate crude was down $1.50 to $97.21. REUTERS

Horticulture production likely to rise a tad

RAISING FARMERS' INCOME. Output projected at 370.85 million tonnes as higher yield makes up for lower acreage

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Horticulture production, which includes spices, plantation crops and honey, as well as fruits and vegetables, in the country is estimated to be a tad higher at 370.85 million tonnes (mt) during the 2025-26 crop year (July-June) from 370.74 mt. There was a marginal drop in the area but there was higher yield in many crops.

The area under all horticulture crops was reported at 30.13 million hectares (mh) in 2025-26 against 30.14 mh in 2024-25, the Agriculture Ministry said in a statement.

Releasing the first estimate of 2025-26 and the final estimate of 2024-25, Union Agriculture and Farmers Welfare Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan said that it reflected the government investment in technology, irrigation, value chain development, processing, storage, cold chains and markets, field ground-level results.

"Horticulture is now a solid foundation for raising farmers' income, ensuring nutritional security and advancing agri-exports, with the goal that farmers everywhere gain better, sustainable earnings from fruits, vegetables, spices, flowers and medicinal crops," Chouhan said in a statement.

YIELD SURGE. Banana production increased to 39.62 mt in 2025-26 from 38.32 mt in the year ago period

Crop estimate at a glance
(in million tonnes)

Crops output	2024-25*	2025-26**	% Change
Fruits	117.65	118.68	0.9
Vegetables	217.80	216.16	-0.8
Aromatics and medicinal	0.90	0.90	0.0
Floriculture	4.27	4.17	-2.3
Honey	0.15	0.15	0.0
Plantation	16.98	17.97	5.8
Spices	12.99	12.82	-1.3
Tomato	20.60	22.70	10.2
Onion	30.77	27.31	-11.2
Potato	58.57	58.45	-0.2

Source: National Horticulture Board; *Final estimate, **First estimate

Among the major fruits, banana production increased to 39.62 mt in 2025-26 from 38.32 mt, that of mango to 23.45 mt from 23.14 mt, apple to 2.79 mt from 2.66 mt, guava 5.52 mt from 5.48 mt and papaya 5.81 mt from 5.76 mt.

The fruits which reported a fall in production include orange (also Kinnow) to 6.46 mt from 6.73 mt, grape to 3.4 mt from 3.65 mt, pineapple to 1.7 mt from 1.71 mt, pomegranate to 2.8 mt from 2.82 mt and watermelon to 4.62 mt from 4.85 mt.

TOMATOES UP 10%

Though overall vegetables production is estimated to marginally drop, the output of tomato, mushroom, tapioca, okra, peas, pumpkin, sweet potato, green chillies and radish are likely to be on the higher side.

Among the essential commodities, the production of tomato is likely to be up by 10 per cent but onion may drop 11 per cent. Potato is seen to be almost at par with last year.

Among spices, the production of cardamom, ajwain, turmeric, fennel, garlic, coriander, clove and celery, dill and poppy is seen to be higher from 2024-25. But the output of cumin, ginger, curry leaf, red chillies (dried), black pepper, tamarind, saffron and vanilla is likely to drop.

In the plantation group, coconut production is pegged at 14.92 mt against 13.97 mt in 2024-25, that of areacanut at 1.53 mt from 1.49 mt and betel leaves at 6,84,000 tonnes against 6,85,000 tonnes. But the output of cashewnut and cocoa is likely to be stagnant at 8,02,000 tonnes and 33,000 tonnes, respectively.

Gold, silver ETFs bear the brunt of Iran war

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Gold and silver exchange-traded funds continued to head southwards amidst the raging Iran war as the underlying precious metals prices were at the mercy of sellers.

All silver ETFs closed in the red. They have plunged 14-16 per cent since the start of this month. Gold ETFs also dipped 8-10 per cent after ending the day deep in the red.

Axis Gold and Ipru Gold ETFs have lost 9 per cent each since the start of this month, while most other gold ETFs, including Nippon India Gold BeeS, SBI Gold, Kotak Gold, Zerodha Gold and DSP Gold ETFs, were down 8 per cent each.

Among silver ETFs, HDFC Silver fell 16 per cent while SBI Silver, DSP Silver, UTI Silver and Kotak Silver ETFs dipped 15 per cent each.

Gold prices in India were down at ₹155,714 per 10 g against ₹158,399 on Friday in line with the global markets. Similarly, silver was down at ₹2,48,711 per kg against ₹2,60,488 in the previous trading session, according to the Indian Bullion and Jewellers Association of India data.

In the US, spot gold fell 0.3 per cent to $5,001.61 per ounce while gold futures for April delivery fell 1.1 per cent to $5,007.20.

The conflict in West Asia has pushed crude oil prices higher as the region is critical for global energy supply. Rising oil prices are strengthening future inflation expectations which, in turn, are pushing US bond yields higher and reducing expectations of near-term rate cuts by the Federal Reserve. This has supported the dollar and weighed on gold and silver.

The dollar index remained above the 100 mark, its highest since last November.

UP's sugar output growth narrows as cane crushing declines

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Sugar production in Uttar Pradesh has been reported at 81.5 lakh tonnes (lt) as of March 15 in the current season, surpassing the 80.95 lt recorded in the corresponding period of the 2024-25 (October-September) sugar year.

However, the year-on-year gain has narrowed to less than 1 per cent from over 2 per cent at the end of February. This is because the output failed to meet initial projections.

"There was an expectation that at least 110 lt of sugar would be produced in Uttar Pradesh. Now, it looks difficult to even touch 95 lt as over 40 of 120 plants have closed crushing operations. Over 30 plants may end operations in the next 20 days," said an industry expert.

78 MILLS OPERATIONAL

According to data compiled by the National Federation of Cooperative Sugar Factories Ltd (NFCSF), 78 mills were operational in Uttar Pradesh as of March 15, compared to 91 a year ago. To date, mills in the State have crushed 802.96 lt of sugarcane, down from 843.23 lt in the previous period. Despite lower crushing volumes, sugar production remains higher due to a superior recovery rate of 10.15 per cent, up from 9.6 per cent last season. Recovery rate refers to the quantity of sugar extracted from cane.

Pan-India sugar production in the 2025-26 season reached 261.75 lt as of March 15, up from 237.15 lt a year ago, per NFCSF data. Currently, 173 mills remain operational nationwide while 367 units have concluded operations. During the same period last year, 200 mills were active, and 333 had finished crushing.

Sugar production between Oct 1, 2025 & Mar 15, 2026
(lakh tonnes)

	2024-25	2025-26	% Change
Uttar Pradesh	80.95	81.50	0.7
Maharashtra	78.60	98.50	25.3
Karnataka	39.10	45.80	17.1
All India	**237.15**	**261.75**	**10.4**

Source: NFCSF

Data further show that Maharashtra's sugar output reached 98.5 lt between October 1 and March 15, a 25 per cent increase from 78.6 lt a year ago. Karnataka reported a 17 per cent rise, with production reaching 45.8 lt, up from 39.1 lt previously.

EXPORTS CONTINUE

Meanwhile, the All India Sugar Trade Association (AISTA) on Monday stated that India's sugar exports reached 3.15 lt during the October-February period, with the UAE emerging as the top destination.

The exported volume included 2.58 lt of white sugar and 0.54 lt of refined sugar. Over 2,000 tonnes are currently being loaded or awaiting shipment, according to the statement.

The UAE received the largest volume at nearly 0.8 lt, followed by Afghanistan (71,813 tonnes), Djibouti (45,801 tonnes) and Tanzania (21,330 tonnes).

"India will be able to do physical shipments of more than 8,00,000 tonnes, including to Asian and Gulf countries," AISTA Chairman Praful Vithalani said.

The trade body recently lowered the sugar production estimate to 283 lt from an earlier 296 lt, citing lower yields in key producing States due to adverse weather.

The Food Ministry has approved a total of 20 lt for export — 15 lt by September 30 and 5 lt by June 30.

Project Chittoor targets ₹1 lakh an acre annual income for farmers

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

The Atria Group, with interests in energy and technology, education, has launched a 600-acre integrated rural transformation initiative in Chittoor district of Andhra Pradesh.

The pilot project aims to increase farm incomes, promote diversified rural livelihoods and develop a model that can be replicated elsewhere.

"The project is designed to increase annual farm income from approximately ₹30,000 per acre to over ₹1 lakh per acre through an integrated ecosystem, spanning regenerative agriculture, solar energy generation, digital education and agro-wellness tourism," Sunder Raju, Founder, Atria Group, said.

"We have developed a model which will support 250 rural families. By combining vertical food forests, integrated livestock systems, clean energy generation, value-added food processing and rural tourism, the model will transform each acre into a diversified economic unit rather than depend on a single crop," he said.

REVERSE MIGRATION

The initiative aims to improve groundwater recharge through regenerative farming practices, enhance biodiversity via agroforestry, and build climate resilience through integrated land use.

"By creating viable rural employment and entrepreneurial opportunities, the project seeks to enable reverse migration of skilled youth and landowners back to their native villages, not out of compulsion but by choice," he said.

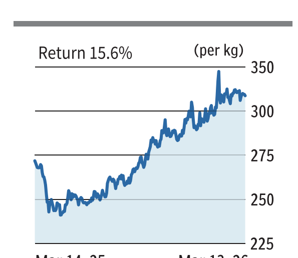
Designed as a replicable blueprint, Project Chittoor has a roadmap to expand to 6,000 acres and eventually 60,000 acres across multiple districts and States.

GREENER FUTURE. By creating viable rural employment, the project seeks to enable reverse migration of skilled youth

Go long if zinc dips to ₹319, stop-loss at ₹315

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Zinc futures are currently trading at ₹322. They lack momentum and have been trading in a range for over a month, i.e., between ₹317 and ₹332.



COMMODITY CALL.

Therefore, until either of these levels is breached, we cannot be certain about the path of the next leg of trend.

That said, the broader trend has been bullish and zinc futures have trendline support around ₹320. Therefore, the price band of ₹317-320 is a good support.

A rebound from this region could lift the contract to ₹328 and ₹332. A breakout of the latter could open the door for another rally, possibly to ₹340.

On the other hand, if zinc futures breach the support at ₹317, the near-term outlook could turn weak, potentially leading to a fall to ₹310. The downswing might even extend to ₹300.

Overall, there is no clarity with respect to the outlook at the moment. But since the broader trend remains positive and there is support ahead, traders could consider buying at lower prices from the current level.

TRADE STRATEGY

Stay out for now. Buy zinc if it dips to ₹319. Target and stop-loss can be ₹330 and ₹315, respectively.

Exclude aluminium from 50% cut in new RoDTEP norms: Industry body

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Aluminium Association India (AAI) has urged the Director-General of Foreign Trade (DGFT), the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, to exclude aluminium and aluminium products from the 50 per cent reduction in the Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products (RoDTEP) rates.

The AAI said its request follows the reduction in RoDTEP rates across sectors by a flat 50 per cent with immediate effect.

Earlier, RoDTEP rates for aluminium exports were nearly 3 per cent for domestic tariff area (DTA) units and 2.2 per cent for special economic zones (SEZ) units.

In a detailed representation to the DGFT, the AAI sought exclusion of export products under ITC HS Chapter 76 (Aluminium and Articles thereof) from the scope of the February 23, 2026, order. It is similar to the exemption already granted to products under ITC HS Chapters 01–24.

UNREBATED TAXES

The notification of RoDTEP rates for FY27 is based on the actual incidence of unrebated taxes applicable to the aluminium sector, for both DTA and SEZ units.

The AAI said India's aluminium exports, valued around $7 billion or nearly 2 per cent of the country's total goods exports, are facing increasing pressure due to escalating tariff and non-tariff barriers in key markets. At the same time, the domestic aluminium industry is confronting a double challenge: Export opportunities are shrinking as global tariff regimes tighten, while imports into India continue to rise sharply.

The European Union's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism has created an indirect tariff barrier, ranging from 7 per cent to 50 per cent, while exports to the US continue to face 50 per cent duties under Section 232 Tariffs.

The association said Mexico had increased customs duties on aluminium products to 10-35 per cent from January 2026, while rising Chinese-funded aluminium capacities in Indonesia are further intensifying competition in global markets.

22% leaf teas unsold at Coonoor auctions

V Sajeev Kumar
Kochi

A slowdown in export demand has resulted in a rise in unsold quantities of tea, particularly leaf varieties, at the Coonoor auctions.

Traders said that in sale 11, nearly 22 per cent of the leaf grades remained unsold as many exporters deferred purchases amid the ongoing crisis in West Asia.

The weak export interest also weighed on prices, with certain leaf grades registering a decline.

DOMESTIC BUYERS

However, domestic buyers stepped in to support the market for dust grades, leading to better demand in that segment. Global Tea Auctioneers said the quantity offered in leaf was 8,20,499 kg, witnessing a sales percentage of 75, while for dust, it was 84 per cent of the offered 2,73,671 kg.

The high-priced teas and better liquoring sorts were lower by ₹3 to ₹4 and more at times; occasionally, some quality lots sold dearer by ₹2 to ₹3. The better medium was lower by ₹1 to ₹2, occasionally some quality lots sold dearer by ₹2 to ₹3. Generally, less demand was noticed in overall CTC leaf sale.

In CTC dust, high-priced and better liquoring sorts were barely steady to occasionally dearer by ₹3 to ₹4. The better medium sorts were lower by ₹2 to ₹3.

The primary orthodox dust grades were sold dearer by ₹4 to ₹5 and more at times. The secondaries and finer dust sorts were barely steady to easier by ₹1 to ₹2 and more at times.

Amid complaints over lower prices, SC tells Centre to revisit policy framework to boost farming of pulses

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Following a petition seeking import curbs on yellow peas due to its adverse impact on the domestic production of pulses, the Supreme Court passed an order directing the government to convene a meeting of stakeholders to revisit the existing policy framework.

It asked the Centre to explore a better substitute, under which the farmers are incentivised for diversification of conventional crops to pulses, along with certain benefits.

"We hope and expect that the Ministries will resolve this issue effectively through a new policy decision," it said and added that the meeting will consider recommendations of the Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP).

The next hearing of the case has been fixed for May 8.

Hearing a petition filed by farmer organisation Kisan Mahapanchayat, a bench, comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi, on March 13 also said: "The deliberations that may take place among different stakeholders be placed on record."

Commenting on the order, Kisan Mahapanchayat president Rampal Jat told *businessline* that the commitment of the Union Government's Ministers of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare, Food and Commerce towards the interests of farmers will be put to the test.

He welcomed the order, specifically asking to place before the court the respective position of different stakeholders concerning the Centre's policies on crop diversification, minimum support price (MSP) and the assurance of procurement at MSP, Jat said.

CENTRE'S RESPONSE

Acting on the petition, which said the supply of imported yellow peas was affecting the livelihood of farmers, the Supreme Court in September 2025 had sought the Centre's response.

In its reply, the Directorate-General of Foreign Trade under the Ministry of Commerce contended that the petition was "not maintainable since no legal right or a fundamental right of the petitioner is violated". It also informed the court that the 30 per cent import duty on yellow peas was introduced from October 29, 2025.

During the hearing of the case, the Bench observed: "You have an MSP for wheat, you have an MSP for rice (paddy), and you have an MSP for some pulses now also. The moment you make sure that the farmer will get this price, you will see how it (pulses production) will rise. Unfortunately, this aspect probably has not been really addressed..."

'West Asia crisis unlikely to dent basmati exports'

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Basmati rice export volumes are likely to remain steady this fiscal and next, with growth of up to 2 per cent over 6.06 million tonnes export volume logged last fiscal, despite the ongoing West Asia conflict, CRISIL Ratings has said.

While exports to Iran, a key market, are likely to be affected, higher demand from other markets in the region, such as Saudi Arabia, Iraq, United Arab Emirates and Yemen will offset the same.

LOGISTICAL HURDLES

The working capital cycle of basmati rice exporters is likely to stretch due to logistical hurdles, such as inadequate availability of ships, longer transit times and payment-related challenges, resulting in a rise in working capital debt.

The exporters are, however, likely to pass on any increase in freight and insurance cost to customers, which will help protect their operating profitability.

Balance sheets should remain healthy despite the uptick in debt levels, keeping credit profiles stable, CRISIL Ratings, based on an analysis of 47 companies which account for about 60 per cent of the overall basmati industry revenue, said.

India is the largest producer of basmati rice, constituting close to 85 per cent of the global basmati rice volume. Exports constitute nearly two-thirds of India's annual basmati rice sales by volume, making the industry vulnerable to geopolitics.

QUICKLY.

Sundaram Home Finance expands into Puducherry

Chennai: Sundaram Home Finance forayed into Puducherry in the emerging business segment that comprises affordable housing finance and working capital loans. This follows the company's expansion into Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh and Telangana earlier this year. The company is targeting disbursements of over ₹10 crore in the initial phase in this segment in Puducherry. OUR BUREAU

IIT-Madras, Tidco tie up for EV, auto tech research

Chennai: The Centre of Excellence in Advanced Automotive Research, IIT Madras, and the Tamil Nadu Industrial Development Corporation (Tidco) will establish the Advanced Automotive Translational Research Centre at Tamil Nadu Knowledge City, Tiruvallur. Planned across 40,000 sq ft, this envisions a ₹200 crore investment over five years to accelerate translational research and product development in next-gen auto tech. OUR BUREAU

Jobless rate dips a tad to 4.9% in Feb as urban employment improves

NSO DATA. Strong recovery in urban market, drop in female unemployment are key drivers

Our Bureau
New Delhi

WOMEN POWER. Female unemployment fell to 5.1% in February from 5.6% in the previous month. Urban female unemployment dropped even more at 8.7% from 9.8%

The jobless rate in India dropped a tad to 4.9 per cent in February from 5 per cent in January, according to data released by the National Statistics Office (NSO) on Monday.

The rate is based on the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS), including nearly 3.75 lakh people. The PLFS conducted by the NSO is the primary source of data on population activity participation and employment and unemployment conditions.

"February 2026 marked a strong recovery for the urban job market with more women working and unemployment rates dropping sharply across both rural and urban sectors," the NSO said in a statement.

The trend was largely driven by declining joblessness in urban areas and improvement in employment indicators for women across both rural and urban regions, according to the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI).

URBAN UNEMPLOYMENT

Urban unemployment among people aged 15 years and above dropped to 6.6 per cent in February from 7 per cent in January, while rural unemployment remained steady at 4.2 per cent during the period. The latest data follows a slight uptick in January, when the unemployment rate rose to 5 per cent from 4.8 per cent in December 2025, partly reflecting seasonal factors and a post-harvest slowdown in rural labour demand.

FEMALE EMPLOYMENT

The February data also pointed to an improvement in labour market outcomes for women. Overall female unemployment declined to 5.1 per cent in February from 5.6 per cent a month earlier. Urban female unemployment recorded a sharper fall, dropping to 8.7 per cent from 9.8 per cent in January.

The overall Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR) among persons of age 15 years and above remained unchanged at 55.9 per cent in February 2026, the same as recorded in January 2026. In rural areas, the LFPR stood at 58.7 per cent in February 2026.

The urban LFPR was estimated at 50.4 per cent in February 2026, up from 50.3 per cent in January 2026.

The overall female LFPR in the age group 15 years and above increased marginally from 35.1 per cent in January 2026 to 35.3 per cent in February 2026.

In rural areas, the female LFPR rose from 39.7 per cent in January 2026 to 40 per cent in February 2026, indicating an improvement in rural female participation, whereas the urban female LFPR remained unchanged at 25.5 per cent during the same period.

WORKER POPULATION

The Worker Population Ratio (WPR) for the 15 years and above age group remained broadly stable in both rural and urban areas in February 2026.

The overall WPR was estimated at 53.2 per cent in February 2026, compared with 53.1 per cent in January 2026. In rural areas, WPR stood at 56.3 per cent in February 2026.

Similarly, the urban WPR was 47 per cent in February 2026, compared with 46.8 per cent in January 2026.

Amrutanjan held on to temple land till 2018, owes ₹9.74 cr rent, TN tells HC

Mohamed Imranullah S
Chennai

The writ petition was dismissed by a single judge of the High Court in 2025

The Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments (HR&CE) Department on Monday informed the Madras High Court that the Chennai-based, 132-year-old company Amrutanjan Ltd was occupying 14 grounds of the Mylapore Kapaleeswarar Temple land on Luz Church Road till 2018. The company has to pay arrears of ₹9.74 crore towards rent.

Appearing before the first Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G Arul Murugan, Special Government Pleader (HR&CE) NRR Arun Natarajan said that the temple authorities had initiated action under the Revenue Recovery Act of 1890 to recover the rental arrears. He also said there was no direct landlord-tenant relationship between the temple and Amrutanjan.

The SGP said the temple had given 14 grounds and 910 sq ft (total 34,510 sq ft) of its land on 99-year lease to one PR Sundera Iyer on August 28, 1901, for a monthly rent of ₹1,400. Iyer, in turn, had assigned the lease rights to a woman named Ramayee Ammal, from whom Amrutanjan Ltd had obtained the rights and continued to occupy the land on payment of ₹1,400 a month for decades.

AFTER LEASE PERIOD

He said Amrutanjan continued to be in occupation even after the expiry of the 99-year lease period on August 27, 2000. Though notices were issued in 2001 and 2004, the company did not vacate the property. Hence, in 2005, a committee constituted for fixing fair rent for temple properties fixed the monthly rent for the land in the heart of Chennai city at ₹3.3 lakh per month and demanded the rent from 2001.

Immediately, the company filed a writ petition in 2005 to declare Section 34A(5) of the Tamil Nadu HR&CE Act of 1959 as illegal, *ultra vires* and unenforceable, since it requires any person filing a statutory appeal before the HR&CE Commissioner to deposit the claimed rental amount in the temple's bank account. The writ petition was dismissed by a single judge of the High Court in 2025, and hence the present writ appeal, Natarajan said.

He also brought it to the notice of the Division Bench that the company continued to be in possession of the property till 2018. The single judge directed the HR&CE Department and the temple administration to recover the rental arrears.

After hearing him as well as the counsel for Amrutanjan, the Chief Justice said there was nothing on record to prove that the company had indeed filed the statutory appeal. He said Amrutanjan had failed to produce an acknowledgement to prove that the statutory appeal was filed before the HR&CE Commissioner or to prove that the officer had insisted on depositing the demanded rent as a precondition to entertain the appeal.

Wondering what necessitated the company to challenge the validity of a legal provision, the Chief Justice's Bench said it would pass detailed orders in a day or two.

Opposition 'absentees' pave way for NDA sweep in Bihar RS polls

Poornima Joshi
New Delhi

The National Democratic Alliance (NDA) on Monday made a clean sweep of all five Rajya Sabha seats from Bihar. The Opposition Mahagathbandhan was dealt a severe blow, with some legislators remaining absent during the polls. In Odisha, too, the BJP and the independent candidate backed by the ruling party emerged victorious in the biennial polls.

The term of 37 Rajya Sabha members will conclude in April, vacating seats for new members to be elected. Of these, 26 candidates have already secured victory unopposed. Voting took place on Monday for the remaining 11 seats, including five from Bihar, four from Odisha and two from Haryana.

In Bihar, the NDA fielded Chief Minister Nitish Kumar, BJP president Nitin Nabin, Ram Nath Thakur, Upendra Kushwaha and Shivesh Ram, all of whom emerged victorious. Nitish Kumar, Nitin Nabin, Ram Nath Thakur and Upendra Kushwaha won on first preference votes while Shivesh Ram secured victory in the second preference round. Opposition candidate AD Singh received 38 votes.

MLAS ABSENT

During polling in the Bihar Assembly, 202 NDA MLAs voted while 37 MLAs from the Mahagathbandhan took part, Congress MLAs Manoj Biswas, Surendra Kushwaha and Manohar Singh, along with RJD MLA Faisal Rahman, remained absent. Bihar Congress chief Rajesh Ram alleged that the BJP had "abducted" and placed three Congress MLAs under house arrest.

Bihar Assembly's total strength is 243 and the NDA has 202 MLAs. To win one

Congress MLAs Manoj Biswas, Surendra Kushwaha and Manohar Singh, along with RJD MLA Faisal Rahman were absent

Rajya Sabha seat from Bihar, a candidate needed 41 first-preference votes. With 202 MLAs, the NDA was comfortably placed to win four seats and won the fifth seat in the second preference vote, with the path for Shivesh Ram, the fifth candidate, having been paved by four MLAs from the Mahagathbandhan absenting.

According to RJD leader Tejashwi Yadav, Mahagathbandhan chose to contest the elections even though the numbers were not on its side because it would "never bow before the BJP."

Tejwasi said the Mahagathbandhan's strength was 35, and while it was initially six short, the NDA too was three short. He claimed that the Opposition had managed to bridge the gap needed for victory with support from five AIMIM MLAs and the Bahujan Samaj Party. In Odisha, the BJP candidates were party State unit president Manmohan Samal and Sujeet Kumar, while it was simultaneously supporting independent Dilip Ray. Although the results had not been announced till the time of going to press, Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Manjhi congratulated Samal and Dilip Ray on X. The Opposition BJD alleged that the BJP had indulged in horse-trading.

In Haryana, vote counting was halted amid objections raised by both the Congress and the BJP over the secrecy of votes cast by some MLAs.

Telangana budget to focus on inclusive growth, says Governor

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Telangana Governor Shiv Pratap Shukla addressing the Assembly on Monday

The Telangana budget for 2026-27 will cater to the social and economic development needs of all sections of the population, said Governor Shiv Pratap Shukla.

Addressing the joint session of the State Assembly on the first day of the Budget Session here on Monday, he said the State government was committed to the development of the State, and the per capita income of Telangana had reached ₹4.18 lakh.

The State government had drawn a roadmap, Vision 2047, to achieve a $3 trillion economy, keeping in mind the increase in the urban population, which would reach 53.8 per cent of the total population by 2031.

The Greater Hyderabad Municipal Corporation (GHMC) was divided into three corporations recently, while the Hyderabad Metropolitan Area was divided into four Commissionerates, the Governor said.

INVESTMENT HUB

Referring to the recent investments attracted by the State, the Governor said the State had become a hub of investments. BioAsia held last month attracted investments worth ₹1,700 crore.

Hyderabad had also become a global tech hub, with 20 per cent of the country's global capability centres (GCCs) based there.

Apart from providing 9.38 lakh jobs, the IT and Services sector had registered exports worth ₹3.13 lakh crore, the Governor said.

On the welfare front, the Governor said the implementation of the Mahalakshmi Scheme, which provides free bus travel to women across the State, had resulted in savings of ₹9.222 crore.

MAJOR CHALLENGE

Deputy Finance Minister Bhatti Vikramarka Mallu will present the State budget for FY2026-27 on March 20, 2026.

The preparation of the budget is expected to be a challenging task for the government as it would need to provide funds for the implementation of various welfare schemes and for the State government takeover of the Hyderabad Metro from L&T for ₹15,000 crore.

Investment, policy support drive trout farming in J&K

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar

Union Minister for Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying (FAH&D) and Panchayati Raj Rajiv Ranjan Singh announced last week a ₹100 crore Integrated Aqua Park project in Anantnag district of Jammu and Kashmir during the 'National Conference on Cold Water Fisheries' in Srinagar, in a fresh push to promote trout farming in the region.

During the conference, Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha said the sector had received support under the Holistic Agriculture Development Programme launched in 2022, which allocated ₹233 crore for fisheries development to promote entrepreneurship, expand trout farming and encourage value-added fish products. Central support under the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana also helped drive the expansion of fisheries and aquaculture in the Union Territory, with the Centre releasing more than ₹118 crore over the past five financial years.

Officials said the funds had been used to strengthen aquaculture infrastructure, improve fish seed production, support fish farming units and build capacity among local farmers. The scheme also supports hatcheries, feed mills and modern aquaculture technologies aimed at enhancing productivity.

The financial support coincided with rapid growth in the fisheries sector in the Union Territory, particularly in trout farming.

SURGE IN PRODUCTION

Jammu and Kashmir has emerged as India's leading producer of trout among cold-water States. Trout production in the region has nearly doubled in recent years, rising from 1,663 tonnes in 2021-22 to a record 2,650 tonnes in 2024-25.

EC teams monitoring both physical and digital movement of cash: TN poll head

Our Bureau
Chennai

Archana Patnaik, Chief Electoral Officer, Tamil Nadu BIJOY GHOSH

With Tamil Nadu's 2026 Assembly poll schedule announced, flying squad members and static surveillance teams are now active in the State to prevent illegal transportation of cash and other items in the run-up to the elections. "We are also monitoring large transactions via the digital route," Tamil Nadu's Chief Electoral Officer Archana Patnaik said here on Monday.

"As of March 15, over 2,100 flying squad members, along with an equal number of static surveillance teams, have been put on duty," she said at a press conference.

"Around ₹1.26 crore in value of goods and services has been caught in various raids by officials from last evening till today (Monday morning). We are also monitoring large value transactions that take place via payment platforms like Google Pay and others," the official said.

Meanwhile, with regard to requests put forward by traders to raise the limit for individuals carrying cash during the election season to ₹5 lakh, the CEO said that if all documents are in place, no cash will be seized and will be allowed by their teams.

"We will follow the norms of the ECI, and there will be better preparation on the ground as training has been given to election officials," she said. "We have stressed that no inconvenience should be caused to general citizens in this process," she added.

Interestingly, the Chief Electoral Officer of Tamil Nadu also said that they have already started monitoring the content on social media for AI-generated and other such synthetic content relating to the elections.

COOPERATION SOUGHT

"This time we have also requested political parties for cooperation to adhere to certain guidelines and procedures when it comes to social media content and use of AI in their communications," Patnaik said. She did not elaborate on these guidelines.

"We urge the voters to check ahead of the actual voting date their name and polling stations, and keep ready. Our booth-level officers are available to help and ensure good voting experiences for voters," the of-

TN AVGC policy envisions 2 lakh jobs

Rohan Das
Chennai

Tamil Nadu's recently announced Animation Visual Effects Gaming Comics and Extended Reality (AVGC XR) policy is expected to help the State become a hub in the emerging digital content industry.

Speaking to *businessline,* leaders from these sectors said that apart from the benefits of bringing these new-gen industries under the government's purview, the policy's focus on early stage support and talent creation will give the State a leg up in the long term.

The policy, in effect for five years, aims to attract high-profile AVGC-XR investments to Tamil Nadu as anchor units while also supporting the creation of 200 start-ups and 100 larger companies. These should create about 2 lakh jobs and capture 20 per cent of the Indian AVGC market, expected to reach about $6 billion by 2030. A gaming industry executive who was consulted as part of the policy making process said that its push for job creation is particularly significant given the current context. "Given the challenges that the IT sector is facing, the AVGC domains can be a good alternative. Though the number of jobs might not be that high, these domains are largely safe from AI and hence focusing on building talent here is crucial," he said.

MAIN DIFFERENTIATOR

He added that the main differentiator in Tamil Nadu's approach has been its focus on building an incubation ecosystem to grow the industry ground up.

"In gaming for instance, they are providing funding for studios with early-stage prototypes and connecting them with global publishers. They can also claim reimbursements on certification costs for their IP, reducing the costs for taking their games international," he said.

In terms of the financial incentives, AVGC firms will now be able to tap into proceeds from TNESSF, TANSEED, TANFUND and iTNT Foundation Fund. The policy also proposes a ₹250 crore research and technology fund to promote research in the field. It also provides for a 100 per cent reimbursement of IP filing costs and 50 per cent reimbursement of costs for participation in global industry events for AVGC companies.

KEY INITIATIVE

A key initiative would be the setting up of an AVGC-XR Centre of Excellence in Chennai with facilities such as performance capture studios, XR testing labs and immersive content production infrastructure. Similar regional centres are planned in Coimbatore, Madurai, Tiruchirapalli, Salem and Tirunelveli.

In terms of talent building, the policy proposes curriculum reforms with specialised courses in animation, VFX, gaming and XR, and digital arts centres across 300-400 colleges. It also provides for scholarships up to ₹2 lakh per year under the Naan Mudhalvan programme for students pursuing these courses.

Manish Agarwal, Board Member, Game Developers Association of India (GDAI) believes that the policy will go a long way in recognising gaming and interactive media as a serious creative and technology industry in the State. "By focusing on skills, incubation, and industry collaboration, the State is laying the groundwork for a strong game development ecosystem. For Indian studios to compete globally, we need more regional hubs of talent and innovation," he said.

BJP releases list of 144 candidates for Bengal polls; Suvendu Adhikari to contest from Mamata's turf

Our Bureau
Kolkata

West Bengal Opposition leader Suvendu Adhikari

The BJP on Monday released its first list of 144 candidates for the West Bengal Assembly elections, setting the stage for a high-stakes contest by fielding the present Leader of the Opposition Suvendu Adhikari from Bhabanipur the constituency of Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee.

Adhikari has also been fielded from his Nandigram seat in Bengal's Purba Medinipur district.

GAME OF SEATS

In the 2021 Assembly polls, the BJP leader had defeated Banerjee, the Trinamool Congress supremo, from the Nandigram constituency. Following her defeat, Banerjee re-entered the Assembly after a by-poll in Bhabanipur. Months before the poll schedule announcement, Adhikari said he would contest from Bhabanipur and defeat Banerjee again.

According to the BJP's candidate list, Dilip Ghosh, the former State president of the party, will contest from the Kharagpur Sadar constituency, his old seat, where he had won in 2016. Party leader and former Rajya Sabha MP Swapan Das Gupta will be fielded from the Rasbehari seat in south Kolkata.

TWO PHASES

In West Bengal, voting will be conducted in two phases on April 23 and April 29. The first phase will cover 152 Assembly constituencies, and the second phase will cover 142.

The Left Front on Monday announced its first list of 192 candidates, with outgoing Rajya Sabha MP Bikash Ranjan Bhattacharya and CPI(M) central committee member Minakshi Mukherjee among the prominent nominees.

Bhattacharya, Mayor of Kolkata from 2005 to 2010, will contest from the Jadavpur constituency in the southern outskirts of the city, while Mukherjee, a youth face of the Left Front, has been fielded from Uttarpara in Hooghly district.

Mukherjee had contested from Nandigram in the 2021 Assembly elections and came third after Adhikari and Mamata Banerjee.

After funding slowdown, edtech sector heads for consolidation

BROADER SHIFT. upGrad buying Unacademy marks one of the biggest efforts to strengthen the industry

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

India's edtech sector may be entering a fresh consolidation phase as large platforms seek scale and sustainable growth after the post-pandemic funding slowdown, industry executives and investors said.

The shift comes as upGrad has signed a term sheet to acquire rival Unacademy in a 100 per cent share-swap transaction, signalling what could become one of the biggest consolidation moves in the country's online education space in recent years.

Unacademy has raised about $854.3 million across 13 funding rounds, according to PitchBook, and counts SoftBank, Tiger Global Management, General Atlantic and Peak XV Partners among its backers, while UpGrad has raised $329 million across eight recent rounds, according to Tracxn.

DIVERSIFIED PORTFOLIOS. The deal may boost upGrad's position ahead of a potential public listing

For upGrad, founded by Ronnie Screwvala, the acquisition could significantly broaden its user base beyond higher education and professional upskilling into the K-12 and test-preparation segments, where Unacademy has built a large audience.

"A lot of capital flowed into edtech during the Covid years, but in many cases the sector struggled to demonstrate durable learning outcomes," said Sunitha Viswanathan, partner at Kae Capital. "As a result, investors have been more cautious post Covid."

PROFITABILITY PUSH

Industry investors said the potential deal also reflects a broader shift in the sector, where companies are focusing on profitability and scale after years of aggressive expansion fuelled by venture capital.

Ujwal Sutaria, Founder and General Partner at TDV Partners, said the move could help upGrad build a full-cycle learning platform.

"For upGrad, this is a bid to build a cradle-to-career platform," Sutaria said. "The company has traditionally focused on higher education and professional upskilling. By acquiring Unacademy, it instantly absorbs a massive K-12 and test-prep audience, creating a pipeline where a learner could enter the ecosystem early and remain within it through their professional journey."

The deal could also strengthen upGrad's positioning ahead of a potential public listing in the coming years, investors said, as larger edtech platforms look to build diversified portfolios and stronger revenue streams.

Sutaria added that the transaction also reflects a growing "last man standing" dynamic in the sector. "In a consolidated market, the players with stronger balance sheets can acquire distressed or reset assets at attractive valuations. That allows them to gain scale much faster than building it organically," he said.

Still, investors remain cautious after the sector's boom-and-bust cycle during and after the pandemic.

"One of the reasons investors became wary of edtech is that over time the 'tech' often took precedence over the 'education'," Viswanathan said. "Going forward, founders will need to keep the learner at the centre of any technological intervention."

Funding in the sector has already fallen sharply from its 2021 peak, with venture capital firms now backing fewer but larger platforms with clearer paths to profitability.

If the upGrad–Unacademy deal closes, it could signal the start of a broader consolidation wave across India's edtech ecosystem, as companies look to combine scale, technology and outcomes to win back investor confidence.

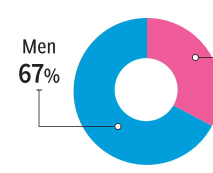
VISUALLY.

Compiled by Yashaswani Chauhan | Graphic KS Gunasekar

Women at the OSCARS

Autumn Durald Arkapaw's 2026 Best **Cinematography** win for *Sinners* marked a historic first in one of the Academy's most technically demanding and male-dominated fields. She became the first woman, and the first woman of colour to win in the category. Yet, nearly a century of data show women account for under 20 per cent of the nominations and it is concentrated in select categories such as costume design and makeup

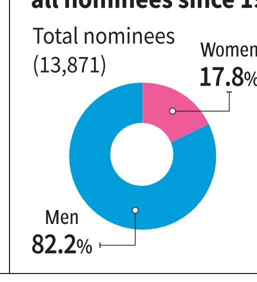
Women accounted for 33% of nominees in Oscars 2026



Women of colour among nominees
12%*

*Highest percentage of women of colour nominees across 98 years

But women make up just 17.8% of all nominees since 1929 (1929-2026)



Women of colour out of total nominees
>2%

Women of colour out of total Oscar winners
>2%

Milestones

First woman of colour nominated for an Oscar

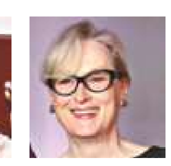
Merle Oberon
(1936)

First woman of colour to win an Oscar

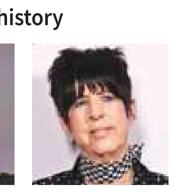
Hattie McDaniel
(1940)

Edith Head remains the most nominated woman in Oscars history

Edith Head
35

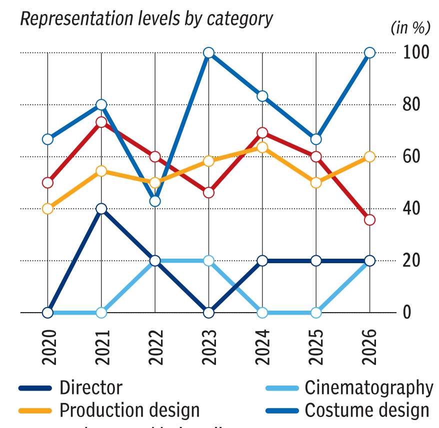


Meryl Streep
21

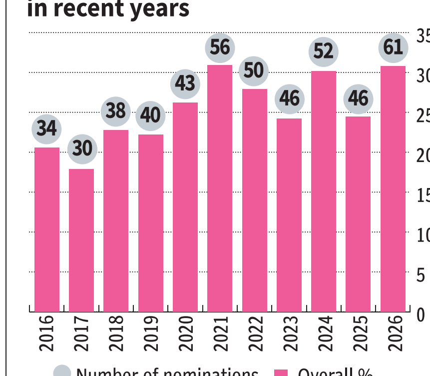


Diane Warren
17

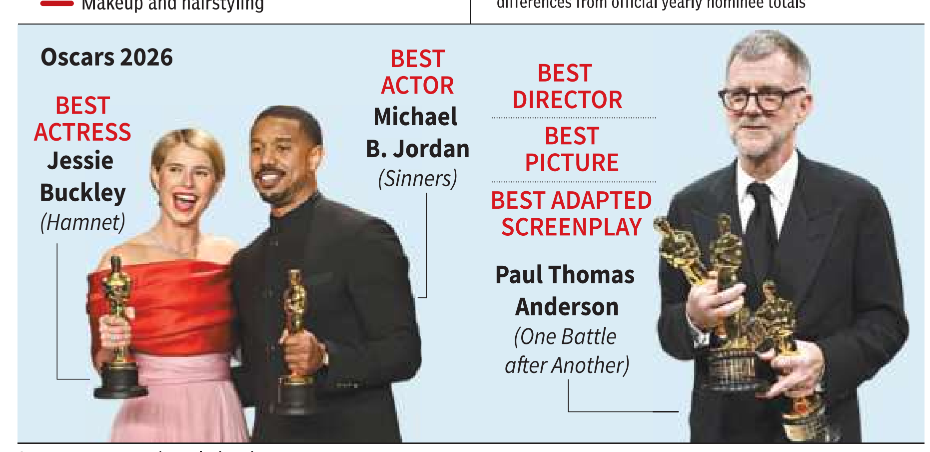
Women's representation stronger in design, weaker in top creative roles



Women's representation increasing in recent years



**Overall percentages group related sub-categories under one award label (for example, "Sound" includes Sound Editing and Sound Mixing), which may lead to slight differences from official yearly nominee totals



Source: oscars.org, The Inclusion List

RBI to conduct ₹1.50 lakh cr variable rate repo auction

Press Trust of India
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Monday said it will conduct a seven-day variable rate repo (VRR) auction of ₹1.5 lakh crore on March 17.

The auction will take place between 9.30 am and 10 am, and the reversal of these funds will take place on March 24, according to a media release from the central bank.

The central bank announced the auction based on the current and evolving liquidity conditions of the banking system, the release added. Currently, the liquidity in the banking system is estimated to be in surplus of around ₹2.08 lakh crore.

RBI has infused ₹3.5 lakh crore of durable liquidity into the banking system through open market purchase of government securities since January 2026.

LIQUIDITY BOOST

In the last few months, the RBI has been infusing large amounts of liquidity into the banking system to keep overnight rates under control.

This has led overnight rates to hover sharply below the repo rate.

Noida airport seeks higher user development fee ahead of launch

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Noida International Airport (NIA) has proposed a user development fee (UDF) of ₹653-₹1,200 for departing domestic and international passengers for FY27 in its tariff submission filed with the Airports Economic Regulatory Authority (AERA).

HIGHER USER FEE

For arriving passengers, a UDF of ₹282-₹520 has been proposed for the first year. The UDF rates for both incoming and departing passengers will increase each year during the first control period, FY 27-31.

Thus, a departing domestic and international passenger could pay as much as ₹921-₹1,736 in user fees in FY31 if the airport's proposal gets accepted.

The NIA received its aerodrome licence earlier this month, and is set to begin commercial operations after formal inauguration.

Last August, AERA approved an *ad hoc* UDF of ₹490-₹980 for departing passengers and ₹210-₹420 for arriving passengers. These rates will apply until the finalisation of the tariff order, expected in the next few months.

BIG CHALLENGES

In its tariff submission, the NIA said that developing the catchment within a dual-airport setup poses significant challenges for it.

"Striking an optimal balance between the UDF and landing/parking charges is crucial for establishing traffic flow and maximising revenue potential," the airport said.

Lupin betting big on innovation, says MD Gupta

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai

Drugmaker Lupin is taking big bets on innovation and will present "a very different story by even as early as next year", said Nilesh Gupta, Lupin Managing Director.

"This is a pivot year for India... the articulation that proprietary products will be a substantial part of our business in India has never been done before," Gupta told *businessline*.

He outlined Lupin's evolving journey, the pharma industry's growth and opportunities for a long-term innovation vision, even as the world presently grapples with a war in West Asia.

"We are (taking big bets)... we've got into it in all earnest," Gupta said, hoping that Lupin "would have a bunch of products in clinical trial ... for first time NCEs (new chemical entities) for India."

There are early innovations in China and Korea, he said, and Lupin would look at these discoveries for further development.

STRONG CAPABILITY

Echoing thoughts similar to industry peers, he said, "I don't think being a large generic player gives you the right to be a large innovation player. The capabilities are different... not necessarily India's strong capability. But India can be leveraged for those capabilities. What I'm loving at this point of time is that we're now starting to operate innovation at two levels... innovation for the world and innovation for India."

Drilling down further, he said in India it could be cardiac molecules, diabetes molecules, respiratory molecules and oncology molecules, all NCEs.

Nilesh Gupta, Managing Director, Lupin

"But the cost of development is lower for just India as a market. The time to market is shorter. And therefore, you can have much more shots on goal... You'll still have failure because you're taking NCE risk eventually," he said, adding that companies are okay with partnering just for India, not giving up their global rights.

"Clearly, we are biting much deeper on the innovation side. We are going to take bigger bites on technology, AI is not an if anymore, it's on when will it make meaningful impact," says Gupta.

WAR CHALLENGES

On helming a business in times of war, Gupta said Covid showed the world how integral the pharma industry is to delivering medicines.

Today is an opportunity to scale even more elsewhere in the world, including India, he said, adding there will be logistics and insurance price increases, for example, but they are short-term and will settle down.

"I would by no means make light of the misfortunes of war," says Gupta. While the present year has been good for Lupin, with revenues over ₹22,707 crore, Gupta said the bigger picture is "innovation at scale... much bigger bites".

Gupta confirmed that Lupin will launch on Day 1 after patent protection expires on semaglutide this week. (Semaglutide is the active ingredient in Novo Nordisk's weightloss and diabetes drugs Wegovy/Ozempic.) It will have two products (different indications), he said.

"You'll see prices coming down 60/70 per cent, at max, from a good player," he said, adding many will launch but the market will settle and not more than 10 (from about 50 branded generics) will be relevant six months later.

INEXPENSIVE DRUG

When medicines go generic (off-patent), products priced about ₹15,000-₹20,000 a month become ₹5,000-₹6,000 or even ₹10,000 a month, he said, lauding the Centre's recent advisory on responsible product use as it becomes available to more people.

Sri Lanka announces 4-day week for public sector to cut fuel use

Meera Srinivasan
Colombo

The Sri Lankan government on Monday announced a four-day working week — declaring Wednesdays off — for government institutions, schools and universities, to conserve fuel as the escalating tensions in West Asia threaten a severe energy crisis.

Addressing a media conference in Colombo, the Commissioner General of Essential Services also encouraged the private sector to consider the option as the island nation, like many others, braces for possible fuel shortages.

ON HOLD

All government functions will be put on hold temporarily, officials said.

However, those employed in essential services including the health sector, ports, water supply and customs departments will function all days.

RATIONING FUEL SALES

The announcement came a day after the Sri Lankan government switched to a QR code-aided digital system to ration retail petrol and diesel sales, limiting weekly quotas to consumers according to the type of vehicle they use.

Meera Srinivasan is *The Hindu* correspondent in Colombo

Dosa taken off flight menus as kitchens try to cut LPG usage

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Dosa and caramel custard may be off in-flight menus in economy cabins as a part of steps initiated by the Kochi-headquartered Casino Air Caterers and Flight Services (CAFS) to reduce LPG consumption.

The firm supplies in-flight meals to domestic and foreign airlines at 11 airports across the country. Air India is CAFS's largest customer and sources meals from a few airports including Chennai, Kochi and Thiruvananthapuram.

Thus passengers on some Air India flights may get served *upma* instead of *dosa* and mousse cake instead of caramel custard.

Domestic flight passengers may be served upma instead

There will be no change in the business and first-class menus.

FRIED FOOD OUT

CAFS CEO VB Rajan said the firm initiated an action plan in view of the LPG shortage and revised menus for domestic airlines, airport lounges, food courts and Vande Bharat trains.

He said CAFS's kitchens consume around 75 cylinders of 19 kg daily and the objective is to reduce LPG consumption by 75 per cent within a week.

CENTRALISED MENU

"The changes include shifting from fried items to steam based products, replacing cooked salads with garden fresh salads and introducing a centralised menu to minimise the preparation of multiple products," he said.

Rajan said electrically-operated hot plates, fryers and tilting pans will be used to manage the crisis without compromising product quality.

Another executive said there would be no rotation in menus in order to reduce complexity.

Air India did not respond to an e-mail query about the latest changes.

'Indian airlines cancelled 4,335 flights due to war'

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Union Civil Aviation Minister K Rammohan Naidu on Monday informed the Rajya Sabha that Indian airlines had cancelled 4,335 flights and foreign carriers 1,187 flights so far in the wake of the West Asia conflict.

Replying to a supplementary query during Question Hour, the Minister asserted that the safety of airline operations is the topmost priority.

AIRSPACE CLOSURE

"Regarding the cancellations that have happened because of airspace closure in West Asia, almost till now, in a cumulative, Indian carriers have cancelled up to 4,335 flights, and foreign carriers have cancelled up to 1,187 flights," Naidu said.

CloudTV eyes growth on replacement boom

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Smart TV operating system platform CloudTV expects the next phase of growth to be driven by replacement demand and expanding smart TV adoption beyond metros.

The platform currently reaches about 7 million devices in India, and nearly 12-13 million users, said Abhijeet Rajpurohit, COO and Co-founder.

CloudTV's operating system is now integrated across over 250 smart TV brands, reflecting its growing presence within India's fast-evolving connected TV ecosystem.

The platform also hosts more than 300 live and FAST (free ad-supported streaming television) channels, alongside over 120 app and content partners, including leading streaming services such as JioHotstar, Prime Video, Zee, Sony and YouTube.

To support its distribution strategy, the company works with more than 25 manufacturing partner companies, enabling TV brands to embed CloudTV's operating system directly into their devices.

The company is also exploring partnerships with multi-system operators and Internet service providers to extend its software ecosystem to older televisions through connected devices and set-top box-style solutions, added Rajpurohit.

SIGNIFICANT GROWTH

Since 2019, the platform has grown at an average of 45 per cent year-on-year, with last year alone seeing close to 70 per cent growth compared to the prior year, said Rajpurohit.

Abhijeet Rajpurohit, COO & Co-founder, CloudTV

As per market intelligence platform Tracxn, the company posted revenue of ₹8.5 crore for FY25, and has trimmed its losses to ₹1.2 crore from ₹1.5 crore in FY24.

"Our primary growth is coming from tier-2 and tier-3 markets, where many households are purchasing their first smart TV. Urban consumers in metro cities have largely already adopted smart TVs, and many are now buying a second or third device for bedrooms or secondary spaces within the same household. In smaller cities, however, we are still seeing first-time adoption, and that is what is truly expanding the market.

Advertising already contributes meaningfully to CloudTV's revenue, though Rajpurohit is clear that the platform is still in an early growth phase.

SMART TV ADOPTION

"Our immediate priority is expanding distribution rather than maximising short-term revenue. India is still at an early stage of smart TV adoption, so our focus is on building scale and presence across devices," he said.

CloudTV's initial focus for international expansion will be South Asia, followed by select markets in the Middle East and North Africa.

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
20 Microns [5]	157.25	151.31	156.10	157.94	146.35	357.81	284.10	146.85	9	151.90
360 One WAM	1027.40	1022.90	1025.00	1038.90	1010.30	331.16	1273.80	790.50	-	-
3i Infotech	12.81	12.86	12.91	13.05	12.68	447.67	27.45	12.68	-	-
3M India	32985.00	32970.00	32985.00	33100.00	32005.00	7.97	38300.00	26800.05	113	33035.20
5PAISA	300.10	292.55	300.75	300.75	288.35	57.98	431.80	287.95	21	291.60
63 MoonsTe [2]	555.00	545.70	555.00	570.55	538.90	199.23	1130.00	538.95	59	545.40

A

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Aadhar Hsg	459.75	478.75	457.95	481.80	451.25	429.40	547.80	399.35	-	-
Aarti Drugs	347.75	339.10	349.00	349.00	335.50	143.94	574.95	312.50	17	338.50
Aarti Ind [5]	420.75	425.15	420.95	429.35	412.65	1349.32	494.00	338.20	42	425.30
Aarti Pharm	650.85	629.35	644.95	665.00	624.55	246.15	971.00	574.45	-	-
Aarti Surfac	364.55	348.95	372.50	372.50	341.00	19.96	653.10	335.55	-	-
Aarvi Encon	127.71	127.72	127.88	130.79	122.23	16.18	152.00	88.00	-	-
Aavas	1169.80	1128.10	1159.50	1164.30	1121.00	321.14	2238.35	1123.70	14	1129.25
AB Capital	310.75	314.60	309.00	317.10	307.50	3069.06	369.25	160.70	28	314.60
AB InfraBuil	16.87	17.01	17.28	17.28	16.84	1029.15	224.98	16.75	-	-
AB Real Est	1134.00	1094.90	1140.00	1142.00	1080.10	332.73	2537.90	1080.10	-	-
AB Sun Life	932.80	952.50	941.30	986.00	935.00	1436.17	1046.55	556.45	-	-
ABB [2]	6392.50	6218.00	6400.00	6417.00	6162.50	371.08	6555.00	4590.05	79	6218.60
ABB Powerpro	24165.00	24205.00	24195.00	24405.00	23400.00	138.19	26325.00	10400.00	-	-
Abbott (I)	26960.00	26670.00	27045.00	27090.00	26605.00	9.44	35921.55	26000.00	37	26678.75
ABFRL	59.28	58.49	59.28	59.44	57.53	4086.27	107.71	57.53	-	58.18
ACC	1376.40	1373.20	1377.00	1386.10	1361.80	278.40	2123.30	1361.00	10	1373.45
ACCELYA	1174.60	1164.30	1179.90	1180.80	1141.10	12.84	1524.55	1135.05	15	1161.40
Accuracy Shp	4.04	3.90	3.95	4.06	3.76	183.65	9.61	3.76	-	-
ACME Solar	255.61	244.89	255.45	260.00	242.00	2068.00	324.30	172.63	-	-
Action Cons [2]	840.55	817.30	839.95	839.95	810.15	236.77	1390.00	775.00	22	818.10
Acutaas Chem	2083.80	2165.00	2062.20	2175.00	2062.00	548.41	2553.65	1040.50	-	-
Adani Ent [1]	1961.10	1978.00	1961.00	1994.80	1946.60	1465.83	2612.75	1850.00	98	1975.60
Adani Green	861.35	866.95	861.35	873.80	853.00	2609.17	1179.20	767.00	194	866.90
Adani Ports [2]	1363.20	1373.90	1356.60	1383.10	1347.00	3322.09	1584.00	1041.05	159	1372.40
Adani Pwr [2]	146.57	154.06	149.90	155.00	146.40	90227.16	182.75	94.41	29	154.10
Adani T Gas	565.90	522.05	588.95	604.30	514.10	18277.89	798.00	462.80	-	-
Adani Wilm	172.89	172.30	173.00	175.96	171.19	2930.84	291.20	171.19	-	-
Adani.E.Sol	992.30	996.50	987.50	1014.30	969.90	1628.02	1067.70	744.90	-	-
ADF Foods [2]	181.31	180.21	181.55	184.71	178.02	85.27	301.00	168.80	21	179.55
AdityaBirlaL	97.42	95.75	97.41	98.00	94.26	3194.51	175.00	94.26	-	-
AdityaInfote	1619.40	1588.20	1618.00	1619.40	1572.70	93.16	1759.00	1015.00	-	-
AdityaVisi	450.85	444.20	457.00	457.00	436.55	203.41	598.70	327.60	-	-
AdorWelding	958.90	941.40	958.90	959.90	932.70	7.35	1260.00	788.00	-	-

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Garware Hi	3824.90	3850.90	3780.00	3875.20	3700.10	30.71	4782.90	2317.35	-	-
Gateway Dis	53.85	52.16	53.65	53.91	51.39	1378.18	76.50	51.39	-	-
GAUDIUM IVF N	80.97	81.57	81.30	82.90	76.00	757.93	87.15	72.02	-	-
GE Vernova	3604.30	3522.30	3575.00	3600.50	3390.00	772.78	3999.00	1254.00	-	-
Genesys Intl [5]	277.85	275.15	277.40	282.60	268.40	789.84	798.95	258.15	27	275.25
Genus Pwr [1]	246.40	239.50	246.00	248.40	236.25	716.48	430.05	210.70	13	239.00
Geojit Fin	58.83	57.05	58.81	58.81	56.12	527.89	94.79	56.12	-	-
GHCL Text	71.99	73.27	71.70	74.00	71.30	203.30	99.00	65.00	-	-
GIC Housing	141.98	139.50	141.98	143.33	137.30	112.30	206.00	137.40	5	139.00
GICRE [5]	359.85	362.55	359.70	364.00	352.00	366.79	453.60	351.00	8	362.60
Gific Bio Sc [1]	287.45	282.60	284.60	287.10	277.45	64.70	409.00	268.65	56	282.95
Gillette (I)	7979.50	7938.00	8000.00	8000.50	7851.50	17.17	11505.00	7551.05	42	7925.10
GK Energy L	103.04	102.71	103.40	103.99	100.05	261.76	239.60	96.01	-	-
Gland Pharma	1626.60	1609.20	1603.10	1620.00	1573.60	57.55	2131.00	1277.80	-	-
Glaxo Pharma	2424.30	2403.00	2413.00	2432.40	2379.20	43.79	3515.95	2220.00	41	2405.15
Glenmark P [1]	2170.70	2175.40	2172.50	2214.80	2145.00	528.61	2297.20	1336.95	41	2175.60
Global Edu.	98.44	97.83	95.50	99.18	95.00	105.30	112.35	41.00	-	-
Global Hlth	1072.10	1040.80	1075.00	1082.00	1036.00	109.98	1456.50	1010.00	-	-
GlobeCivil	45.44	42.85	44.51	45.41	42.41	177.69	95.00	42.41	-	-
GLOBUS SPR	825.90	808.95	830.00	832.40	800.75	57.40	1303.95	802.15	29	809.90
Glottis Ltd	44.10	43.79	44.00	44.44	43.12	147.12	93.00	42.51	-	-
GM Breweri	964.00	967.15	974.55	992.90	951.45	83.51	1328.00	591.05	14	966.90
GMM Pfaud [2]	870.30	864.90	869.90	870.00	849.15	79.68	1416.30	831.00	57	864.95
GMR Airports	89.26	90.50	90.00	92.05	88.77	15405.96	110.36	73.80	-	-
GMR P&U Inf.	102.84	103.54	103.00	105.20	99.98	1672.94	141.01	97.22	-	-
GNA	388.40	383.70	389.50	391.65	376.60	71.60	470.70	269.80	15	383.75
GNFC	426.15	417.70	426.15	426.55	412.20	222.71	573.25	406.05	10	418.15
GNG Elect	386.65	367.55	380.90	380.90	367.35	398.99	401.70	239.00	-	-
Go Digit	334.65	339.80	334.65	343.00	328.30	136.56	381.40	264.60	-	-
GO Fashion	264.80	249.50	264.90	264.90	238.40	830.61	943.75	238.40	-	-
Goa Carbon	316.65	303.55	316.00	316.00	300.00	22.11	532.30	300.00	-	302.10
GOCL Corp [2]	235.65	230.00	235.65	238.75	225.45	106.34	417.00	226.00	8	231.65
Godavari Bio	281.85	292.50	282.00	297.00	280.20	241.81	348.70	145.00	-	-
Godawari p [1]	251.55	249.15	252.70	253.00	245.30	1688.34	290.00	170.00	21	249.30
Godfrey Phil [2]	2016.60	2019.60	2017.50	2034.50	1970.10	376.19	3945.00	1856.15	25	2019.65
Godrej Agro	568.95	574.70	571.75	580.60	565.35	119.48	876.30	506.70	20	575.65
Godrej Con [1]	1027.90	1041.10	1027.30	1047.20	1019.50	2299.41	1308.40	1020.00	76	1040.75
Godrej Ind [1]	837.95	859.55	837.00	866.65	814.40	81.45	1391.50	800.05	-	860.85
Godrej prop [5]	1577.40	1560.00	1578.00	1593.00	1543.00	841.22	2505.00	1476.05	113	1560.75
Gokaldas [5]	578.20	577.45	578.00	581.00	558.20	483.78	1060.00	531.60	22	577.15
Gokul Agro [1]	159.72	159.17	159.99	164.79	154.25	294.48	221.40	96.00	19	158.05
GOKUL REF [2]	40.70	40.12	42.00	42.00	38.41	89.67	54.00	31.07	-	40.10
Goldiam Int [2]	296.55	291.90	297.00	299.50	285.00	544.67	444.35	252.00	78	292.40
Good Luck [2]	1022.40	1024.80	1010.00	1033.20	1001.30	139.67	1352.80	608.00	20	1027.00
Gopal Snacks	269.40	269.30	275.00	275.05	265.55	157.94	398.00	255.90	-	-
GPPL	151.92	150.71	151.85	153.15	148.05	1123.94	200.00	121.30	16	150.75
GPT Health.	124.42	123.03	124.05	127.44	120.00	147.47	185.00	119.34	-	-
GPT Infra	103.38	99.41	103.00	103.05	96.61	305.81	149.75	92.01	14	99.05
GR Infrapro	924.15	910.25	921.00	921.00	892.50	20.59	1444.40	892.50	-	-
Granules Ind [1]	562.20	567.00	560.50	572.70	555.75	661.43	627.45	412.05	36	566.05
Graphite [2]	621.55	613.50	618.50	618.50	591.50	1004.12	747.00	413.00	29	612.55
Grasim Ind. [2]	2568.60	2654.40	2570.00	2661.40	2565.00	1531.88	2980.05	2351.05	468	2654.90
Gravita Ind [2]	1420.00	1399.90	1430.00	1439.90	1382.60	277.30	2169.90	1383.00	34	1401.90
Great Easte	1459.90	1373.40	1450.00	1452.70	1343.70	1140.04	1509.15	817.20	11	1373.95
Greaves Cot [2]	136.07	135.75	136.07	139.34	133.11	1236.68	244.55	133.50	14	135.70
Green pwr	9.91	9.40	9.93	9.95	9.30	5684.74	15.80	8.71	-	9.41
Greenlam [1]	211.06	222.72	211.00	224.08	201.20	85.17	298.28	187.00	42	223.00
Greenpanel I	200.16	192.97	200.16	200.16	190.65	121.19	335.20	190.10	-	-
Greenply Ind [1]	193.18	193.49	194.00	195.00	188.71	145.61	355.51	188.10	27	194.00
Grind Nort [5]	1434.90	1452.90	1436.70	1461.90	1401.10	45.34	1881.35	1403.85	42	1453.20
GRM Overseas	154.44	153.19	154.00	159.00	152.10	1460.69	517.70	151.00	-	-
GRSE	2309.20	2304.50	2314.00	2336.50	2242.00	808.96	3535.00	1303.45	38	2304.70
GSFC [2]	156.07	154.46	156.39	158.15	150.60	1418.12	220.75	149.55	9	154.65
GTL Infra	1.05	1.03	1.05	1.07	1.01	43065.53	2.16	0.98	-	1.03
GTPL	59.52	56.62	60.10	60.73	55.75	116.21	133.75	55.22	28	56.81
Guj Fluoro	3070.60	3078.70	3055.30	3109.50	2980.50	82.57	4083.55	2916.60	-	-
Guj Petronet	271.60	270.25	272.05	275.45	264.15	493.47	360.00	264.60	22	270.60
Guj. Alkali	430.70	416.40	433.00	433.00	409.15	53.59	700.00	410.00	89	416.20
Guj. Mineral [2]	528.75	532.10	530.00	538.95	523.15	2032.93	651.45	245.50	26	531.90
Gujarat Amb [1]	130.20	126.86	129.30	129.53	122.21	1501.44	149.45	100.05	28	127.05
Gujarat Gas [2]	374.30	365.25	377.00	379.70	356.35	1509.14	508.60	356.50	22	366.15
Gujarat Hea	450.70	454.75	448.40	456.95	441.50	140.25	668.00	442.25	8	454.40
Gujarat Kidn	108.66	105.87	108.52	108.52	105.00	128.49	123.00	98.36	-	-
Gujarat Them	280.95	277.10	278.15	283.80	265.05	100.17	479.00	222.05	-	-
GujIndl Pow	131.27	129.93	131.01	132.00	128.00	481.18	224.00	128.00	14	130.65
Gulf oil Lub [2]	995.60	973.00	995.60	999.70	961.80	74.16	1331.20	962.65	13	972.65
Gulf Petro [5]	30.60	28.61	30.10	30.59	28.27	134.84	51.44	28.27	5	28.69
Gulshan Po [1]	154.47	154.21	153.16	156.44	153.00	100.60	220.00	121.75	12	155.55

H

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
HAL [5]	3914.40	3913.10	3914.40	3938.80	3843.00	1379.00	5166.00	3398.00	30	3913.55
Happi.Minds	393.25	377.35	390.00	390.90	365.15	3617.30	674.85	330.20	-	-
HappyForging	1217.20	1264.00	1200.60	1275.00	1200.60	72.08	1370.00	724.10	-	-
Hariom Pipe	316.20	305.20	315.00	315.05	301.15	171.94	572.20	301.15	-	-
Harsha Eng	350.65	338.05	345.40	350.65	336.00	35.00	451.85	329.95	-	-
HATHWAY C [2]	9.85	9.76	9.84	9.87	9.58	2292.52	17.95	9.57	-	9.76
HATSUN AG [1]	952.80	956.75	941.00	964.90	933.30	24.92	1178.80	731.05	55	959.00
Havell's Ind [1]	1310.20	1297.30	1310.00	1316.90	1273.00	963.29	1673.20	1250.15	53	1296.35
HBL Engg L	658.50	656.25	658.95	667.55	641.20	1402.61	1122.00	405.00	-	-
HCG	543.80	549.05	543.80	564.70	538.20	259.45	799.35	489.27	308	550.35
HCL Infosys [2]	12.12	11.92	12.12	12.41	11.90	154.53	24.39	11.78	-	11.92
HCL Tech. [2]	1325.40	1328.60	1312.80	1337.70	1302.40	3618.38	1770.00	1275.70	29	1328.70
HDB FinSer	642.55	642.15	641.05	643.80	633.00	512.80	891.90	633.00	-	-
HDFC Bank [1]	817.00	840.60	817.00	844.50	815.65	52182.61	1020.35	812.00	18	840.50
HDFCAMC [5]	2381.00	2367.20	2384.00	2397.80	2323.00	1973.37	2965.00	1762.53	35	2366.55
HDFCLIFE	625.75	626.00	625.00	630.55	617.20	2750.36	820.50	617.25	72	625.85
HEG [2]	496.05	498.60	495.40	502.00	476.50	1172.61	672.20	394.25	34	497.05
HEIDEL CEM	151.05	149.49	151.00	151.50	147.91	87.77	224.60	148.05	24	149.45
Hemisphere	133.30	128.78	133.10	133.21	127.10	639.46	190.69	111.03	-	-
Heranba Ind	172.91	171.60	173.49	174.60	167.00	77.18	403.70	167.00	-	-
HeritageFo [5]	306.35	308.80	306.95	312.45	304.60	296.45	541.60	296.15	20	309.35
Hero Motoc [2]	5206.00	5278.50	5198.50	5329.00	5124.50	466.61	6390.00	3322.60	21	5277.05
HexawareTech	411.35	416.95	407.40	420.15	402.05	835.28	900.00	402.05	-	-
HG Infra	487.95	489.10	486.90	494.20	472.10	223.05	1272.10	471.45	7	488.10
HGSL	367.15	362.40	367.00	367.10	352.20	59.61	628.80	341.60	-	361.30
Highway Infr	50.07	49.14	49.32	49.91	48.80	124.81	131.40	47.47	-	-
Hikal [2]	172.41	169.24	172.00	173.87	166.50	369.76	456.60	166.55	83	169.15
HIMACHAL F [1]	71.97	71.27	72.32	72.95	69.30	20368.20	93.95	59.83	-	71.34
Himadri Sp [1]	438.85	440.85	434.00	444.90	421.00	1921.37	534.35	351.40	31	440.50
Himat.Seide [5]	83.31	81.30	83.11	83.61	79.10	634.16	168.85	79.12	7	81.46
Hind Rectifi [2]	1432.20	1456.50	1430.00	1478.40	1386.00	39.45	2101.00	817.25	48	1458.65
Hind Uni [1]	2160.00	2175.70	2169.60	2186.70	2154.00	1981.51	2734.31	2105.10	48	2174.45
HIND.CONST [1]	15.33	14.93	15.52	15.52	14.60	31626.43	31.47	14.62	11	14.96
HIND.COPP [5]	496.30	477.55	488.05	494.80	472.50	11893.74	759.20	183.90	69	477.65
Hind.Foods	470.65	470.70	469.65	473.90	463.05	39.86	608.00	421.50	-	-
Hind.oil Exp	144.96	126.95	145.04	145.34	117.65	3839.20	197.80	117.90	10	126.65
Hind.Znc [2]	551.95	533.85	548.00	551.90	529.60	7774.89	732.60	385.05	19	533.75
HINDALCO [1]	910.05	921.15	906.85	943.15	901.30	10755.61	1029.60	546.25	24	921.10
Hindware HME	199.70	191.12	199.00	199.00	185.20	226.14	392.70	180.00	-	-
Hitech Pipes	78.51	75.82	77.33	78.27	75.40	760.07	235.00	117.30	29	139.35
HLE Glascoat	293.65	288.45	296.60	301.95	284.50	142.48	661.95	220.57	-	-
HLV	7.21	6.98	7.29	7.29	6.90	503.13	15.75	6.68	-	-
Home FirstFi	987.70	989.20	982.80	1007.90	977.50	400.73	1519.00	878.40	-	-
Honasa Cons.	268.95	265.90	265.40	267.85	261.60	452.20	334.20	205.01	-	-
Honda Siel	1989.60	2046.30	1998.80	2080.00	1922.20	10.70	3251.00	1827.20	25	2038.15
HONEYWELL	30050.00	29305.00	30100.00	30250.00	29085.00	3.34	41599.80	29105.00	50	29277.00
HPCL	368.75	353.80	361.00	364.95	348.30	14657.70	508.45	319.75	5	354.55
HPL	312.30	273.45	297.00	297.00	266.40	1840.70	639.50	267.00	19	273.40
Hubtown	197.02	190.33	198.00	202.83	187.10	1281.44	366.00	149.90	22	190.10
HUDCO	172.70	172.12	172.70	173.55	168.90	3356.61	253.80	167.60	12	172.25
Huhtamaki In	161.41	160.84	161.55	162.88	156.67	210.78	272.65	156.67	-	-
HyundaiMotor	2018.00	1963.90	2004.00	2009.00	1930.30	1324.04	2890.00	1541.70	-	-

I

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
ICDS	54.44	50.28	59.88	59.88	49.56	158.78	68.49	36.40	-	-
ICE Make Ref	788.70	794.55	790.05	810.00	773.85	51.53	1088.75	666.30	-	-
ICICI Bank [2]	1254.80	1272.90	1255.00	1276.80	1240.10	22740.69	1494.10	1240.15	19	1273.00
ICICI PRUD AMC	2879.70	2884.00	2853.10	2903.60	2819.70	248.86	3193.00	2530.00	-	-
ICICIGI	1837.10	1850.50	1836.20	1855.00	1806.60	725.66	2074.85	1660.20	34	1850.05
ICICIPruLife	583.75	583.90	580.00	589.15	578.00	1391.78	706.50	517.00	61	583.90
ICRA	5265.50	5235.00	5226.00	5300.00	5161.50	3.76	7135.35	5105.90	38	5218.80
IDBI	92.18	76.90	82.12	82.84	76.11	125045.17	118.45	72.04	9	77.00
IDEA CELL	9.27	9.39	9.32	9.74	9.29	550904.01	12.80	6.12	-	9.40
Ideaforge	404.80	392.50	404.80	407.85	385.35	364.12	659.85	304.20	-	-
IDFCFirstBnk	62.57	62.81	62.49	63.20	61.30	43729.89	87.00	52.46	-	-
IEX [1]	120.25	118.80	120.28	120.89	117.19	6559.29	215.40	117.15	23	118.75
IFB	990.40	972.80	998.70	998.70	961.90	64.11	2024.90	962.65	30	969.95
IFB Agro	714.85	683.35	714.85	719.85	679.15	26.49	1795.00	441.00	12	683.65
IFCI	57.21	55.73	57.49	57.50	54.13	33637.43	74.50	35.67	50	55.74
IFGL	149.05	143.44	150.70	150.70	142.40	56.95	339.50	142.30	22	142.95
IG Petro	338.75	333.70	336.25	352.20	325.90	28.27	519.00	317.80	148	334.95
Igarshi Mot	312.45	306.50	312.45	313.50	301.55	54.95	665.45	301.00	71	308.15
IIFL [2]	477.45	475.45	475.10	479.00	460.85	971.83	674.95	305.55	30	474.30
IIFL Capital	283.65	280.85	280.05	284.00	273.25	818.46	411.30	180.00	-	-
IKIO Light.	126.43	120.72	125.01	126.00	118.58	239.72	304.00	118.58	-	-
IL & FS INVE [2]	6.97	6.84	6.97	7.05	6.21	332.05	10.65	6.70	-	6.81
Imagica Wrld	40.50	39.53	40.01	40.50	38.61	749.90	75.55	37.62	-	-
Ind Glycols [5]	854.60	857.90	850.00	883.05	838.50	178.03	1222.85	502.50	26	856.95
Ind.Inv.Tru	131.39	131.09	128.77	134.00	126.62	19.48	265.80	121.40	50	131.35
Ind.Shelt.Fi	689.65	702.65	704.00	707.00	683.30	211.27	1011.75	650.00	-	-
Indegene	429.25	435.30	430.00	443.70	423.00	461.13	632.90	423.00	-	-
IndHumPip [2]	325.80	313.05	320.35	323.65	310.40	40.32	490.00	295.00	16	313.00
India Nippon [5]	762.50	753.40	762.50	768.00	739.20	14.99	1099.95	545.20	17	752.05
India Pesti.	141.69	140.85	141.70	142.37	136.50	203.21	245.84	123.11	-	-
Indiabulls	9.73	9.99	9.76	10.10	9.30	11931.85	21.25	8.90	-	-
IndiaCements	354.30	355.20	350.00	358.00	344.60	168.82	489.65	252.55	-	355.25
IndiaMart In	2101.90	2108.00	2100.20	2140.00	2074.90	125.69	2799.00	1900.10	-	-
Indian Bank	870.30	877.45	865.00	884.60	848.65	2341.80	1000.00	490.15	10	876.85
Indian Htl [1]	609.85	613.35	610.00	617.20	595.00	3356.82	858.85	595.00	55	613.35
INDIAN MET	1177.60	1190.20	1177.60	1203.70	1166.10	77.36	1511.05	550.85	18	1188.35
IndianOilCo	156.54	148.96	153.01	154.60	146.88	35687.08	188.90	120.05	6	149.20
IndianOverBk	32.61	32.21	32.50	32.54	31.59	6890.44	45.19	31.58	13	32.23
IndiaTour De	439.35	426.05	441.00	441.00	419.40	28.67	714.05	421.00	45	427.45
IndigoPaints	786.85	757.70	781.50	785.65	751.00	443.71	1345.90	751.00	-	-
IndiqubeSpac	150.04	142.53	150.04	150.04	141.20	62.64	243.80	141.20	-	-
Indo Amines	95.72	92.95	95.00	96.74	92.13	53.20	176.25	92.13	-	-
INDO COU [2]	234.55	233.25	235.95	237.00	227.85	276.89	350.70	210.70	40	233.75
Indo Farm Eq	125.39	124.17	125.39	127.15	122.00	214.72	271.69	122.00	-	-
Indo Rama	32.67	31.95	32.97	33.30	30.30	385.83	74.94	29.10	7	32.15
INDO THAI [1]	250.20	255.75	256.40	259.00	245.55	474.90	470.00	144.00	86	255.70
IndocoRem [2]	196.28	189.11	196.11	198.39	188.00	42.08	348.10	188.00	-	189.60
IndogulfCrop	61.30	59.58	61.01	61.05	58.60	182.98	122.00	58.60	-	-
INDOSTAR	194.41	195.61	195.00	199.02	189.11	174.63	368.55	185.10	-	196.80
IndoTech Tra	1318.80	1247.20	1348.80	1351.20	1235.30	23.39	2790.15	1138.95	15	1248.50
Indrapra Gas [2]	156.51	155.49	156.90	157.72	152.20	1976.28	229.20	152.10	15	155.50
Indraprastha	382.90	391.60	383.55	395.15	375.05	323.59	640.05	317.25	20	391.85
IndSwifLab	137.34	137.14	138.65	139.74	135.11	239.18	151.95	67.15	25	137.40
IndusInd BK	814.40	825.05	814.55	830.00	806.20	3107.01	968.60	618.05	-	824.95
IndusTowers	423.95	427.10	425.00	430.65	418.45	3446.84	481.50	312.55	-	-
INFO EDGE [2]	952.40	949.60	950.00	955.30	932.20	2203.29	1549.00	933.45	57	947.85
Infobeans Te	123.52	134.22	123.53	135.87	121.00	1259.46	1030.00	120.33	-	-
INFOSYS [5]	1248.30	1249.80	1240.20	1254.30	1224.20	12314.45	1727.85	1225.00	18	1249.60
Ingersoll	3681.00	3647.60	3655.00	3725.90	3564.10	13.38	4449.95	3070.00	42	3653.30
Innova Cap	713.55	707.00	705.60	722.95	688.60	55.26	1020.70	622.00	-	-
Inox Grn Enr	143.97	141.11	143.50	146.39	139.27	1680.61	279.00	104.00	-	-
Inox India	1136.50	1144.40	1138.50	1155.90	1117.00	52.53	1288.00	892.25	-	-
Inox Wind	79.59	78.40	79.70	81.10	77.18	13302.82	198.14	77.20	21	78.45
INSECTCID	575.35	569.30	570.05	577.90	554.90	51.06	1096.30	531.60	12	567.25
INSOLATION E	95.23	91.97	97.20	98.65	91.11	1077.29	104.90	91.11	-	-
INTELLECT [5]	660.75	645.20	666.75	666.75	642.00	290.74	1255.00	555.05	39	644.10
InterarchBui	1724.00	1716.60	1706.50	1747.00	1690.00	74.76	2762.60	1264.00	-	-
InterGlobeAv	4158.20	4222.10	4105.00	4270.00	4093.90	1792.86	6225.05	4035.65	36	4222.50
Intl Convey.	72.44	70.34	70.90	74.00	70.00	68.45	114.54	64.50	-	-
Intl Gemm In	308.85	306.15	310.00	314.00	296.05	450.66	442.00	287.00	-	-
Inventu Know	1327.30	1330.60	1333.90	1378.00	1315.70	251.21	1876.00	1236.80	-	-
IOL Chem [2]	68.82	68.66	68.80	70.07	67.19	1977.54	126.60	57.51	16	68.49
Ion Exch	337.80	340.75	340.50	344.80	332.70	281.04	580.75	322.10	-	-
Ipca Lab [1]	1561.30	1557.00	1565.60	1574.50	1534.10	181.09	1594.55	1200.00	39	1555.20
IRB INFRA [1]	41.56	41.36	41.84	41.87	40.40	9469.08	54.38	36.99	28	41.36
IRCON	130.22	125.83	130.22	130.50	123.71	4930.94	225.52	123.71	-	-
IREDA	114.85	115.19	114.85	116.17	112.07	7970.88	186.58	112.07	-	-
IRFC	97.20	96.44	96.90	97.13	94.32	16521.26	148.95	94.32	-	-
IRIS Bus.	230.43	226.84	229.28	231.58	225.10	29.14	437.50	203.00	-	-
IRIS Cloth.	29.57	29.85	29.65	30.70	28.05	515.89	68.70	28.05	-	-
IRM Energy	211.43	200.56	213.00	213.02	198.10	131.22	393.00	185.00	-	-
IRTC	527.60	526.45	527.70	529.00	518.25	1857.69	820.25	518.25	-	-
ISGEC Hvy	902.30	887.40	908.00	908.00	852.90	114.70	1281.30	683.95	-	-
ITC [1]	301.45	308.25	302.55	309.45	302.00	37472.20	444.15	300.10	19	308.20
ITC Hotels	153.12	154.74	152.00	156.75	146.25	9024.73	261.62	146.25	-	-
ITI	242.30	277.15	243.05	289.80	240.00	87087.97	372.95	232.90	-	276.00
IValue Infos	225.10	226.93	225.08	230.99	220.41	115.94	340.00	213.98	-	-
IWIND ENERGY	8.45	8.36	8.70	8.70	8.28	310.07	23.71	8.00	-	8.43
Ixigo	161.90	161.97	159.90	164.28	159.67	1881.43	339.15	123.29	-	-

J

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
J KUMAR INF [5]	494.00	495.35	491.75	499.00	486.25	159.97	764.00	454.50	9	494.35
J&K Bank [1]	120.81	123.66	121.14	125.61	116.49	12077.83	128.45	82.01	6	123.65
J.K.INDUST [2]	411.75	418.40	412.60	422.15	399.00	1537.84	611.60	231.65	17	418.45
Jagran Prak [2]	61.40	61.32	61.64	61.99	60.02	526.09	83.99	60.10	5	61.38
Jagson Phar [2]	182.96	183.72	182.75	184.98	180.78	282.89	301.80	154.90	29	184.15
Jai Corp [1]	97.51	96.48	98.29	98.29	94.31	456.81	178.00	81.27	10	96.40
JaiBalaj.Ind	62.45	62.74	62.30	63.69	60.38	2835.17	668.00	81.00	-	-
JAIN IRRIG [2]	32.06	31.25	31.90	34.00	31.00	6249.97	66.40	30.98	-	31.27
Jain Resourc	428.45	424.85	421.60	428.00	413.15	1388.62	461.00	247.57	-	-
Jamna Aut [1]	117.56	118.89	117.00	120.80	116.07	2148.93	152.50	70.00	20	118.60
Jana SFB	353.05	348.35	353.05	353.10	342.35	300.36	552.50	333.60	-	-
Jaro InsofT	429.05	462.50	429.55	472.50	428.00	1248.15	890.00	386.00	-	-
Jash Engg	363.00	366.15	352.40	382.90	352.10	248.55	698.95	351.10	-	-
JAY NECO IND	71.27	70.69	71.20	72.59	69.75	3953.30	94.30	26.06	18	70.56
JayBh Maru [2]	88.40	86.09	88.85	89.72	85.16	143.77	115.63	55.32	11	86.25
Jaykay Enter	128.12	125.83	129.99	130.00	122.89	331.88	219.70	122.89	-	-
JB Chem [1]	2121.80	2090.20	2136.00	2177.00	2065.00	605.83	2171.40	1303.00	46	2088.60
JBM Auto [1]	494.30	486.20	499.85	500.40	477.00	418.61	790.00	477.00	71	486.65
JeenaSikhoLi	582.05	585.85	577.00	590.00	570.60	235.76	2450.00	400.25	-	-
JG Chem.	329.05	330.65	330.05	335.00	317.10	97.76	558.00	280.45	-	-
JIN POLY INV	1231.30	1229.70	1241.00	1282.50	1185.00	169.55	1480.00	621.15	2	1224.30
Jindal Drill [5]	474.10	474.20	470.10	485.00	451.00	817.18	981.00	440.00	7	478.00
Jindal Poly	929.65	924.50	920.05	958.15	894.45	659.30	961.60	359.90	16	925.75
Jindal Saw [1]	191.33	196.67	190.88	203.79	187.00	25191.39	286.50	153.20	11	197.00
JINDAL SOUTH	15537.00	16241.00	15630.00	16635.00	15284.00	2.66	27760.50	15284.00	150	16226.35
Jindal Sta [2]	707.45	709.90	706.90	715.95	674.15	1358.18	883.25	497.00	21	710.60
Jindal Ste [1]	1143.30	1133.00	1137.00	1156.20	1124.20	1403.67	1270.00	770.00	26	1132.45
Jindal Wor [1]	21.06	20.63	21.06	21.13	20.25	452.66	79.32	20.25	-	20.66
JindalPho	1185.80	1177.70	1203.60	1216.80	1150.10	35.87	1634.80	592.35	282	1173.00
Jinkushal In	55.26	51.20	54.43	54.99	50.13	114.71	126.95	50.00	-	-
JioFin Servi	235.25	234.35	235.00	238.00	230.70	14936.67	338.60	203.10	-	-
JK Cement	5002.00	5061.00	4967.00	5103.00	4869.00	65.09	7565.00	4225.00	36	5061.35
JK Lakshmi [5]	598.55	583.75	601.70	607.15	574.55	239.43	1020.85	575.00	15	583.30
JK PAPER	335.95	326.00	332.00	335.95	318.30	450.54	444.45	288.00	25	325.95
JM Financial [1]	118.44	119.30	119.60	121.80	115.00	4063.70	199.75	78.00	14	119.45
JNK India	233.63	243.12	233.99	246.80	229.10	261.27	419.55	200.92	-	-
JPPOWER	13.90	13.50	13.94	13.98	13.40	39185.34	27.62	12.60	-	13.49
JSW Cement	115.81	116.46	115.81	117.69	114.99	1742.78	162.15	106.65	-	-
JSW energy	512.95	505.15	512.95	516.90	496.05	3366.98	578.85	428.00	99	504.55
JSW Infra	253.40	250.40	252.95	253.35	245.90	1235.64	349.00	243.00	-	-
JSWSL [1]	1119.30	1145.60	1121.50	1150.00	1120.10	2593.20	1284.55	907.25	39	1145.20
JTL Indus.	52.28	52.26	51.80	52.92	51.51	1307.05	85.99	50.16	-	-
Jub.Ingrevia	557.60	550.05	560.50	561.10	540.10	441.36	851.80	535.20	-	-
Jub.Pharmova	844.20	839.95	830.10	845.20	816.65	142.88	1248.00	786.05	-	-
Jubilant Agr	1610.30	1626.00	1615.50	1646.40	1582.80	7.23	3013.40	1020.00	-	-
JUBL FOOD [2]	458.15	467.80	460.00	472.20	448.35	2085.26	743.95	448.50	126	467.45
Juniper Hot	198.00	203.31	198.47	209.98	196.51	194.33	345.55	193.74	-	-
Jupiter Life	1250.20	1272.00	1240.90	1287.00	1240.90	22.80	1770.00	1198.80	-	-
Jupiter Wag	262.15	262.30	262.00	265.30	255.40	2183.76	457.00	246.20	-	-
JUSTDIAL	523.05	517.30	516.05	525.00	509.00	166.80	1049.85	509.80	8	516.90
JYOTHY LAB [1]	219.65	214.90	219.65	228.30	213.50	1539.37	399.95	212.75	23	214.85
Jyoti CNC Au	715.95	705.70	715.95	721.80	686.75	421.95	1330.00	686.75	-	-
Jyoti Struct [2]	10.97	10.49	11.00	11.02	10.28	12511.57	22.19	7.92	-	10.50

K

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
K.P.R. MILL [1]	839.20	826.10	844.80	858.30	807.00	549.77	1395.40	796.05	48	826.20
Kajaria Cere [1]	910.15	888.90	905.00	908.25	870.00	343.86	1322.00	745.00	40	889.60
Kalpataru Lt	303.45	295.70	299.00	299.80	290.25	87.58	457.40	286.00	-	-
KalpataruPro	1102.00	1088.10	1096.60	1099.60	1063.50	73.08	1335.60	786.30	-	-
Kalyan Jwl.	379.00	381.60	379.00	386.70	373.75	2535.41	617.70	347.50	-	-
KALYANI S [5]	663.50	649.10	663.50	663.50	639.60	38.04	988.00	636.95	11	657.25
Kamat Hotels	188.55	182.46	186.00	188.59	179.50	90.63	368.95	160.25	13	182.85
KAMDHENU [1]	21.93	21.89	21.89	22.00	21.44	1195.85	35.96	20.50	8	21.81
Kamdhenu Ven	4.47	4.31	4.47	4.49	4.20	599.88	12.49	3.95	-	-
Kansai Nero [1]	182.14	177.43	182.00	184.00	176.02	553.64	274.80	176.00	22	177.55
Karnataka Bk	223.61	217.70	225.00	225.01	211.05	5109.65	232.85	163.10	7	218.45
KarurVysya [2]	282.10	284.60	277.55	286.65	272.35	4025.83	343.55	155.29	12	284.50
KAVERI SEED [2]	810.90	810.15	792.10	818.50	784.00	104.68	1601.85	705.80	15	812.35
KaynesTech	3475.60	3555.00	3490.00	3580.10	3420.00	1484.90	7705.00	3294.90	-	-
KCP [1]	141.25	140.43	142.15	142.72	136.62	235.77	229.80	136.60	19	140.75
KDDL	2209.70	2170.60	2199.90	2221.00	2130.40	48.12	3350.00	2067.25	41	2169.55
KEC Inter [2]	549.05	534.60	549.05	549.50	525.35	1503.29	947.30	517.90	37	535.50
KEI Inds [2]	4158.00	4174.00	4117.00	4218.00	4063.00	311.51	5301.10	2443.70	46	4171.85
KELLTON [1]	16.84	16.45	16.86	16.86	16.13	1831.44	33.10	14.57	-	16.46
Kernex Micro	982.20	938.60	975.00	981.90	922.90	252.05	1433.95	625.55	32	940.95
Kewal Kiran	461.45	450.20	461.45	462.60	444.00	71.16	594.35	422.15	21	453.30
Keystone Rlt	382.35	379.20	387.35	387.35	371.00	115.24	697.00	371.00	-	-
KFIN Tech	892.55	901.35	893.00	913.80	889.10	700.24	1388.50	828.80	-	-
KHADIM	101.13	96.94	103.40	103.40	96.02	79.74	310.70	96.45	18	97.15
Khaitan Chm	51.85	50.13	52.26	52.26	47.77	395.80	135.80	43.17	-	-
Kilos oil [2]	1451.30	1470.20	1449.00	1509.00	1421.50	625.94	1529.40	585.75	46	1467.35
KIMS	634.90	646.10	634.95	652.00	627.00	234.01	798.40	528.05	-	-
Kingfa	4095.30	4192.40	4100.00	4330.00	4051.00	9.15	4987.00	2451.00	34	4215.40
KIOCL	301.00	296.90	301.95	301.95	290.65	101.35	634.35	188.15	-	296.80
KIRI DYES	385.75	381.15	383.00	388.40	370.35	587.29	778.00	370.40	86	381.85
KIRL INDUS	2691.90	2731.40	2705.40	2750.00	2647.10	6.99	4650.00	2620.00	37	2731.85
KIRL.BROS. [2]	1520.20	1518.40	1509.10	1529.90	1469.50	54.43	2475.55	1405.65	46	1518.85
Kirlosk.Elec	79.18	78.51	79.00	79.50	77.10	209.30	100.80	26.95	15	-
Kirlosk.Pne	1077.80	1053.80	1074.60	1075.00	1040.00	47.45	1550.00	990.10	-	-
KITEX GARM [1]	165.10	159.65	166.97	166.97	156.41	773.38	320.95	138.45	44	159.60
KM Sugar Ml [2]	25.54	24.58	25.10	25.53	24.27	129.58	33.50	22.50	4	24.61
Knowledg.Mar	1525.30	1538.80	1517.70	1550.00	1475.00	72.80	3758.50	1264.05	-	-
KNR CONST [2]	122.72	120.77	122.72	124.20	119.10	1286.39	254.15	117.10	20	121.05
KOHINORFO	24.02	22.90	23.22	24.00	22.44	99.60	46.00	22.31	-	22.80
KOKUYOCM [1]	76.75	77.45	77.98	78.59	75.32	60.30	137.70	72.02	30	78.04
KOLTEPATIL	327.75	330.30	327.95	331.80	325.30	76.04	497.80	310.00	92	329.35
Kopran Ltd	116.25	113.47	115.67	117.08	111.50	222.38	214.65	111.55	27	113.65
Kotak Mah [1]	366.85	369.85	366.85	373.35	364.05	27927.29	460.31	363.45	27	370.00
KOTHARI PR [5]	108.63	104.57	106.00	108.49	102.35	40.65	0.15	0.05	-	-
KOTYARK INDUS	362.80	350.00	362.80	363.60	332.60	76.28	371.80	316.00	-	-
KP Energy	279.90	277.45	281.00	281.95	268.30	267.71	583.70	237.90	-	-
KPI Grn Enr	401.60	380.30	401.65	403.80	369.25	2460.06	563.00	335.65	-	-
KPIT Tech	660.15	631.95	660.00	664.10	629.20	3226.45	1434.50	629.20	-	-
KRBL. [1]	307.50	290.35	305.50	306.85	288.75	977.66	495.00	225.70	10	290.65
Krishana Ph.	482.65	474.35	487.90	487.90	468.60	31.26	619.00	210.00	-	-
Krishna def	994.00	930.90	980.50	992.10	917.40	250.23	1240.00	530.10	-	-
Kritika Wire	4.98	5.18	4.98	5.36	4.98	293.35	11.22	4.82	-	-
KRN Heat Ex.	856.00	850.25	855.00	867.40	823.30	841.85	1031.80	589.80	-	-
Kronox Lab	113.62	110.84	111.20	115.99	108.90	100.97	207.49	105.50	-	-
Kross	181.15	181.21	182.53	185.21	173.96	578.82	237.60	150.06	-	-
Krsnaa Dia.	603.65	599.65	596.05	606.80	587.80	199.42	894.40	579.15	-	-
Krystal Int.	569.35	550.95	570.00	589.95	550.00	72.65	729.50	423.05	-	-
KSB	751.00	752.60	745.05	757.00	738.30	70.75	912.00	647.80	-	-
KSH Internat	387.40	406.00	387.40	412.65	381.35	215.35	420.00	330.00	-	-
KSolves Ind	274.05	271.55	270.15	273.90	265.40	45.46	497.00	250.05	-	-
Kuantum Pap.	79.46	78.02	79.55	79.91	75.35	115.24	135.00	75.35	-	-
KWALITY WALL'S	24.82	24.23	24.98	25.07	23.95	9174.08	31.29	23.95	-	-

L

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
L & T [2]	3439.00	3469.40	3453.50	3494.80	3396.60	8459.23	4440.00	2967.65	42	3463.85
L&T Finance	258.00	260.65	257.00	262.50	255.15	3213.13	329.45	138.64	-	-
Lal path lab	1355.10	1341.00	1355.20	1364.80	1326.90	205.39	1771.30	1187.50	42	1340.45
Landmark Car	362.55	359.90	360.00	377.95	356.90	82.48	662.80	329.80	-	-
LA-OPALA [2]	187.49	186.89	187.42	188.77	182.42	78.93	286.00	182.50	20	186.25
Latent View	280.25	280.85	280.95	285.00	273.65	1131.23	517.50	273.65	-	-
Laurus Labs [2]	1003.40	960.80	997.70	1013.90	951.80	2979.58	1140.90	517.05	65	960.85
Laxmi Organ.	116.60	116.68	115.68	119.25	114.60	1045.97	241.00	110.15	-	-
LaxmiDent	178.51	172.72	177.30	178.44	171.20	99.62	509.95	171.20	-	-
LaxmiIndFin	81.25	79.43	82.32	84.60	77.82	226.75	180.90	77.82	-	-
LEMONTREE	101.11	103.02	101.11	103.77	99.61	5551.38	180.60	99.70	71	102.90
Lenskart Sol	499.80	498.70	500.90	510.85	487.80	4732.19	541.80	356.10	-	-
LG Balkrish	1798.30	1749.00	1795.10	1795.10	1700.60	56.98	2096.95	1080.00	19	1747.30
LG Electroni	1562.00	1537.30	1555.00	1570.00	1520.10	552.15	1749.00	1325.50	-	-
LIBERTY SHOE	262.47	261.61	275.00	277.77	260.42	174.88	474.80	210.05	38	260.95
LIC	772.70	777.35	770.00	784.90	759.10	1221.31	980.00	737.70	-	-
LIC Housing [2]	496.60	501.50	496.95	504.45	490.30	2286.16	646.60	488.60	5	501.35
LikhithaInfr	141.84	142.09	148.40	148.40	137.02	70.56	324.00	137.02	-	-
Lincoln Phar	603.25	584.30	603.25	605.00	571.00	38.16	679.45	439.95	13	584.00
LINDEINDIA	6944.50	7172.50	6850.00	7242.50	6840.00	89.40	7865.05	5202.45	105	7168.65
Lloyds Engg	41.85	41.30	41.60	41.99	40.44	3994.12	84.27	40.44	-	-
Lloyds Met.	1140.80	1147.20	1149.00	1157.00	1119.90	522.47	1612.00	1015.00	-	-
LMW	13952.00	14464.00	13952.00	14580.00	13652.00	5.74	18250.00	13500.00	-	-
Lokesh Machi	199.10	203.60	200.00	208.00	193.80	98.62	255.90	129.25	-	204.70
Looyds Ent.	47.63	45.88	47.78	48.01	45.11	4018.40	96.40	37.28	-	-
LT Foods	385.25	383.60	385.55	388.95	375.00	944.26	518.55	288.25	-	-
LTIMINDTREE	4206.50	4207.10	4214.90	4274.00	4160.10	220.85	6429.50	3802.00	-	-
LTTS [2]	3430.10	3324.90	3457.00	3457.00	3240.00	703.28	4750.00	3046.85	28	3325.90
Lumax Ind	4813.50	4902.00	4750.00	4949.50	4750.00	29.74	6969.90	2150.00	30	4896.55
Lumax Tech [2]	1434.00	1452.40	1440.00	1465.80	1394.50	233.07	1823.75	452.55	112	1451.75
Lupin Ltd. [2]	2314.90	2290.40	2301.10	2312.00	2251.00	614.81	2376.00	1774.00	19	2290.15
LUXIND [2]	863.75	867.40	864.00	874.00	840.00	45.68	1640.00	805.05	23	869.40
Lyka Labs	52.29	53.14	52.00	54.49	51.11	112.58	128.60	51.45	-	53.35

M

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
M&M FinSer [2]	330.20	319.55	328.00	330.40	314.70	2087.23	412.30	235.46	17	319.40
Macpower CNC	903.05	891.75	948.80	975.00	871.90	17.91	1090.00	601.20	-	-
Macrote.Dev.	866.35	848.75	868.00	874.60	831.95	1542.88	1531.00	831.95	-	-
Madhya Bh.Ag	446.50	449.30	438.05	453.95	438.05	344.23	489.45	240.00	-	-
MagellanicCl	22.07	21.78	22.07	22.33	21.50	1006.67	105.42	21.20	-	-
MAH HOLIDAY	264.15	264.05	260.00	266.65	259.30	177.41	381.55	241.00	22	265.15
Mah Logis	368.85	375.65	368.85	381.25	363.55	245.59	435.35	218.20	100	377.05
Mah&Mah [5]	2931.10	3036.10	2902.00	3043.70	2896.00	5378.64	3840.00	2360.45	25	3035.70
Mah.seamle [5]	549.80	559.90	549.80	564.00	539.30	194.69	774.00	500.00	9	561.75
Maha.Scooter	12629.00	12386.00	12602.00	12603.00	12206.00	3.60	18526.00	9225.05	46	12382.75
MahaSteelInd	997.65	942.30	982.70	982.70	898.00	14.94	1061.85	224.20	185	942.90
MAHINDRALIFE	346.55	342.80	343.10	347.75	338.85	107.64	428.35	253.81	99	344.25
Maithan All	926.70	898.00	925.00	926.70	887.10	55.17	1265.00	834.05	6	898.30
MamataMach	384.65	377.20	380.05	384.60	375.00	58.11	541.00	311.55	-	-
Man ind [5]	395.70	396.45	395.70	399.95	382.95	297.08	490.90	248.15	18	396.35
Man Infra [2]	94.69	93.01	94.20	95.22	91.41	538.68	191.90	91.70	23	92.85
Manali Petro [5]	45.93	44.68	45.50	45.79	43.76	403.46	81.00	43.82	-	44.68
Manappur [2]	256.10	251.20	253.85	257.05	246.95	5145.34	320.95	204.30	14	250.95
MandB Eng	282.85	286.65	281.30	288.90	270.00	135.35	535.90	270.00	-	-
Mangalam Cem	794.00	792.80	790.00	811.40	785.05	59.23	939.30	640.00	27	792.30
MangalElec	228.58	233.04	225.75	236.76	222.16	149.58	573.70	222.16	-	-
Mankind Phr	2138.90	2094.70	2126.30	2141.60	2081.00	332.07	2716.50	2012.30	-	-
ManojVaibGem	148.99	150.59	147.00	153.99	145.13	127.94	280.00	145.13	-	-
Manomay Tex	209.30	218.64	215.00	219.90	200.44	70.61	259.88	154.10	-	-
Manorama Ind	1276.10	1299.20	1268.00	1311.70	1240.00	130.10	1760.00	849.95	-	-
Marath NX [5]	380.05	381.30	380.10	385.95	370.00	129.66	774.55	368.40	15	379.10
MARICOLTD [1]	752.40	750.10	751.10	752.95	738.50	1976.71	813.10	602.85	50	749.95
Marine Elec.	175.32	174.46	172.69	176.68	170.40	307.47	258.00	155.10	-	-
MarkolinePav	150.16	153.45	150.50	154.80	149.88	245.49	188.00	131.65	-	-
MARKSANS [1]	167.01	164.76	167.84	168.24	162.68	590.41	270.60	157.25	30	164.85
MARSONS	138.54	133.24	138.80	141.89	132.25	491.33	152.00	132.25	-	-
Maruti Udy [5]	12591.00	12757.00	12532.00	12874.00	12400.00	1416.17	17371.60	11072.20	28	12753.30
MASFIN	301.60	294.40	303.20	303.20	292.00	203.47	354.95	230.35	15	294.50
Mastek [5]	1496.80	1471.20	1497.90	1509.00	1440.70	65.27	2817.75	1440.00	24	1468.10
Master Trust	71.09	70.03	70.50	72.45	69.23	195.50	174.40	69.23	-	-
MATRIMONY [5]	379.30	393.35	379.50	412.00	364.05	37.48	598.95	363.30	26	385.65
Max Estate	368.70	362.10	365.00	367.90	357.20	82.34	564.30	341.10	-	-
Max Healthca	990.00	970.60	990.00	999.50	964.20	4063.49	1314.30	933.80	-	-
Max India	145.94	142.22	152.00	153.41	138.60	85.08	241.57	138.60	-	-
MAYUR UN. [5]	504.00	502.05	504.00	506.70	487.15	63.39	629.30	434.90	12	501.80
Mazagon Dock	2328.00	2331.80	2328.50	2348.90	2260.50	1971.20	3775.00	2125.90	-	-
MBL INFRA	22.99	22.01	23.00	23.00	21.11	407.38	56.90	21.00	-	21.68
MCLEOD RU [5]	37.07	35.32	38.00	38.68	35.00	871.99	68.73	29.65	-	35.56
MCX [2]	2498.80	2555.60	2474.00	2577.00	2440.80	3474.37	2706.00	905.35	90	2554.95
Medi Assist	302.00	312.35	304.70	316.55	294.70	350.28	594.10	294.70	-	-
Medicam.Bio	272.15	272.70	272.15	275.95	263.25	32.68	544.00	263.25	-	-
Medico Reme.	40.17	39.65	40.17	40.64	37.86	165.71	62.48	37.18	-	-
Medplus Hlth	849.65	825.75	839.00	845.15	812.35	101.54	1045.30	678.05	-	-
Meesho	137.52	134.77	138.00	138.00	125.56	10825.72	254.40	125.56	-	-
MeghmaniOrg	43.34	41.85	43.34	43.57	41.25	1046.83	106.30	41.25	-	-
Metro Brand	930.20	911.20	926.00	926.00	896.40	71.83	1340.80	896.40	-	-
METROPO [2]	1808.60	1839.40	1821.00	1914.00	1806.20	85.70	2259.30	1383.70	66	1840.40
MFL	63.91	61.85	63.80	64.42	61.00	76.16	24.70	12.15	-	-
MFSL [2]	1628.10	1645.20	1628.10	1656.90	1604.40	789.15	1891.35	1032.90	-	1644.90
MGL	1035.00	1010.20	1035.00	1042.00	989.00	311.27	1586.00	990.00	10	1009.65
MIC Electr.	33.45	32.11	33.30	33.40	31.81	895.44	82.97	31.81	-	-
Midhani	312.90	306.00	312.70	313.20	298.40	547.53	468.40	217.05	52	306.10
Midwest Ltd	1172.60	1181.70	1172.00	1200.00	1141.40	31.75	1859.90	1048.50	-	-
MINDACORP [2]	480.85	481.10	480.85	483.70	470.35	231.45	644.35	445.25	56	481.65
MindTeck(I)	182.20	168.91	180.10	181.16	163.56	177.38	307.00	141.00	24	168.80
MINERAL&M [1]	53.29	52.55	53.00	53.43	51.78	1291.75	88.20	42.55	-	52.51
Mirc Elect [1]	24.50	23.47	24.50	24.50	22.68	1261.48	37.47	10.30	-	23.46
MM Forgings	429.35	427.00	433.55	438.15	419.00	64.61	500.00	276.05	20	427.80
MMP Ind	210.30	221.43	211.00	226.30	211.00	52.68	318.00	201.99	-	-
Mnkcmil Ltd [1]	111.74	112.64	111.00	113.50	109.39	187.49	182.80	71.56	29	112.50
Modison	118.02	116.81	118.03	119.73	115.00	41.85	197.45	112.00	-	-
MOIL	260.15	248.05	260.15	260.40	247.00	1496.85	405.50	247.50	17	248.20
MOLDTKPA [5]	495.55	496.90	493.00	506.75	475.00	183.25	890.00	415.00	24	497.00
Monarch Netw	258.80	265.00	260.10	268.00	252.00	148.63	398.80	239.85	-	-
Montecarlo	503.85	506.65	506.50	510.50	493.60	25.43	865.00	489.80	11	508.65
Morepen La [2]	38.11	37.75	38.11	38.37	36.80	2930.85	70.40	33.47	36	37.72
Moschip Tech	167.93	165.23	168.24	168.24	161.53	1545.85	288.45	129.98	-	-
Mothersn Sum	39.08	39.15	38.89	39.42	37.95	8956.61	65.96	36.66	-	-
MOTILALOFS [1]	680.25	669.95	681.40	684.35	662.25	918.99	1097.00	487.85	42	670.75
Motisons Jwl	13.14	12.96	13.26	13.29	12.71	3316.42	24.02	10.62	-	-
MPHASIS	2114.80	2081.10	2116.00	2124.60	2061.60	314.62	3035.15	2025.05	28	2079.80
MPS	1465.20	1498.70	1467.00	1519.90	1456.90	26.75	3071.85	1340.00	22	1492.60
MRF	134920.00	132345.00	135455.00	135455.00	131100.00	7.64	163500.00	105039.80	25	132471.25
MRPL	178.14	206.77	178.10	209.96	173.91	145192.27	214.95	114.40	17	206.80
Mrs.Bect.Fd	181.19	180.34	181.19	182.06	174.38	668.52	1654.00	174.38	-	-
MSP Stl	31.02	29.94	31.02	31.09	29.61	1163.65	41.25	23.56	-	29.97
MSTC	413.20	405.70	414.00	415.05	393.45	210.21	582.45	393.45	-	-
MTAR Tech	3388.00	3438.20	3388.00	3491.90	3309.00	349.24	3920.00	1155.60	-	-
MTNL	25.13	24.63	25.15	25.29	24.28	1921.79	58.00	24.33	-	24.65
MufinGreen	101.70	100.07	102.50	103.60	99.40	1014.84	126.34	63.11	-	-
Mukand Ind	120.28	117.52	120.20	121.00	114.31	407.03	160.85	84.64	17	118.00
Mukka Protin	21.88	21.29	21.88	21.88	21.05	243.73	36.73	20.16	-	-
Munj Auto [2]	75.88	74.92	76.26	78.00	73.05	77.23	114.60	60.04	24	74.86
Muthoot Fin	3333.20	3361.00	3316.60	3370.00	3283.00	1333.03	4149.00	1964.35	16	3359.65
Muthoot MFin	145.96	145.46	146.00	148.50	141.50	185.88	199.39	119.25	-	-

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Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
N C L IND.	173.29	170.72	174.38	174.38	165.20	173.87	239.20	165.60	12	170.45
Nagar Fert [1]	4.17	4.00	4.17	4.25	3.91	668.61	6.54	3.78	-	4.02
NagarAgri [1]	122.03	115.93	121.10	121.58	115.93	1212.79	309.41	80.73	-	115.80
Nandan Den [1]	2.42	2.25	2.44	2.44	2.19	4897.01	4.41	2.21	-	2.27
Natco Phar [2]	955.85	946.15	990.00	990.00	933.50	800.91	1059.60	660.05	11	946.10
NATIONAL FER	71.20	68.60	71.31	71.34	67.01	3287.13	112.11	67.17	23	68.60
NationalAl [5]	387.35	372.25	384.25	390.30	369.60	17935.36	431.60	140.00	11	371.80
Nava	551.70	538.15	547.95	554.05	529.65	302.12	735.00	396.30	-	-
Navin Fluori [2]	6172.00	6171.50	6120.00	6233.50	6100.00	107.79	6960.00	3664.55	71	6168.20
NAVKARCORP	86.49	83.38	87.78	87.78	82.40	348.85	140.35	82.39	-	83.61
Navneet Edu [2]	128.54	127.28	128.00	129.25	125.61	117.50	168.00	126.10	15	127.10
Nazara Tech	237.35	232.60	238.95	238.95	220.10	1602.13	1453.00	220.10	-	-
NBCC [1]	83.20	82.88	83.20	83.75	80.25	13948.34	130.60	75.01	36	82.97
NCC [2]	144.28	141.84	144.28	144.75	139.44	2860.04	242.00	136.00	14	141.75
NDR AutoComp	654.30	649.10	657.45	657.55	624.75	23.68	1220.00	572.85	-	-
NDTV [4]	76.43	73.07	76.54	76.54	72.66	262.88	140.54	72.61	-	73.25
NELCAST [2]	122.69	120.16	120.80	121.66	118.16	82.33	180.65	78.00	22	120.70
Nelco Ltd.	602.05	592.10	599.35	599.35	575.60	82.34	1161.50	568.10	322	592.30
Neogen Chem	1343.60	1388.60	1352.10	1427.80	1319.10	113.82	1805.70	966.70	-	-
Nephrocare	538.30	526.80	540.00	544.00	515.10	64.98	616.00	446.00	-	-
NESCO [2]	1021.60	1021.70	1026.50	1030.00	1005.00	52.06	1638.85	867.00	18	1023.65
NESTLE (I) [1]	1202.20	1213.40	1200.00	1219.30	1196.50	1100.15	1339.85	1075.00	74	1211.80
Netweb Tech	3176.00	3226.60	3170.00	3258.90	3135.10	1424.01	4479.00	1251.55	-	-
Network18 [5]	31.10	30.64	31.08	31.16	30.00	5893.97	65.31	30.00	-	30.67
NetworkPeoSR	890.60	878.60	898.80	898.80	846.60	45.46	2531.75	846.60	-	-
Neuland Lab	12152.00	12230.00	12152.00	12550.00	12010.00	30.92	19748.40	10060.00	88	12243.85
Newgen Soft	441.90	451.20	446.00	467.90	440.15	5788.78	1379.15	437.00	21	451.65
Neyveli Lig	259.50	257.00	260.00	262.90	255.00	2231.59	292.35	202.05	18	256.95
NGL Fine Chm	2150.20	2179.90	2117.90	2323.90	2117.90	7.83	2575.00	980.00	-	-
NH	1668.80	1640.10	1660.00	1672.30	1613.00	375.62	2371.60	1380.05	68	1640.95
NHPC	74.98	75.27	75.20	75.98	74.27	26396.88	92.30	68.66	24	75.31

For BSE/NSE live quotes, scan the QR code or click the link https://bit.ly/2FpossK

CHENNAI businessline. TUESDAY - MARCH 17 - 2026

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Nucle.soft E	786.45	753.40	780.20	783.65	747.30	88.75	1375.75	723.85	12	753.45
Nupur Recycl	50.34	51.57	49.66	52.50	48.12	158.84	94.00	48.12	-	-
Nureca	257.45	246.20	259.05	262.25	242.00	24.76	343.00	203.62	-	-
Nuvama Wealt	1158.60	1158.80	1150.00	1171.00	1136.80	366.06	8508.50	1136.80	-	-
Nuvoco Vist.	292.10	287.85	292.05	294.85	280.45	271.94	477.50	280.30	-	-
O										
OBEROI REAL	1452.10	1418.10	1464.10	1464.10	1395.50	1082.38	2006.25	1396.00	30	1418.65
OCCL	86.98	86.11	86.95	87.75	84.10	64.15	159.42	72.83	-	-
Odisha Ce [2]	1839.90	1853.00	1856.00	1868.00	1803.60	237.88	2495.95	1604.00	238	1853.10
Oil Country	43.75	36.97	43.10	43.61	35.65	397.27	101.00	35.66	-	36.76
OIL INDIA	470.55	460.10	471.00	473.70	454.40	4235.09	524.15	322.15	18	460.05
Ola Electric	23.07	24.31	23.18	25.84	22.25	80291.42	71.24	21.21	-	24.32
OlectraGreen	880.45	897.45	885.00	906.95	866.60	427.28	1714.20	866.60	-	-
OM Infra	88.56	83.27	87.21	87.99	82.10	112.42	146.12	71.50	-	-
Omax Autos.	96.24	95.36	95.65	96.59	93.21	36.16	165.28	78.00	9	94.85
OMAXE	71.42	68.59	71.00	71.32	67.00	185.66	113.51	62.85	-	68.62
OMNITECH EN	218.54	218.68	225.00	230.00	211.87	952.38	230.00	176.25	-	-
One PointOne	43.99	45.98	44.12	47.73	41.84	3040.87	69.99	41.01	-	-
OneMobiwik	185.44	185.13	185.90	187.20	177.50	821.19	354.40	174.50	-	-
OnesourceSpe	1491.20	1493.20	1456.00	1506.30	1421.50	186.22	2248.00	1057.00	-	-
ONGC [5]	264.10	260.45	264.05	266.00	258.35	21725.89	293.15	205.00	10	260.40
ONMOBILE	48.34	48.37	48.59	48.90	46.66	192.35	75.00	40.00	13	48.30
Onward Techn	235.35	231.40	241.30	241.30	219.55	113.55	382.00	206.80	16	231.10
OPTIEMUS	335.60	333.70	336.70	343.70	325.05	146.30	712.95	325.20	127	333.75
ORACLE FIN [5]	6526.00	6414.00	6516.00	6525.00	6317.00	124.43	9948.00	6318.55	16	6407.50
Orchid Phr	512.10	504.95	512.00	513.90	497.25	199.66	899.00	489.00	-	-
ORIENT CEM [1]	133.24	133.41	133.50	135.32	131.85	507.44	362.05	132.35	8	133.85
Orient Cera.	35.66	34.73	36.37	37.38	34.48	92.73	56.64	28.67	-	-
Orient Elec.	169.80	167.99	172.78	172.78	166.10	124.53	248.90	155.35	-	-
Orient Hotel [1]	86.30	83.66	85.20	86.39	80.00	427.13	169.00	80.50	25	84.60
Orient Paper [1]	16.61	16.08	16.52	16.90	15.66	355.89	31.54	15.70	-	15.88
Orient Tech.	272.55	264.15	276.65	276.65	257.60	318.62	513.40	254.00	-	-
Orissa Min [1]	3592.50	3509.40	3583.20	3609.80	3441.10	14.01	6132.00	3450.00	-	3507.30
Orkla India	549.15	548.40	552.00	553.95	538.20	239.77	760.00	533.25	-	-
OswalAgroMil	41.74	40.51	41.48	42.20	39.57	64.39	110.69	40.00	7	40.43
OswalGrn.Tch	24.08	23.74	23.60	24.04	23.16	131.67	50.90	23.16	-	-
OswalPumps	292.80	291.80	293.50	296.00	283.10	943.43	888.40	283.10	-	-
P										
P&G Health	4849.40	4902.80	4849.40	4926.60	4725.00	14.61	6739.00	4725.00	-	-
Pace Digitek	163.85	163.90	163.00	167.47	158.72	454.38	231.95	153.05	-	-
Page Ind	30285.00	30200.00	30280.00	30350.00	29805.00	17.64	50470.60	29800.00	44	30201.60
Pakka	77.36	76.43	78.05	78.39	74.74	124.32	226.78	74.12	-	-
Panacea Bio [1]	325.15	316.80	327.75	327.75	313.00	104.89	581.00	306.00	-	317.30
Panama Pe [2]	269.65	256.20	268.35	270.00	252.00	57.68	411.15	236.00	12	260.05
ParadeepPhos	111.39	109.48	111.00	111.52	106.79	5911.35	234.39	89.73	-	-
Parag Milk	195.15	201.07	195.20	206.35	192.68	1358.25	377.20	142.10	16	200.70
PARAM [2]	31.81	33.21	31.50	33.45	30.86	1358.58	62.39	30.73	17	33.25
Paras Defen	638.95	634.45	640.00	648.00	625.00	899.20	1945.00	608.60	-	-
Park Hotels	112.36	107.09	112.36	112.81	106.22	877.65	173.20	106.22	-	-
Park MediWo	192.56	185.15	190.00	194.00	181.03	1012.57	208.72	138.10	-	-
Parsvnath [5]	6.76	6.51	6.90	6.90	6.45	800.04	27.46	6.10	-	6.60
Pasupati Acr	44.88	44.60	44.52	45.04	43.04	186.98	63.50	40.10	-	-
Patanjali Fd	481.60	483.80	484.85	487.00	476.45	1891.38	2011.00	476.45	-	-
Patel engg [1]	24.57	23.88	24.75	24.75	23.33	7703.40	46.59	23.33	6	23.92
Patel Retail	166.91	163.00	166.00	167.77	158.22	94.87	305.00	155.00	-	-
PayTM	976.20	1013.80	975.60	1019.80	972.10	2811.17	1381.80	682.10	-	-
PB Fintech	1446.00	1475.30	1433.00	1484.20	1431.00	1068.37	1978.00	1311.35	-	-
PC Jeweller [1]	8.51	8.37	8.49	8.49	8.18	34604.23	19.65	8.18	-	8.37
PCBL	253.20	250.70	254.85	255.40	245.10	1306.36	444.15	245.10	-	-
PDS	269.50	276.40	269.90	280.00	259.40	152.88	466.00	259.40	-	-
Penland Ltd [2]	15.47	15.24	15.47	16.79	15.00	1464.66	46.00	14.94	-	15.16
PENNAR IND [5]	145.39	140.65	144.00	144.00	136.95	1038.94	279.80	133.50	19	141.50
PERSISTENT [5]	4638.80	4638.80	4640.00	4848.90	4552.00	325.86	6597.00	4163.80	46	4643.85
Petronet LNG	286.30	283.35	285.30	288.10	280.35	3471.03	326.50	263.70	12	283.10
Pfizer Ltd.	4623.00	4749.50	4600.00	4950.00	4600.00	119.45	5987.65	3742.90	28	4749.25
PG Electro [1]	502.20	507.35	504.15	510.95	486.00	4784.69	1008.00	471.15	116	507.15
PGIL [5]	1461.90	1452.60	1467.80	1478.00	1439.00	48.20	1993.30	884.00	88	1450.60
Phoenix Mill [2]	1565.50	1552.30	1565.50	1566.00	1507.00	788.99	1965.00	1403.00	190	1555.55
PhysicsWall	84.08	83.72	84.20	84.84	80.60	10408.41	161.99	77.72	-	-
PI INDUS.L [1]	2896.30	2890.10	2900.00	2902.80	2844.00	135.13	4329.00	2841.60	27	2889.85
PiccadilyAgr	531.80	540.65	531.80	544.80	524.00	421.31	805.50	515.00	-	-
Pidilite [1]	1340.00	1353.60	1340.80	1361.50	1328.80	332.17	1575.00	1325.15	60	1354.20
Pine Labs	159.40	163.05	159.41	164.64	158.42	511.08	284.00	158.42	-	-
Piramal Fin	1746.90	1790.20	1721.80	1818.00	1690.00	361.02	1954.50	1260.00	-	-
Piramal Phr	139.81	138.72	140.02	141.10	134.60	4065.91	240.95	134.60	-	-
Pitti Engg [5]	770.45	775.20	769.90	789.00	752.10	47.66	1121.00	677.20	28	776.65
Pix Transm	1401.50	1409.10	1424.00	1424.00	1365.10	17.56	1799.60	1220.10	-	-
PlatinumInd	209.23	204.99	211.80	211.80	202.60	55.53	342.40	199.05	-	-
Plaza Wires	34.90	34.29	35.00	35.00	32.50	71.20	65.34	32.50	-	-
PN Gadgil Jw	550.95	537.10	558.95	558.95	527.00	146.82	701.40	473.80	-	-
Pnb Gilts	71.81	69.38	71.50	71.75	68.15	371.54	119.84	68.16	5	69.47
PNB Housng	763.90	766.75	763.00	777.55	749.50	534.97	1141.85	730.00	9	767.30
PNC Infra [2]	193.24	188.13	191.90	192.28	186.23	571.58	331.80	186.20	13	187.95
PNGS REVA DIA	383.50	365.45	389.25	391.65	361.00	153.26	433.00	360.00	-	-
Pokarna Ltd [2]	854.15	859.15	841.00	880.00	822.05	67.69	1359.05	692.55	-	862.05
Poly Medicu [5]	1260.20	1255.60	1265.00	1274.00	1235.00	119.56	2936.70	1210.35	37	1256.90
Polycab Ind.	7193.50	7127.00	7203.00	7224.50	7008.00	459.07	8722.00	4567.00	-	-
Polyplex	818.05	807.45	819.50	841.85	794.05	79.14	1396.80	775.00	38	808.05
PonawallaFin	408.35	423.40	407.80	426.70	402.55	2036.96	570.40	281.35	-	-
Pondy Oxides	1053.40	1040.70	1053.40	1060.00	1016.70	153.47	1578.00	490.00	-	-
Popular Veh.	89.50	86.19	90.00	90.00	82.41	125.77	163.00	82.41	-	-
Power Finan	405.60	406.25	404.20	410.00	396.55	6317.75	443.95	330.05	7	406.50
Power grid	300.95	297.75	300.95	303.00	291.40	25911.82	321.75	250.05	18	297.40
Power Instru	99.47	94.93	101.99	102.00	93.00	106.50	195.45	93.00	-	-
Power Trad	158.48	157.32	157.79	159.53	155.22	980.98	206.90	142.60	12	157.40
POWERMECH	1983.00	1876.50	1980.00	1980.00	1804.60	137.47	3415.45	1854.85	19	1890.35
Prabha Energ	152.85	148.11	149.00	151.94	146.10	37.05	315.90	146.10	-	-
Praj Ind.ltd [2]	302.40	295.05	304.50	304.60	292.25	1712.36	591.90	273.05	34	295.00
Prakash Ind.	120.77	117.80	121.00	122.01	116.26	456.53	191.00	110.00	6	117.95
Prakash Pipe	192.05	185.28	192.00	192.00	183.61	137.63	473.90	183.61	-	-
Precam	120.56	117.05	120.56	121.52	115.05	179.10	263.30	115.05	40	117.25
Precision Wr [1]	283.15	286.15	285.65	289.00	277.75	1206.93	355.90	118.35	40	286.30
Premier Enr	781.85	795.75	781.00	800.65	768.05	1878.69	1163.90	660.00	-	-
Premier Expl [2]	450.95	431.85	450.50	450.95	426.00	300.83	682.90	308.95	50	431.85
prestige Est	1257.00	1250.30	1257.20	1261.00	1204.00	1786.83	1812.40	1048.30	561	1250.15
Pricol Ltd [1]	516.85	525.60	516.00	528.00	511.00	462.50	694.95	381.50	41	526.65
Prime Focus [1]	257.45	260.65	258.00	268.75	257.00	4158.17	294.05	85.00	-	261.95
Primo Chemic	18.11	17.96	17.20	20.00	17.20	279.15	31.39	16.78	-	-
Prince Pipe	244.15	241.40	245.00	245.45	236.05	141.97	387.70	229.05	-	-
Prism Cement	125.21	125.26	125.20	126.78	124.75	247.74	172.15	110.05	-	125.40
Pritika Auto	11.96	11.65	12.15	12.15	11.46	173.25	21.01	11.40	-	-
Privi Speclt	2845.30	2823.70	2845.30	2855.80	2752.50	53.75	3440.50	1482.00	-	-
Procter&Gam	10522.00	10161.00	10599.00	10599.00	10078.00	47.40	14536.60	10100.00	38	10170.30
ProstarmInfo	125.31	124.05	129.00	129.00	122.41	354.04	253.49	108.00	-	-
Protean EGov	523.55	524.85	527.00	530.00	511.00	519.72	1484.50	511.00	-	-
Prozone Rlty	42.96	43.78	42.96	44.16	42.26	262.68	72.77	27.30	-	-
Prudent Corp	2228.90	2204.00	2234.90	2256.00	2164.60	42.39	3098.00	1750.05	-	-
PSPPROJECT	658.95	667.60	663.00	683.30	653.00	111.71	1030.80	577.00	73	674.55
PTC Ind.	16999.00	17110.00	16999.00	17239.00	16385.00	20.25	19387.00	11902.00	-	-
PTCFIN SER	27.52	26.78	27.51	28.70	26.46	897.68	44.49	24.03	5	26.79
Pudumjee P [1]	72.99	72.60	74.00	74.00	71.23	98.92	148.05	63.11	7	72.60
Punjab Nat [2]	111.70	110.97	112.00	112.20	108.20	24727.26	135.15	86.63	8	110.90
PUNJABNSIND	23.60	23.10	23.50	23.59	22.60	2845.46	50.49	22.60	14	23.20
Puravankara [5]	180.92	179.03	181.83	181.97	175.62	188.38	338.50	160.00	-	178.95
PVR Inox	973.90	977.20	977.90	980.50	956.00	328.04	1249.70	830.00	-	-
Q										
Quadrant Fut	296.80	290.50	301.35	301.35	284.70	477.81	604.75	248.55	-	-
QualityPower	777.30	795.75	783.30	809.80	762.85	1052.48	1082.00	267.80	-	-
QUESS	181.72	175.19	180.41	181.55	174.00	461.37	378.10	173.95	12	175.00
Quickheal	144.95	142.23	145.01	146.48	138.60	150.60	416.00	138.45	114	142.75
R										
RACL Geartch	1229.90	1278.60	1236.10	1291.00	1227.10	38.14	1691.90	658.05	-	-
RadhikaJew	58.04	56.77	57.58	58.04	55.32	232.87	111.50	55.32	-	-
Radiant CMS	35.97	35.45	34.99	36.47	34.86	369.09	73.80	34.73	-	-
RadiKhait [2]	2800.10	2827.40	2788.00	2856.00	2757.10	283.16	3695.00	2132.05	71	2823.15
Raghav Prod.	649.50	642.05	664.95	664.95	636.80	38.25	1065.50	456.60	-	-
Rail Tel	278.00	269.95	278.00	279.25	265.45	1131.09	478.95	265.45	-	-
RAIN [2]	112.16	112.46	112.66	114.40	110.02	2758.42	175.95	99.85	-	112.70
Rainbow Ch.	1132.70	1118.00	1132.70	1138.20	1107.00	85.90	1645.70	1090.00	-	-
Rajoo Engine	57.27	57.26	57.27	57.80	55.04	565.25	145.88	55.04	-	-
Rajratan Glo	367.65	367.15	368.00	378.65	351.10	108.80	540.00	260.00	-	-
Rallis India [1]	240.10	236.60	240.45	240.90	231.20	222.89	385.60	197.00	25	236.75
Ram Ratna Wr	307.50	299.65	302.40	310.00	295.85	37.94	785.95	268.00	-	-
Rama Phos.	110.23	107.32	110.77	110.77	105.52	77.59	217.19	80.85	-	-

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Rhetan TMT L	24.52	25.07	24.40	25.20	24.40	1704.67	27.69	20.32	-	-
Rico Auto [1]	105.71	105.79	105.05	106.56	102.39	1949.60	142.30	49.50	41	106.00
Rishabh Ins	390.85	401.45	391.00	410.00	370.00	77.32	490.00	202.51	-	-
Ritco Logi.	207.02	205.79	207.80	208.40	199.01	69.67	317.95	183.27	-	-
RITES	196.84	191.15	195.78	196.99	188.35	737.21	316.15	188.30	23	191.00
RK Forgings [2]	559.25	554.15	559.00	562.30	539.35	322.33	862.05	473.35	40	555.20
RK Swamy	95.36	89.22	95.00	96.00	88.51	108.84	248.04	88.51	-	-
Rolex Rings	115.21	116.98	115.21	117.88	113.60	515.72	1660.00	99.79	-	-
Rossari Bio	446.30	433.95	446.30	446.30	431.10	73.29	766.00	431.10	-	-
Rossell Tech	684.45	660.75	674.00	677.15	650.05	50.83	840.00	231.15	-	-
Roto Pumps	57.21	56.03	57.25	57.67	54.55	682.41	310.25	52.29	-	-
Route Mobile	460.60	456.25	460.60	462.30	446.00	185.72	1158.00	446.00	-	-
Royal Orch	333.85	322.35	330.00	330.10	311.05	85.92	594.10	311.35	49	322.05
RPG lifesc [8]	1881.00	1894.70	1880.90	1935.60	1850.00	14.25	2715.90	1767.25	30	1884.40
RPOWER	22.25	22.42	22.44	22.59	21.88	50187.81	76.49	21.13	-	22.42
RPP INFRA	69.47	68.93	69.47	70.30	67.51	321.06	177.45	63.00	9	69.25
RPSG Vent.	597.30	592.15	606.25	614.00	574.05	30.04	1027.00	574.05	-	-
RR Kabel	1343.10	1369.70	1339.10	1377.70	1315.00	212.32	1578.20	853.55	-	-
RSystems Int [1]	266.90	261.90	265.60	273.45	254.40	1269.89	496.95	251.00	13	262.10
RTNPOWER	8.14	8.02	8.17	8.20	7.88	13746.45	16.94	7.63	-	8.02
Rubicon Rese	768.80	747.60	767.70	784.20	744.00	166.04	822.00	570.75	-	-
RUPA & CO [1]	126.52	122.36	125.31	126.74	120.61	260.08	233.45	121.05	14	122.30
Rushil Deco [1]	15.61	15.25	15.43	16.21	15.00	786.31	33.80	15.00	-	15.23
RVNL	271.25	266.70	271.25	271.90	260.70	6663.57	447.80	260.70	-	-
S										
S&W Solar	169.25	171.25	170.48	173.50	165.30	2032.02	348.90	165.30	-	-
SaatvikGreen	352.20	346.90	344.10	350.70	337.00	145.47	567.00	328.00	-	-
Sadhana Nit.	1.69	1.77	1.73	1.77	1.66	3876.32	23.86	1.42	-	-
Safari Ind	1594.10	1544.60	1580.00	1596.80	1531.60	118.82	2507.10	1531.60	-	-
Sagar Cemnt [2]	176.14	171.71	176.12	176.98	170.11	170.29	300.00	155.05	-	171.60
Sagility Ind	37.83	37.68	38.16	38.62	37.11	19263.21	57.89	37.11	-	-
Sai Life Sci	953.05	976.50	953.10	984.65	946.35	672.77	1084.00	636.10	-	-
Sai Silks	100.34	96.25	100.34	100.34	95.22	873.93	223.03	94.55	-	-
Sakar Health	518.75	515.40	520.35	528.00	504.10	66.01	569.95	210.10	-	-
SAKSOFT [1]	127.66	121.71	129.22	129.22	120.55	389.61	254.15	119.55	22	121.90
Sakthi Sugar	14.72	13.90	14.72	15.39	13.62	211.57	28.51	13.72	10	13.92
SALASAR [1]	7.06	6.89	7.02	7.17	6.81	5956.43	11.53	6.80	-	6.90
Salzer Elec	570.30	547.15	562.35	568.90	539.00	112.05	1167.50	527.00	19	545.00
SambhvStee	89.18	87.17	89.18	91.20	86.00	1605.02	149.40	81.42	-	-
Samhi Hotels	148.41	146.47	148.41	150.35	143.42	1062.27	254.50	121.10	-	-
Samman Cap.	140.12	138.09	141.00	141.28	137.50	6850.34	192.95	97.61	-	-
Samvard.Moth	113.82	113.32	113.82	115.10	111.00	17822.19	162.25	89.70	-	-
Sanathan Tex	390.00	383.40	378.00	390.85	378.00	55.28	560.20	306.00	-	-
Sandhar	483.95	484.15	485.00	487.25	475.10	82.04	600.10	340.05	17	485.20
Sandur Mang.	191.63	182.01	192.60	193.23	181.10	1790.68	557.75	156.30	-	-
Sanghvi Mo [1]	235.00	230.95	231.05	235.95	223.80	314.89	412.90	205.00	14	232.65
Sangi Ind	51.06	51.40	51.06	52.08	50.84	1406.74	71.80	51.00	-	51.42
Sanofi Cons.	4192.90	4269.10	4239.00	4303.20	4080.00	12.02	5894.50	3975.00	-	-
Sanofi ind	3501.30	3438.00	3500.00	3500.00	3415.00	22.88	6717.50	3415.80	23	3440.95
Sansera Engg	1953.40	2026.80	1984.00	2072.40	1947.70	325.87	2396.00	972.20	-	-
Sanstar	83.99	81.06	83.21	84.07	80.10	210.82	107.29	79.00	-	-
Sapphire Fd	162.54	163.06	160.10	164.95	155.00	777.80	368.00	153.53	-	-
Sarda EnMin [1]	530.35	505.40	531.95	531.95	499.05	737.95	639.95	397.10	20	505.95
Saregama (I) [1]	342.60	357.40	342.60	370.90	338.80	2522.64	603.00	307.25	34	358.00
SARLA PER F [1]	75.24	79.53	75.00	81.50	72.59	161.68	127.90	71.27	10	79.02
SASKEN COMM	1007.50	1003.40	1022.60	1024.50	991.00	42.75	1710.25	993.05	25	1006.85
Satia Ind.	59.92	59.49	59.79	60.72	58.50	145.65	97.50	58.00	-	-
SATIN	144.04	144.58	144.04	146.80	143.00	140.60	176.00	131.40	8	144.85
SBC Exports	32.07	31.34	32.05	32.31	29.30	14795.02	32.85	10.95	-	-
SBFC Fin.	90.95	91.44	90.01	91.92	89.05	997.59	123.00	82.00	-	-
SBI Cards	704.90	695.55	700.05	702.85	688.05	1191.41	1027.25	688.05	-	-
SBILIFE	1904.40	1909.20	1901.00	1918.00	1881.00	902.40	2132.90	1391.15	77	1909.65
SChand Co [5]	146.49	143.05	148.99	148.99	139.75	62.97	257.50	138.55	57	142.80
SchlossBanga	432.20	415.90	427.00	432.05	413.45	275.54	474.40	382.50	-	-
ScodaTubes	119.08	117.76	118.00	120.99	110.00	132.69	230.85	110.00	-	-
SE INVESTM [1]	30.97	34.79	30.99	37.16	30.00	10977.42	41.50	29.40	15	35.27
SEDEMAC MECH	1465.50	1471.00	1490.00	1495.00	1427.90	125.99	1613.50	1413.10	-	-
Senco Gold	290.55	290.85	290.55	294.50	282.85	546.59	405.70	227.40	-	-
Senores Phar	727.10	744.30	732.45	753.70	715.05	122.82	876.50	440.30	-	-
SEPC	5.32	5.01	5.35	5.35	4.83	71953.17	16.89	4.83	-	-
Servote.Pwr	68.28	66.23	68.24	68.29	65.00	630.43	168.50	57.51	-	-
Seshasaai Te	250.08	249.97	254.90	254.90	248.24	86.47	437.45	227.01	-	-
SFL [5]	515.25	517.80	517.15	522.25	499.80	180.77	778.20	498.05	77	518.25
SG Mart L	452.00	438.95	452.00	454.05	430.80	145.40	479.10	313.10	-	-
SGFinserveLt	378.40	378.00	378.00	385.15	368.00	109.15	452.80	323.00	-	-
Sh Renu Sug [1]	24.02	23.49	23.86	23.98	23.12	3745.10	35.84	22.86	-	23.51
Shadowfax Te	107.47	108.78	107.00	109.79	104.03	708.95	127.75	98.55	-	-
Shaily Eng	1938.80	1915.10	1912.20	1934.00	1876.40	322.80	2799.90	1372.65	-	-
SHAKTI PUMPS	500.90	493.15	500.90	502.35	484.95	914.97	1047.00	462.50	19	492.75
SHALBY	144.02	140.16	142.05	144.80	139.02	176.06	274.50	137.00	20	140.05
Shankara Bld	104.47	104.08	104.10	105.60	102.82	92.22	311.50	98.50	5	104.15
Shankara Bui	937.35	917.35	937.35	950.00	895.00	31.21	1050.20	636.00	-	-
ShantiGolInt	187.61	182.28	187.61	188.55	178.20	334.24	274.10	178.20	-	-
Sharda Crop	989.70	989.30	989.70	1001.90	967.30	166.66	1297.80	440.05	18	989.25
SHARDA M [2]	779.75	763.20	779.75	785.00	752.10	49.38	1258.00	625.00	14	763.75

Exchange Traded Funds

BSE Stocks

NSE Trade for Trade